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Initial Public Offer of equity shares on the main board platforms of BSE Limited ("BSE") and National Stock Exchange of India Limited ("NSE", and together with BSE, the "Stock Exchanges") in compliance with Chapter II of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018, as amended ("SEBI ICDR Regulations").

milkymist

MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus and the Abridged Prospectus)

Our Company was initially formed as a partnership firm as "M.M.D. Dairy" at Erode, Tamil Nadu under the Indian Partnership Act, 1932, pursuant to a deed of partnership dated November 30, 1998, and a certificate of registration dated February 1, 1999 issued by the Registrar of Firms, Periyar (Erode). The name of the partnership firm was changed to "Milky Mist Dairy Food" pursuant to a certificate of registration dated August 2, 2006 issued by the Registrar of Firms, Periyar (Erode). The partnership firm was subsequently converted and our Company was incorporated as a private limited company under the Companies Act, 2013 under the name "Milky Mist Dairy Food Private Limited" pursuant to a certificate of incorporation dated July 10, 2014 issued by the RoC. Subsequently, our Company was converted into a public limited company as approved by a resolution of our Board dated May 15, 2025, and a special resolution of our Shareholders dated May 16, 2025 following which the name of our Company was changed to "Milky Mist Dairy Food Limited" and a fresh certificate of incorporation consequent upon change of name dated May 26, 2025, was issued by the RoC. For further details, see *"History and Certain Corporate Matters"* on page 263 of the red herring prospectus dated August 4, 2026 (**"RHP"** or **"Red Herring Prospectus"**) filed with the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu at Coimbatore.

Registered and Corporate Office: SF No. 43/1-4, Pattakaranpalayam, Perundurai, Erode District – 638 057, Tamil Nadu, India;
Contact Person: S Prakash, Company Secretary and Compliance Officer; **Telephone:** + 91 424 2533248; **E-mail:** investor@milkymist.com; **Website:** www.milkymist.com; **Corporate Identity Number:** U15200TZ2014PLC020554

OUR PROMOTERS: SATHISHKUMAR T AND ANITHA S

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFERING OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED ("OUR COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹[●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("OFFER PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹15,530.00 MILLION COMPRISING A FRESH ISSUE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹14,280.00 MILLION BY OUR COMPANY (THE "FRESH ISSUE") AND AN OFFER FOR SALE OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES ("OFFERED SHARES") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹1,250.00 MILLION BY SATHISHKUMAR T AND ANITHA S (THE "PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS", AND SUCH OFFER FOR SALE BY THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDERS, THE "OFFER FOR SALE" TOGETHER WITH THE FRESH ISSUE, THE "OFFER").

THIS OFFER INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AGGREGATING UP TO ₹20.00 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY) FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES (THE "EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION"). OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS, HAS OFFERED A DISCOUNT OF [●] % ON THE OFFER PRICE (EQUIVALENT OF ₹13 PER EQUITY SHARE) TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING UNDER THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT"). THE OFFER LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET OFFER". THE OFFER AND THE NET OFFER SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]%, RESPECTIVELY OF THE POST-OFFER PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF OUR COMPANY.

OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS, UNDERTOOK A PRE-IPO PLACEMENT OF (I) 543,789 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹139.76 PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A PREMIUM OF ₹137.76 PER EQUITY SHARE); AND (II) 25,000,000 CCPS OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹139.76 PER CCPS, AGGREGATING TO ₹3,570.00 MILLION, AS PERMITTED UNDER THE APPLICABLE LAW. THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT WAS AT A PRICE DECIDED BY OUR COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS AND WAS COMPLETED PRIOR TO FILING OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS WITH THE ROC. THE AMOUNT RAISED PURSUANT TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT WAS REDUCED FROM THE FRESH ISSUE, SUBJECT TO COMPLIANCE WITH RULE 19(2)(B) OF THE SECURITIES CONTRACTS (REGULATION) RULES, 1957, AS AMENDED AND THE SIZE OF THE FRESH ISSUE HAS BEEN REVISED TO UP TO ₹ 14,280.00 MILLION. THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT DID NOT EXCEED 20% OF THE ORIGINAL SIZE OF THE FRESH ISSUE AS DISCLOSED IN THE DRAFT RED HERRING PROSPECTUS. OUR COMPANY HAD APPROPRIATELY INTIMATED THE SUBSCRIBERS TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT, PRIOR TO ALLOTMENT PURSUANT TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT, THAT THERE IS NO GUARANTEE THAT OUR COMPANY MAY PROCEED WITH THE OFFER OR THE OFFER MAY BE SUCCESSFUL AND WILL RESULT INTO LISTING OF THE EQUITY SHARES ON THE STOCK EXCHANGES. FURTHER, RELEVANT DISCLOSURES IN RELATION TO SUCH INTIMATION TO THE SUBSCRIBERS TO THE PRE-IPO PLACEMENT HAS BEEN APPROPRIATELY MADE IN THE RELEVANT SECTIONS OF THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND WILL BE MADE IN THE PROSPECTUS.

DETAILS OF THE PROMOTER SELLING SHAREHOLDER, OFFER FOR SALE AND WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION

NAME OF THE SELLING SHAREHOLDER	TYPE	NUMBER OF EQUITY SHARES OFFERED (UP TO) / AMOUNT	WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION PER EQUITY SHARE[(1)](IN ₹)
Sathishkumar T	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹750.00 million	0.06
Anitha S	Promoter Selling Shareholder	Up to [●] Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each aggregating up to ₹500.00 million	0.06

[(1)] As certified by VKS Aiyer & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN:000066S), pursuant to their certificate dated August 4, 2026.

PRICE BAND: ₹ 133 TO ₹140 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 2 EACH.
THE FLOOR PRICE AND THE CAP PRICE ARE 66.50 TIMES AND 70.00 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES, RESPECTIVELY.
BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 107 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 2 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 107 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹2 EACH THEREAFTER.
A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 13 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION.
THE PRICE TO EARNINGS RATIO (P/E) BASED ON DILUTED EPS FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS AS HIGH AS 71.07 TIMES AND AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 67.51 TIMES AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 52.56 TIMES.
WEIGHTED AVERAGE RETURN ON NET WORTH FOR LAST THREE FINANCIAL YEARS IS 24.77%.

The details of the Fresh Issue, Offer for Sale, Total Offer Size and the post Offer market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹133 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹140 per Equity Share	
	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 2 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)	Up to No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 2 each	Up to Amount (₹ in million)
Fresh Issue	107,384,711	14,280.00	102,014,623	14,280.00
Offer for Sale	9,398,495	1,250.00	8,928,570	1,250.00
Total Offer Size	116,783,206	15,530.00	110,943,193	15,530.00
Post-Offer market capitalization of the Company	775,213,500	103,103.40	769,843,412	107,778.08

BID/OFFER PROGRAMME

BID/OFFER OPENS TODAY

BID/OFFER CLOSES ON : THURSDAY, AUGUST 13, 2026[#]

[#] The UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on Bid/Offer Closing Date.

We are a packaged food company with exclusive focus on value-added products within the dairy market such as cheese, paneer, butter, curd, ghee, yogurt, ice cream, ultra-high temperature long-shelf life products, and other products, including frozen foods, ready-to-eat and ready-to-cook products, as well as chocolates, all being offered under our umbrella brand 'Milky Mist', and sub-brands such as 'SmartChef', 'Capella', 'Misty Lite', 'Briyas' and 'Asal'.

THE OFFER IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.
THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.
QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET OFFER | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET OFFER | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET OFFER
EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES AGGREGATING UP TO ₹20.00 MILLION

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST ONLY RELY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE OFFER, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE OFFER AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT FOR THE OFFER AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE VALUATION OF OUR COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE OFFER. ("BRLMs").

IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE RECOMMENDATION OF THE COMMITTEE OF INDEPENDENT DIRECTORS OF OUR COMPANY, PURSUANT TO THEIR RESOLUTION DATED AUGUST 5, 2026, THE ABOVE PROVIDED PRICE BAND IS JUSTIFIED BASED ON QUANTITATIVE FACTORS/ KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATORS ("KPI") DISCLOSED IN THE *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION ON PAGE 146 OF THE RHP *VIS-A-VIS* THE WEIGHTED AVERAGE COST OF ACQUISITION ("WACA") OF PRIMARY AND SECONDARY TRANSACTION(S), AS APPLICABLE, DISCLOSED IN *'BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE'* SECTION ON PAGE 146 OF THE RHP.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details, refer to section titled "Risk Factors" beginning on page 23 of the RHP

1. **Contingent liabilities exposure:** As of March 31, 2026, we had contingent liabilities aggregating to ₹2,290.09 million, which if materializes, may adversely affect our Company's business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows. Set forth below is the detailed breakup of the contingent liabilities.

Particulars	As of March 31, 2026 (₹ million)
Guarantees given by banks on behalf of our Company	66.40
Obligation with respect to Export Promotion Capital Goods (EPCG) licenses: Quantum of duty saved[(1)]	1,948.71
Disputed statutory liabilities not provided for	254.68
Disputed other liabilities not provided for	20.30
Total	**2,290.09**

Notes:
[(1)] If we fail to meet our EPCG obligations in full or within the prescribed timelines or if an extension is not granted to us to fulfil our obligations, we may be liable to pay an amount equivalent to the duty saved, along with applicable interest and penalties.

2. **Dependence on raw milk procurement from Tamil Nadu:** Our manufacturing operations are dependent on the supply of our primary raw material, being raw milk, with 94.51%, 97.68% and 99.62% for Fiscals 2026, 2025, 2024 respectively being procured from Tamil Nadu. Further, we procure majority of the raw milk from dairy farmers which constituted 74.34%, 85.15% and 96.61% of our total raw milk procurement in Fiscals 2026, 2025, 2024 respectively and we have no formal arrangements with such dairy farmers. Any disruption in the availability of raw milk, increase in procurement costs, disease outbreaks affecting cattle, or adverse developments in Tamil Nadu may adversely affect our Company's business, financial condition and results of operations.
3. **Geographical revenue concentration in South India:** We derive a significant portion of our revenue from the sale of our products in South India (comprising Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh and Telangana). The table below sets forth our revenue from operations from South India in the years indicated:

Region	Fiscal 2026		Fiscal 2025		Fiscal 2024	
	Amount (₹ million)	% of revenue from operations	Amount (₹ million)	% of revenue from operations	Amount (₹ million)	% of revenue from operations
Karnataka (A)	7,469.09	23.80%	5,834.46	24.83%	4,844.20	26.59%
Tamil Nadu (B)	7,597.72	24.21%	5,817.36	24.76%	4,713.46	25.88%
Kerala (C)	3,541.46	11.28%	2,740.63	11.66%	2,134.79	11.72%
Andhra Pradesh (D)	798.93	2.55%	637.88	2.71%	455.01	2.50%
Telangana (E)	2,320.04	7.39%	1,650.36	7.02%	1,273.96	6.99%
South India (F) = (A) + (B) + (C) + (D) + (E)	**21,727.24**	**69.23%**	**16,680.69**	**71.00%**	**13,421.42**	**73.68%**

Any significant social, political or economic disruption, or natural calamities or civil disruptions in South India, or changes in policies of the state or local governments or the government of India or adverse developments related to competition in the aforementioned regions, may adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.

4. **Substantial indebtedness:** We have substantial indebtedness which requires significant cash flows to service and limits our ability to operate freely. As of May 31, 2026, our total outstanding fund-based borrowings were ₹13,907.23 million. Further, one of our trademarks "Milky Mist" has been hypothecated as security for financing arrangements availed from certain lenders. Enforcement of such security by lenders in the event of default may have an adverse effect on our brand, reputation and financial results. The table below sets forth certain information on our borrowings as of and for the last three Fiscals as indicated:

Particulars	As of/ for the year ended March 31, 2026	As of/ for the year ended March 31, 2025	As of/ for the year ended March 31, 2024
Total borrowings (₹ million)	16,718.53	13,763.76	10,367.23
Finance costs (₹ million)	1,057.88	858.51	717.19
Finance costs as a % of revenue from operations	3.37%	3.65%	3.94%
Interest coverage ratio (in times)	2.50	2.02	1.60
Debt service coverage ratio (in times)	1.63	1.16	1.04
Debt to equity ratio (in times)	3.61	4.20	3.68

5. **Revenue concentration from certain products:** Significant portion of our revenue is derived from the sale of certain products, namely, paneer, cheese and curd (which contributed 59.05%, 62.63% and 66.16% to our revenue from operations in Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively). Demand for these product categories depends primarily on consumer-related factors such as regional preferences, demographics, consumer confidence in our products as well as evolving consumer tastes and preferences and any decrease in demand for these products could have an adverse effect on our business, results of operations, financial condition and cash flows.
6. **Recent equity issuance at lower than Offer Price:** Our Company has issued Equity Shares during the last 12 months, including pursuant to Pre-IPO Placement, at prices that could be lower than the Offer Price as set out below:

Date of allotment	Details of allottees	Reason for/ nature of allotment	No. of Equity Shares allotted	Face value per Equity Share (₹)	Issue price per Equity Share (₹)	Nature of consideration
July 15, 2025	Multiple allottees[(1)]	Conversion of CCPS into Equity Shares	12,285,000	2	15.87[##]	Cash consideration received at the time of allotment of CCPS. No consideration received on conversion of CCPS into Equity Shares.
April 30, 2026	Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd	Private placement	543,789	2	139.76	Cash
July 22, 2026	Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd	Conversion of CCPS into Equity Shares	25,000,000	2	139.76**	Cash consideration received at the time of allotment of CCPS. No consideration received on conversion of CCPS into Equity Shares

[##] The above price has been derived based on the consideration paid by the holders of CCPS at time of allotment of CCPS divided by the number of equity shares allotted to such shareholders upon conversion of CCPS. The CCPS were allotted at ₹2,856 per CCPS aggregating to a total consideration of ₹ 194.92 million. Pursuant to a resolution passed by our Board dated March 13, 2025, and a special resolution passed by our Shareholders at an extra-ordinary general meeting held on March 14, 2025, each preference share of our Company of face value of ₹10 was sub-divided into 5 preference shares of face value of ₹2 each. Further, on March 17, 2025 our Company allotted bonus CCPS in the ratio of 35 preference shares for every 1 preference share held by the existing Shareholders as of the record date i.e., March 12, 2025. Accordingly, 12,285,000 Equity Shares were allotted upon conversion of CCPS.
*** The above price has been derived based on the consideration paid by the holder of CCPS at time of allotment of CCPS divided by the number of equity shares allotted to such shareholders upon conversion of CCPS. The CCPS were allotted at ₹139.76 per CCPS aggregating to a total consideration of ₹ 3,494.00 million.*
[(1)] For details refer to "Capital Structure – Notes to the Capital Structure" on page 99 of the RHP.

7. **Regulatory approvals Risk:** Our Company is required to obtain and maintain various statutory approvals, licences and permits. The details of material approvals for our Perundurai Manufacturing Facility and Milk Chilling Centres for which applications are pending before relevant authorities are as below. Failure to obtain, renew or comply with such approvals may adversely affect our operations. Further, our Company is in the process of applying for Consent to operate issued under the provisions of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974 and the Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981 for the Milk Chilling Centres situated at Gundlupete, Karnataka.

S. No.	Nature of approval	Name of Authority	Date of acknowledgement of application/ date of application
Perundurai Manufacturing Facility			
1.	Consent to operate issued under the provisions of the Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974 and the Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981 for our Perundurai Manufacturing Facility	Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board	April 8, 2026
Milk Chilling Centres			
1.	No objection certificate issued under the provisions of the Karnataka State Fire Services Act, 1964 for our Milk Chilling Centre situated at Gundlupete, Karnataka	Karnataka State Fire and Emergency Services Department	July 18, 2025

8. **Utilization of Net proceeds:** Our Company has not entered into definitive arrangements for the utilisation of certain portions of the Net Proceeds, and the estimated costs are based on vendor quotations and management estimates. As of June 30, 2026, purchase orders aggregating to ₹897.49 million (approximately 17.33% of the estimated capital expenditure for the expansion and modernisation of the Perundurai Manufacturing Facility) had been placed, out of which ₹487.02 million had been paid. Any delay in finalising arrangements, obtaining regulatory approvals, procuring equipment, cost escalations, foreign exchange fluctuations, or executing the proposed expansion may result in time and cost overruns and adversely affect our business, financial condition, cash flows and results of operations.
9. **Auditor remarks:** The statutory auditors of the Company and Subsidiary have made certain observations in their audit reports for Fiscal 2026, 2025 and 2024 under their reporting requirements under the Companies (Auditor's Report) Order, 2020 and Rule 11(g) of the Companies (Audit and Auditors) Rules, 2014 (as amended). Similar observations in future periods may adversely affect the Company's reputation and financial condition.
10. **Credit rating risk:** Our Company's ability to access capital depends on maintaining its credit ratings. Any downgrade may increase borrowing costs and adversely affect access to financing.

Continued on next page...

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11. The details of Price/Earnings, Earnings per share, Return on Net Worth, Net Asset Value Per Equity Share for our Company and peer group are as follows:

Name of the company	Revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	Face value per equity share (₹)	Closing price on July 20, 2026 (₹) per equity share	P/E ratio	EPS (Basic) (₹ per share)	EPS (Diluted) (₹ per share)	RoNW (%)	Net Worth (in ₹ million)	Net Asset Value ("NAV") (₹ per share)
Our Company	31,383.64	2.00	140.00**	71.07**	1.98*	1.97*	33.60%	3,779.95	5.87
Listed peers									
Bikaji Foods International Limited	29,938.63	1.00	642.05	62.33	10.31	10.30	16.07%	16,069.93	64.03
Britannia Industries Limited	1,91,515.90	1.00	5,467.70	51.98	105.18	105.18	49.61%	51,065.60	212.01
Dodla Dairy Limited	41,252.01	10.00	1,073.65	24.26	44.26	44.26	15.95%	16,740.81	277.50
Hatsun Agro Product Limited	99,592.20	1.00	930.65	58.20	15.99	15.99	18.32%	19,445.20	87.30
Nestle India Limited	2,31,546.00	1.00	1,447.70	79.76	18.15	18.15	67.85%	51,569.70	26.74
Parag Milk Foods Limited	38,175.00	10.00	224.90	21.28	11.06	10.57	10.73%	12,585.60	93.44
Tata Consumer Products Limited	2,02,904.30	1.00	1,091.80	70.08	15.59	15.58	7.08%	2,17,875.30	220.02
Average of Listed Peers				**52.56**					

**Earnings per Share for the years ended March 31, 2026, March 31, 2025 and March 31, 2024 have been retrospectively adjusted for equity shares issued on conversion of CCPS.*
***Determined based on the Cap Price.*
For further details and relevant footnotes, please refer to page 150 of the RHP.
Rationale for selection of listed industry peers: *Our Company is a packaged food company with an exclusive focus on value-added products within the dairy market. For the purpose of selection of listed industry peers, we have focused on listed companies with revenue of more than ₹15,000.00 million in Fiscal 2026, branded pure-play packaged food companies as well as large dairy companies with revenue of more than ₹15,000.00 million in Fiscal 2026 and with more than one-third of their revenue attributable to value added products. Basis these criteria, our listed peers have been identified as Bikaji Foods International Limited, Britannia Industries Limited, Dodla Dairy Limited, Hatsun Agro Product Limited, Nestle India Limited, Parag Milk Foods Limited and Tata Consumer Products Limited.*

12. Weighted Average Return on Net Worth for Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 24.77%

13. Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares held by each of our Promoters, Sathishkumar T and Anitha S (also the Promoter Selling Shareholders) is ₹0.06 per Equity Share of face value of ₹2 each and the Offer Price at upper end of the price band is ₹ 140 per Equity Share.

14. Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition of Equity Shares: The weighted average cost of acquisition of all shares transacted in last one year, 18 months and the three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus is set out below:

Particulars	Weighted Average Cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'x' times the weighted average cost of acquisition	Range of acquisition price per Equity Share (Lowest price –Highest price) (in ₹)
Last one year preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	110.84	1.26	Nil-139.76
Last 18 months preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	8.52	16.43	Nil-139.76
Last three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus	8.52	16.43	Nil-139.76

(1) As certified by VKS Aiyer & Co., Chartered Accountants (FRN:000066S), pursuant to their certificate dated August 5, 2026.
For further details and relevant footnotes, please refer to page 108 of the RHP.

15. Performance of BRLMs' Past Issues: The 3 BRLMs associated with the Offer have handled 95 public issues in the past three years, out of which 25 issues closed below the IPO price on listing date:

Name of the BRLMs	Total Public Issues	Issues closed below the issue price on listing date
JM Financial Limited*	16	8
Axis Capital Limited*	23	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)**	20	7
Common issues of above BRLMs	36	8
Total	**95**	**25**

**Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs.*

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. Subsequent to the filing of the DRHP, our Company, in consultation with the BRLMs, undertook a private placement of (I) 543,789 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each at a price of ₹139.76 per Equity Share (including a premium of ₹137.76 per Equity Share); and (ii) 25,000,000 CCPS of face value of ₹2 each at a price of ₹139.76 per CCPS, aggregating to ₹ 3,570.00 million, as permitted under the applicable law **("Pre-IPO Placement")**. The details of the shares allotted in Pre – IPO Placement from the date of filing of DRHP till date of filing of the RHP are as follows:

(i) Equity Shares

S. No.	Name of Allottee	Nature of Shares Allotted	Date of Allotment	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each Allotted	Issue Price (in ₹)	Premium per Share (in ₹)	Percentage of pre-offer share capital of our Company (%)	Consideration Amount (₹ in million)
1.	Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd	Equity Shares	April 30, 2026	543,789	139.76	137.76	0.08	76.00

***Pre-Offer share capital refers to the issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity Share capital of the Company as on the date of the DRHP.*

(ii) CCPS

S. No.	Name of Allottee	Nature of Shares Allotted	Date of Allotment	No. of CCPS of face value of ₹2 each Allotted	Issue Price (in ₹)	Consideration Amount (₹in million)	Number of Equity Shares to be allotted post conversion	Number of Equity Shares to be allotted post conversion as % of pre-offer share capital of our Company (%)	Estimated Price per Equity Share based on conversion (in ₹)
1.	Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd	CCPS	April 30, 2026	25,000,000	139.76	3,494.00	25,000,000	3.89	139.76

Note The above allotted CCPS have been converted into Equity Shares in the ratio of 1:1 and thus on July 22, 2026, our Company allotted 25,000,000 Equity Shares to Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd.
***Pre-Offer share capital refers to the issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity Share capital of the Company as on the date of the DRHP.*

2. In addition to the above, our Promoters (also the Promoter Selling Shareholders) cumulatively transferred 8,943,903 Equity Shares for a consideration aggregating to ₹1,250.00 million, by way of a secondary sale to Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd. The details of Secondary Transfer by the Promoters (also the Promoter Selling Shareholders) from DRHP till date of filing of the RHP are set forth below:

S. No.	Name of Transferor	Name of Transferee	Date of Transfer	No. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each transferred	Transfer Price (in ₹)	Premium per Equity Share (in ₹)	Percentage of pre-offer share capital of the Company** (%)	Consideration Amount (₹ in million)
1.	Sathishkumar T	Jongsong Investments Pte. Ltd.	April 30, 2026	5,366,342	139.76	137.76	0.84	750.00
2.	Anitha S			3,577,561	139.76	137.76	0.56	500.00
	Total			**8,943,903**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**1,250.00**

***Pre-Offer share capital refers to the issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity Share capital of the Company as on the date of the DRHP.*

BASIS FOR OFFER PRICE

*(**"Basis for Offer Price"** on page 146 of the RHP has been updated with the above Price Band and disclosed below. Please refer to the website of the BRLMs:* www.jmfl.com, https://www.axiscapital.co.in/ and www.iiflcapital.com, *for the **"Basis for Offer Price"** updated with the above price band).* (You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of **JM Financial Limited)**

An indicative timetable in respect of the Offer is set out below:
Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors):

Bid/Offer Period (except the Bid/Offer Closing Date)	
Submission and Revision in Bids	Only between 10.00 a.m. and 5.00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST")
Bid/Offer Closing Date*	
Submission of electronic applications (online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate ASBA applications through UPI Mechanism where Bid Amount is up to ₹0.50 million)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications of QIBs and NIBs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 3.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 1.00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (syndicate non-retail, non-individual applications of QIBs and NIBs)	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 12.00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and NIB categories#	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 4.00 p.m. IST
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIBs and Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion	Only between 10.00 a.m. and up to 5.00 p.m. IST

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be 5.00 p.m. on the Bid / Offer Closing Date.*
 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Bidders can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/withdraw their Bids.

Bid / Offer Programme

EVENT	INDICATIVE DATE
Anchor Investor Bidding Date	Monday, August 10, 2026
Bid/Offer opens on	Tuesday, August 11, 2026
Bid/Offer closes on	Thursday, August 13, 2026#
Finalisation of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Friday, August 14, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors)/unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Monday, August 17, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialised accounts of Allottees	On or about Monday, August 17, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Tuesday, August 18, 2026

 # UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 5:00 p.m. on the Bid / Offer Closing Date.
** In case of any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/Offer Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the SEBI ICDR Master Circular and SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of our Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

ASBA# Simple, Safe, Smart way of Application!!!

Applications supported by blocked amount (ASBA) is a better way of applying to issues by simply blocking the fund in the bank account. For further details, check section on ASBA.

Mandatory in public issues. No cheque will be accepted.

UPI UNIFIED PAYMENTS INTERFACE

UPI-Now available in ASBA for Retail Individual Investors and Non - Institutional Investor applying in public issues where the application amounts is upto ₹ 5,00,000/-, applying through Registered Brokers, Syndicate, DPs and RTAs. UPI Bidder also have the option to submit the application directly to the ASBA Bank (SCSBs) or to use the facility of linked online trading, demat and bank account. Investors are required to ensure that the bank account used for bidding is linked to their PAN. Bidders must ensure that their PAN is linked with their Aadhaar and that they are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020, issued by the Central Board of Direct Taxes and the subsequent press releases, including press releases dated June 25, 2021 and September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

*ASBA has to be availed by all the investors except anchor investors. UPI may be availed by (i) Retail Individual Investors in the Retail Portion; Eligible Employees in the Employee Reservation Portion (ii) Non-Institutional Investors with an application size of up to ₹ 500,000 in the Non-Institutional Portion. For details on the ASBA and UPI process, please refer to the details given in ASBA form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to the section "Offer Procedure" beginning on page 451 of the RHP. The process is also available on the website of Association of Investment Bankers of India ("**AIBI**") and Stock Exchanges and in the General Information Document. ASBA bid-cum-application forms can be downloaded from the websites of the Stock Exchanges and can be obtained from the list of banks that is displayed on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi=yes&intmId=35 and https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebiweb/other/OtherAction.do?doRecognisedFpi= yes&intmId=43, respectively as updated from time to time. For the list of UPI apps and banks live on IPO, please refer to the link: www.sebi.gov.in. UPI Bidders Bidding using the UPI mechanism may apply through the SCSBs and mobile applications whose names appear on the website of SEBI, as updated from time to time. Axis Bank Limited and Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited have been appointed as Sponsor Banks for the Offer, in accordance with the requirements of the SEBI Circular dated November 1, 2018 as amended. For Offer related queries, please contact the BRLM on their respective email IDs as mentioned below. For UPI related queries, investors can contact NPCI at the toll free number: 18001201740 and mail Id: ipo.upi@npci.org.in.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL GET LISTED ON MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/Offer Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company may, in consultation with the BRLMs, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid /Offer Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/Offer Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/Offer Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Members of the Syndicate and by intimation to Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable.

The Offer is being made in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the Securities Contracts (Regulation) Rules, 1957, as amended **("SCRR")** read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations. This Offer is being made through the Book Building Process in accordance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations wherein not more than 50% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers (**"QIBs"** and such portion, **"QIB Portion"**), provided that our Company in consultation with the BRLMs may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis (**"Anchor Investor Portion"**). 40% of the Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds; and (ii) 6.67% for life insurance companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from the domestic Mutual Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion (other than Anchor Investor Portion) (**"Net QIB Portion"**). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to Mutual Funds only, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs (other than Anchor Investors), including Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Offer Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to QIBs. Further, (a) not less than 15% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders (out of which one third shall be reserved for Bidders with Bids exceeding ₹ 0.20 million and up to ₹ 1.00 million and two-thirds shall be reserved for Bidders with Bids exceeding ₹1.00 million) and (b) not less than 35% of the Net Offer shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders **('RIBs')** in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received from them at or above the Offer Price. All potential Bidders, other than Anchor Investors, are mandatorily required to participate in the Offer through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount **("ASBA")** process by providing details of their respective ASBA Account (as defined hereinafter) and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders (defined hereinafter), which will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks **("SCSBs")** or the Sponsor Bank(s), as the case may be, to the extent of their respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Anchor Investor Portion through the ASBA process. For details, see the section titled ***"Offer Procedure"*** on page 451 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Offer, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Offer. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with their Aadhar, and that they are in compliance with CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section **"*History and Certain Corporate Matters*"** beginning on page 263 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Offer. For further details, please see the section titled **"*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*"** beginning on page 529 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares

Amount of share capital of our Company and Capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised Equity share capital of the Company is ₹ 1,700,000,000 divided into 850,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 2 each and the authorised preference sharecapital of ₹ 50,000,000 divided into 25,000,000 preference shares of face value ₹2 each . The issued, subscribed and paid-up share capital of the Company is ₹ 1,335,657,578 divided into 667,828,789 Equity Shares of face value of ₹2 each. For details, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 97 of the RHP.

Names of signatories to the Memorandum of Association of our Company and the number of Equity Shares subscribed by them: The names of the initial signatories of the Memorandum of Association of our Company are: Sathishkumar T, Anitha S, C Shanmugasundaram, S Manoranjitham, Shivakumar C S, S Rathepriya, and G Lingeswaran. For details of the share capital history of our Company, please see the section titled ***"Capital Structure"*** beginning on page 97 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the Red Herring Prospectus are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to letters each dated September 3, 2025. For the purposes of the Offer, the Designated Stock Exchange is NSE. A signed copy of the Red Herring Prospectus has been filed with the Registrar of Companies, Tamil Nadu at Coimbatore **("RoC")** and the Prospectus shall be filed with the RoC in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus until the Bid/Offer Closing Date, see the section titled ***"Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection"*** on page 529 of the RHP.

Disclaimer Clause of the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"): SEBI only gives its observations on the Offer documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Offer or the specified securities stated in the Offer Documents. The investors are advised to refer to page 479 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer Clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange) : It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the Offer Document has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 482 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of NSE.

Disclaimer Clause of BSE : It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 482 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of BSE.

General Risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and Bidders should not invest any funds in the Offer unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Bidders are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Offer. For taking an investment decision, Bidders must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Offer have not been recommended or approved by the SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the Red Herring Prospectus. Specific attention of the Bidders is invited to the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** on page 23 of the RHP.

Our Company has entered into a policy agreement dated August 10, 2026 ("**Policy Agreement**") with International Finance Corporation ("**IFC**"), one of the Anchor Investors in the Offer, which has come into effect upon IFC making an investment in our Company and shall remain in effect until such time that IFC remains a shareholder in our Company. Pursuant to this Policy Agreement, our Company has agreed to comply with certain policy reporting and compliance requirements and covenants, including in relation to sanctionable practices, environmental and social covenants, insurance, anti-corruption, anti-harassment and compliance with UN Security Council Resolutions, in accordance with IFC's requirements. Any information required to be provided by our Company pursuant to the Policy Agreement shall be shared in compliance with the SEBI Insider Trading Regulations and the SEBI Listing Regulations and in case of any unpublished price sensitive information that may be required to be shared under this Policy Agreement, our Company shall, simultaneous with or prior to the disclosure to IFC, publish such information on the Stock Exchanges, as required under applicable law.

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS			REGISTRAR TO THE OFFER	COMPANY SECRETARY AND COMPLIANCE OFFICER
JM Financial	AXIS CAPITAL	IIFL CAPITAL	KFINTECH	**S Prakash** SF No. 43/1-4, Pattakaranpalayam, Perundurai, Erode District – 638 057, Tamil Nadu, India **Telephone:** + 91 424 2533248 **E-mail:** investor@milkymist.com
JM Financial Limited 7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030 **E-mail:** milkymist.ipo@jmfl.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** grievance.ibd@jmfl.com **Website:** www.jmfl.com **Contact person:** Prachee Dhuri **SEBI registration number:** INM000010361	**Axis Capital Limited** Axis House, 1st Floor, P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai – 400 025 Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4325 2183 **Email:** milkymist.ipo@axiscap.in **Investor grievance email:** complaints@axiscap.in **Website**: https://www.axiscapital.co.in/ **Contact person:** Tosit Agarwal **SEBI registration number:** INM000012029	**IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)*** 24th Floor, One Lodha Place, Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India **Telephone:** +91 22 4646 4728 **Email:** milkymist.ipo@iiflcap.com **Investor grievance email:** ig.ib@iiflcap.com **Website:** www.iiflcapital.com **Contact person:** Nitesh Yadav/ Pawan Kumar Jain **SEBI registration number:** INM000010940	**KFin Technologies Limited** Selenium Tower – B, Plot 31 & 32, Gachibowli, Financial District, Nanakramguda Serilingampally, Hyderabad - 500 032 Telangana, India **Tel:** +91 40 6716 2222 **E-mail:** milky.ipo@kfintech.com **Investor grievance e-mail:** einward.ris@kfintech.com **Website:** www.kfintech.com **Contact Person:** M. Murali Krishna **SEBI Registration No.:** INR000000221	Bidders may contact our Company Secretary and Compliance Officer, the BRLMs or the Registrar to the Offer in case of any pre-Offer or post-Offer related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Offer related queries and for redressal of complaints, Bidders may also write to the BRLMs and/or Registrar.

AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP: Investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled ***"Risk Factors"*** beginning on page 23 of the RHP, before applying in the Offer. A copy of the RHP is available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, the website of the Company at www.milkymist.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, Axis Capital Limited and IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.jmfl.com, https://www.axiscapital.co.in/ and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS: A copy of the Abridged Prospectus is available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Offer at www.milkymist.com, www.jmfl.com, https://www.axiscapital.co.in/, www.iiflcapital.com and www.kfintech.com, respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS: Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **Milky Mist Dairy Food Limited, Telephone:** + 91 424 2533248; **BRLMs: JM Financial Limited , Telephone:** +91 22 6630 3030, **Axis Capital Limited, Telephone:** +91 22 4325 2183 and **IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* , Telephone:** +91 22 4646 4728 and **Syndicate Member:** JM Financial Services Ltd, **Telephone:** + 91 22 6136 3400 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Offer. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Applications Supported by Blocked Amount (ASBA): Investors have to apply through the ASBA process. ASBA has to be availed by all the investors. For details on ASBA process, please refer to the details given in the ASBA Form and Abridged Prospectus and also please refer to ***"Offer Procedure"*** beginning on page 451 of the RHP. Further ASBA Application forms can be obtained from Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of banks that are available on website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in and website of Stock Exchanges at www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com. The investors are required to fill the Bid Cum Application form and submit the same to the relevant SCSBs at the specific locations or registered brokers at the broker centers or RTA or DPs. The SCSB's will block the amount in the account as per the authority contained in application form. On allotment, amount will be unblocked and account will be debited only to the extent required to be paid for allotment of shares. Hence, there will be no need of refund.

UPI: UPI Bidders can also Bid through UPI Mechanism.

Sub-Syndicate Members: Axis Securities Limited, 5paisa Capital Limited, Almondz Global Securities Limited, Ambit Capital Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, Eurekha Stock & Share Broking Services Limited, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, HDFC Securities Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Keynote Capital Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Kotak Securities Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Prabhudas Lilladher Private Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Securities Limited, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SBICAP Securities Limited, Sharekhan Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited and Yes Securities (India) Limited

Escrow Collection Bank and Refund Bank: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited **Public Offer Account Bank :** Axis Bank Limited **Sponsor Banks:** Axis Bank Limited and Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited

All capitalized terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them in the RHP.

For **MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED**
On behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
S Prakash
Company Secretary and Compliance Officer

Place: Erode,Tamil Nadu
Date: August 10, 2026

MILKY MIST DAIRY FOOD LIMITED is proposing, subject to applicable statutory and regulatory requirements, receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC, SEBI and the Stock Exchanges on August 4, 2026. The RHP is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, and is available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE and NSE at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com, respectively, on the website of the Company at www.milkymist.com and the websites of the BRLMs, i.e., JM Financial Limited, Axis Capital Limited and IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* at www.jmfl.com, https://www.axiscapital.co.in/ and www.iiflcapital.com, respectively. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk and for details relating to such risk, see *"Risk Factors"* beginning on page 23 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP and should instead rely on their own examination of our Company and the Offer, including the risks involved, for making any investment decision.

The Equity Shares offered in the Offer have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act of 1933, as amended (the "**U.S. Securities Act**") or any state securities laws in the United States and, unless so registered, may not be offered or sold within the United States, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws. Accordingly, such Equity Shares are being offered and sold (i) outside of the United States in offshore transactions in reliance on Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur; and (ii) within the United States to "qualified institutional buyers" (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act), pursuant to the private placement exemption set out in Section 4(a) of the U.S. Securities Act. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered, listed or otherwise qualified in any other jurisdiction outside India and may not be offered or sold, and Bids may not be made by persons in any such jurisdiction, except in compliance with the applicable laws of such jurisdiction. There will be no public offering in the United States.

Adfactors 253/26

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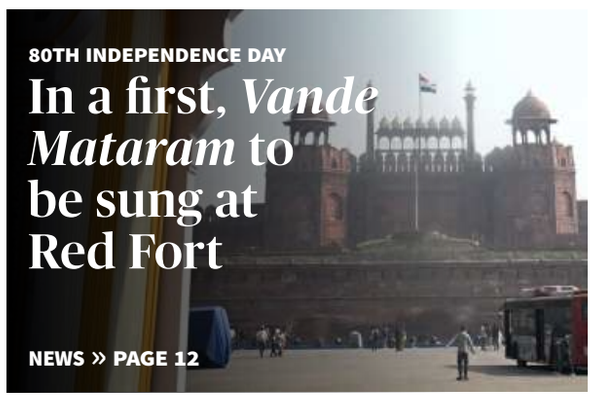

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INCESSANT RAIN
9 of a family killed as van swept away in M.P.
NEWS » PAGE 12

IN BRIEF

Suvendu admits police negligence in custodial death

KOLKATA
West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Monday visited the residence of TMC worker Birju Keot, who died in police custody on August 8. He said police negligence in the incident was "clear as daylight". » Page 4

Conversion of 2 women upheld by Allahabad HC

NEW DELHI
The Allahabad High Court last week directed the release of two adult Hindu women who claimed to have voluntarily converted to Islam. It held that their father had unlawfully confined them because of their religious choices. » Page 10

Protesters march to Jharkhand Assembly; 5 injured in clashes

Students, aspirants continue sit-in in Ranchi seeking cancellation of JSSC-CGL exam and CBI probe into irregularities; police deny use of force; former JPSC Chairman arrested; march comes day after State government agreed to cancel three exams

Suruchi Kumari
Aniket Singh Chauhan
RANCHI

Thousands of students and job aspirants from across Jharkhand marched towards the State Assembly in Ranchi on Monday, breaking through barbed barricades and reaching the Assembly gates as their indefinite strike over alleged irregularities in government recruitment examinations entered its 17th day.

At least five protesters were injured, including one who suffered a head injury, after the police resorted to lathi-charge and dispersed the crowd.

At present, the protesters are continuing their sit-in at the Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium in the capital, seeking resolution of their demands. The protesters are demanding cancellation of the Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission-Combined Graduate Level (JSSC-CGL) examination and an investigation by the Central Bureau of Investigation into alleged irregularities in the recruitment process.

The march came a day after the State government agreed to cancel three examinations, including the preliminary examination of the 14th Jharkhand Public Service Commission Combined Civil Services.

Meanwhile, former JPSC chairman L. Khiangte, who resigned on July 22 after the State CID took over the probe, was arrested in connection with the investigation.

Taking a stand: Protesters marching towards the Jharkhand Assembly in Ranchi on Monday. PTI

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'BATTLING FOR 26 YEARS'
» PAGE 10

Rahul slams police action; BJP steps up attack

PATNA
While the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, on Monday condemned the police action against protesting students in Jharkhand, the BJP stepped up its attack on the Hemant Soren-led government and dared the Congress to withdraw support to it if the party was serious about the students' demands. » PAGE 10

Ready for discussion on protests, says govt.

Sandeep Phukan
Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The Centre on Monday offered a full-fledged discussion in the Lok Sabha on the protests by students and the police action against them, with Union Home Minister Amit Shah set to reply to the debate.

However, the Opposition refused to relent, insisting that Mr. Shah clarify who ordered the use of pellet guns on the students in Delhi.

The Opposition also insisted that the Centre agree to a discussion and issue a statement on the alleged theft of donations at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

The Centre's offer to break the deadlock in the Lok Sabha came at a meeting of the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) in the afternoon, after which Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju said the government was ready for a debate on the agitations and the police action in different parts of the country.

"We have made it clear to the BAC of the Lok Sabha that the government is ready for a full-fledged discussion on the student and youth agitations that have been going on in different parts of the country as well as police action. The Home Minister will give a point-by-point reply to the debate on behalf of the government," the Union Minister said.

> The government is ready for a full-fledged discussion... The Home Minister will give a point-by-point reply to the debate
>
> **KIREN RIJIJU**
> Parliamentary Affairs Minister

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» PAGE 10

Over 100 killed as powerful earthquake strikes Colombia

Associated Press
BOGOTA

At least 111 people were killed and 87 injured in Colombia on Monday when a 7.4 magnitude earthquake struck the Latin American country, leaving several cities ravaged and trapping residents under debris of hundreds of collapsed buildings while their loved ones and rescue workers searched through the rubble.

The "highest magnitude earthquake in Colombia in the last decade" was followed by two aftershocks of magnitudes 2.8 and 4.8, the Colombian Geological Service said. The U.S. Geological Survey reported the tremor's epicentre in San Jose Del Palmar, about 400 kilometres west of capital Bogota. The tremors were felt in neighbouring Ecuador and Panama, though minimal damage was reported there.

A rescue worker searching for survivors in a collapsed building in Cali, Colombia. AP

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

State song must be sung first, states T.N. House resolution

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

CM Vijay termed the resolution 'historic'; the DMK demanded a special law to give it legal status

The Tamil Nadu Assembly on Monday unanimously adopted a resolution to make it mandatory to render the State Song, '*Tamil Thai Vazhthu* (Invocation to mother Tamil)', first before the commencement of programmes at all educational institutions, universities, government offices, public sector undertakings, and other public institutions in the State.

The resolution, moved by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, stated that *Tamil Thai Vazhthu* was an expression of respect for the Tamil language and culture. The resolution stated that the decision was in accordance with the linguistic and cultural rights guaranteed by the Constitution and aimed at preserving the cultural identity of Tamil Nadu.

Tamil is "one of the world's ancient classical languages" and Tamil civilisation represents one of the oldest cultural traditions in the world, it added. Recalling the history of *Tamil Thai Vazhthu*, taken from *Manonmaniam* written by Manonmaniam Sundaranar in 1891, the resolution stated that the government order stipulating that it be sung first at government functions came into effect on November 23, 1970. The DMK government issued an order on December 12, 2021, according recognition to it as the State song. The resolution added that the Home Ministry, in a letter dated July 9, 2026, "made certain observations regarding the singing of the State song". (It did not explain what these observations were.)

Later, in a social media post, Mr. Vijay termed the resolution "historic" and thanked all political parties for supporting it. The DMK, however, demanded a special law to give legal status to the resolution.

RELATED REPORT ON
» PAGE 4

Chiselled campaign

Taking the town: Pedestrians walking past a huge sculpture of a rhinoceros surrounded by lush tropical plants, meant to create awareness about endangered animals, at Malleshwaram in Bengaluru on Monday. J. ALLEN EGENUSE

'Series of technical failures' preceded 300-ft plunge by Air India flight; probe continues

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The "momentary loss in altitude" of the Air India flight from Phuket in Thailand to Delhi on August 4, which injured 17 people aboard, was preceded by a cascade of failures involving the aircraft's hydraulic and flight-control systems, said multiple sources familiar with the matter, contradicting the airline's initial attribution of the incident to turbulence.

Flight AI 2379, undertaken in an Airbus A320neo aircraft, experienced technical failures at cruising altitude nearly two-and-a-half hours after take-off. The sequence involved low-pressure indications and failures affecting hydraulic systems, according to a source who has reviewed the automated post-flight maintenance report. This was followed by an autopilot disconnect and simultaneous fault indications affecting both the left and right elevators, which are the control surfaces that move the aircraft's nose up or down.

The A320neo has three independent hydraulic systems that power critical functions. The maintenance report records failures and warning indications in the systems, occurring either individually or in combinations, but affecting all three of them, according to the source. The report recorded nine such messages within one minute. Several pilots described the near-simultaneous failure of three of the hydraulic systems as extremely rare.

The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau (AAIB) is probing the incident and has classified it as 'serious'. An Airbus team is expected to arrive on Tuesday to assist with the AAIB probe, while France's aviation safety investigation authority, the Bureau of Enquiry and Analysis for Civil Aviation Safety, will also join the investigation.

An injured passenger of Air India flight AI 2379 being assisted by a medical personnel after arriving in New Delhi on August 4. ANI

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Rights groups call for overhaul in hearings by apex court-appointed panel on Aravalis

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Civil rights groups in Rajasthan have called for an overhaul in the process of hearings by the Supreme Court-appointed high-powered committee on the Aravali hill range to ensure "meaningful and inclusive" public participation. The panel is now visiting the hill regions in Delhi, Haryana, and Rajasthan.

The Supreme Court has directed the committee to conduct an independent review of the Centre's report on the definition and delineation of the Aravali hill range and address "critical ambiguities" in the findings. The panel will examine the overall ecology of the region and its impact on people's lives and socio-economic conditions. It has to submit its report by August 31.

'Token tour'

"Such an assessment is simply not possible through what amounts to a token tour of nine districts in just four days," read a statement issued by the rights groups.

The committee has conducted public hearings in places such as Alwar and Ajmer. The People's Union for Civil Liberties (PUCL) and other groups said the mining lobby dominated the hearings and the administration did not make any meaningful effort to inform or involve locals.

PUCL-Rajasthan president Anant Bhatnagar said if the panel fails to make its process genuinely participatory and inclusive, people's groups will organise their own public hearings at different locations across the Aravali region.

Meanwhile, Akhil Bharatiya Vanavasi Kalyan Ashram, a Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh-affiliated social welfare organisation, has written to the committee raising several issues over its public consultation notification, including not providing enough time to submit comments and failing to reach rural communities.

The panel is visiting hill regions in Delhi, Haryana, and Rajasthan. ANI

INBRIEF

20,000 personnel, anti-drone systems in place for I-Day

Delhi Police has tightened security around Red Fort and along VIP routes ahead of the Independence Day. Around 15,000-20,000 personnel, besides personnel from the Rapid Action Force and the Border Security Force, have been pressed into service. Over 1,000 CCTVs and number-plate recognition systems, along with three facial recognition systems and anti-drone systems will monitor have also been deployed, said a senior officer.

828 principal, vice-principal posts vacant in govt. schools

As many as 828 posts of principals and vice-principals are lying vacant in Delhi government schools, according to a Union Public Service Commission recruitment advertisement. The vacancies comprise 124 principal and 704 vice-principal posts. The Directorate of Education runs around 1,090 schools. Of the 950 sanctioned posts of principals and 1,670 posts of vice-principals, 50% are earmarked for direct recruitment. PTI

HC gives Kejriwal 4 weeks to reply to pleas against acquittal

The Delhi High Court on Monday gave former Chief Minister Arvind Kejriwal four weeks to respond to Enforcement Directorate (ED) pleas challenging his acquittal in two cases related to non-compliance with summonses in the excise policy case. Justice Manoj Jain said the pleas were likely to be listed in September. The ED alleged that Mr. Kejriwal deliberately avoided joining its probe. The trial court, however, held that ED had failed to prove intentional disobedience. PTI

CM tables CAG report on decline in infrastructure investment under AAP

Subsidies rose by ₹3,222 cr. or 172.48% from 2015-25, leaving little space for capital expenditure, finds audit report; AAP MLAs seek Sood's resignation over 'irregularities' in free bicycle scheme

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday tabled a Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India report in the Assembly that flagged a "declining trend" in capital expenditure and a reduction in infrastructure investment during the Aam Aadmi Party's (AAP) tenure in Delhi.

Earlier in the day, AAP MLAs arrived at the Assembly on bicycles wearing T-shirts calling for the resignation of Education Minister Ashish Sood over "irregularities" in the purchase of bicycles under the Vidya Vahini Yojana.

Meanwhile, the CM distributed bicycles to 200 Class 9 girls under the scheme.

"Investment in girls' education is an investment in the bright future of society. The government is continuously working to ensure that girls in Delhi have access to education, modern facilities and equal opportunities to move forward," she said.

CM Rekha Gupta and other Ministers with beneficiaries of the Vidya Vahini Yojana at the Delhi Assembly on Monday. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Cost of subsidies

The audit report on 'State Finances for the year 2024-25' stated: "Capital expenditure during the period 2015-25 showed a declining trend ranging from 7% to 15% of total expenditure, reflecting constraints in infrastructure investment and capital formation."

"Capital expenditure has shown a declining trend rather than consistent growth, indicating reduction in the GNCTD's investment in long-term assets and infrastructure," it added.

The report noted that subsidies increased by ₹3,222 crore (172.48%) during 2015-25, mainly due to a ₹2,033 crore (128.83%) rise in electricity subsidies.

During this period, the government's revenue expenditure grew by 88.38%, largely owing to "committed costs and subsidies", which left limited fiscal space for capital investment, it observed.

Two Bills tabled

The government also tabled two Bills in the House.

Mr. Sood, who also holds the Urban Development portfolio, introduced the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (Amendment) Bill, 2026 to revise the cut-off date for a cluster to be considered a slum for rehabilitation from January 1, 2006 to January 1, 2026 while Information Technology Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh introduced the Delhi (Right of Citizen to Time Bound and Ease of Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026.

Both Bills are expected to be discussed and passed in the ongoing session.

Gupta defends 3-child limit for Lakshmi Yojana beneficiaries

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday defended the three-child limit for beneficiaries of the government's Lakshmi Yojana, which provides monthly aid of ₹2,500 to women aged 21 to 60, saying the condition is meant to protect women's health.

Ms. Gupta was responding to criticism from Aam Aadmi Party national convener Arvind Kejriwal, who questioned the need for the cap, citing Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh chief Mohan Bhagwat's remarks urging Hindus to have "as many children as possible".

"If a family wants to expand, it will not stop after listening to Rekha Gupta. Nor will it expand if Mohan Bhagwat says so. People make decisions about family planning according to their own needs," the CM said in the Assembly.

She added, "No woman is a machine for giving birth. Her health is extremely important to us."

'Stray cattle situation alarming': Speaker asks MCD to submit report

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Speaker Vijender Gupta on Monday referred the issue of stray cattle on city streets to the Assembly's Committee on the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) and sought a report from the corporation on the action taken to address the problem.

The issue of stray cattle was raised in the Assembly by Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA Harish Khurana, who drew attention to cattle being repeatedly left on roads in parts of Delhi, including by unauthorised dairy operators after milking. MLAs from the Aam Aadmi Party also raised concerns over illegal dairies and the abandonment of cattle on roads.

Terming the stray cattle situation "alarming", Mr. Gupta said the problem was becoming severe by the day and required immediate action to ensure the safety of citizens as well as the welfare of the animals. He directed the MCD to inform the Assembly of the action being taken and sought a detailed report from MCD Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on the number of cow shelters, their available space and capacity, arrangements for accommodating rescued cattle, the procedure followed after cattle are impounded, and action taken against those responsible for leaving them on public roads.

The Speaker observed that cattle roaming freely on roads were contributing to accidents and serious public inconvenience.

BJP MLA Harish Khurana raised the issue of stray cattle, in the Assembly. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

'Organised system'

He said the manner in which cattle were being left on the streets suggested that an "organised system" was behind it.

Taking cognisance of the Assembly proceedings, MCD Standing Committee chairperson Satya Sharma wrote to Mr. Khirwar demanding that officials be directed to ensure an effective and regular system for removing animals found on roads and shifting them to designated cow shelters and other suitable locations. Ms. Sharma said the presence of animals on roads affected traffic and created the possibility of accidents and other public safety concerns, and directed that sensitive locations be identified for special monitoring.

She said sanitation and the removal of stray animals from roads were among the MCD's primary responsibilities and called for regular review of actions taken on both issues.

2,500 homeless children mapped across city

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Delhi Police has mapped around 2,500 homeless children found begging in public places and at major road intersections to support the 'Child Beggar-Free Delhi' campaign announced by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on August 8.

The survey was conducted by the Special Police Unit for Women and Children (SPUWAC) from July 1 to July 31 as part of 'Child Safety Month'.

Deputy Commissioner of Police (SPUWAC) Neha Yadav said the survey focused exclusively on children who were completely shelterless, with most of them found in west Delhi.

The children's latitude and longitude coordinates, and photographs will be shared with the Department of Women and Child Development and the Delhi Commission for Protection of Child Rights. The campaign will address their homelessness and vulnerability to crime, including being forced or drawn into activities such as snatching or working as couriers for drug peddlers.

Gurugram woman held for assault on domestic help; released on bail

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

Gurugram Police arrested a 52-year-old woman on Monday for allegedly assaulting and forcibly restraining her domestic help at her apartment in DLF Camellias in Sector 42, Gurugram.

The woman was booked on charges of voluntarily causing hurt and wrongful confinement.

She was later released on bail.

The arrest came after a team from the Sushant Lok police station took *suo motu* cognisance of a video purportedly showing the abuse that went viral on social media.

In a purported video of the incident, the accused, 52, can be seen hitting the victim repeatedly and pulling her hair

In the purported 90-second video, believed to have been recorded secretly by a neighbour, the accused can be seen hitting the victim repeatedly and pulling her hair.

The incident took place on July 24 at the DLF Camellias on Golf Course Road, said a senior police officer.

Preliminary probe

According to the preliminary investigation, the woman allegedly assaulted her domestic help following a work-related argument. The domestic help subsequently quit the job on July 27.

Further investigation is under way, and additional action will be taken in accordance with the law, the officer said.

Man, 34, dies while cleaning manhole

Press Trust of India
FARIDABAD

A sanitation worker died while another was left critically injured after entering a manhole outside a factory in Faridabad's Sector 25 on Monday, said the police.

Aslam, 34, died on the spot, while Bunty, 37, was admitted to a hospital. Police said the two had entered the manhole without safety gear and began suffocating soon after. Aslam's family alleged negligence by the factory owner. Police said a case would be registered after investigation.

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

INVITATION FOR TENDER (Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invite tenders in Two Stage Tender System from Eligible Contractors for the below mentioned works.

Office of The Chief Engineer (UWP), 5th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, KG Road, Bangalore-560009.

Sl. No.	Name of Work	Amount Put to Tender / EMD
No: BWSSB/CE(UWP)/ACE(UWP-1)/DCE(UWP)/TA/930/2026-27		**Date:10.08.2026**
1	Providing and Commissioning of Biogas Engine at 60 MLD STP at Challaghatta Valley Coming Under EE(WWM-TV) Division. (3rd Call).	Rs. 405.82 Lakhs / Rs. 6.09 Lakhs

For the above work Last date and time for Receipt of tenders will be on **25.08.2026 upto 17.00 hrs**. The bids will be opened on: **27.08.2026 at 11.00 hrs**.

Sd/- Chief Engineer (UWP)

Office of The Chief Engineer (North), 6th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, KG Road, Bangalore-560009.

No: BWSSB/EIC/CE(N)/ACE(WWM-N)/DCE(N)/TA(N)/2445/2026-27		**Date: 10.08.2026**
2	Work Shifting of UGD pipeline for construcution of approach road at LC 148 &152(Hebbal & Lottegollahalli).	Rs. 297.70 Lakhs / Rs. 4.47 Lakhs

For the above work Last date and time for Receipt of tenders will be on **27.08.2026 upto 16.00 hrs**. The bids will be opened on: **28.08.2026 after 16.00 hrs**.

Sd/- Chief Engineer (North)

The detail regarding the tender & participation in the e-procurement portal process can be obtained by logging on to **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.** For further details contact the below signed office during working hours.

DIPR/CP/2083/NR/2026-27

Timings

DELHI

TUESDAY, AUG. 11			
RISE	05:48	SET	19:04
RISE	03:52	SET	18:13
WEDNESDAY, AUG. 12			
RISE	05:49	SET	19:04
RISE	05:03	SET	18:55
THURSDAY, AUG. 13			
RISE	05:49	SET	19:03
RISE	06:12	SET	19:32

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	35	28
Safdarjang	35	28
Palam	34	26

Delhi Palam Today
32°C The weather will be little warm but uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of moderate rain and thundershower to occur.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
33°C The weather will be warm. Spell of light to moderate rain and thundershower to occur. Night will be comfortable.

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₹2,574 cr. water supply project gets 'in-principle' nod

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh on Monday said a Union Finance Ministry committee has given an 'in-principle' approval to the ₹2,574 crore Asian Development Bank-assisted Wazirabad Water Supply Improvement Project.

"For the people of Delhi, water is a daily necessity. Our responsibility is to ensure that the infrastructure behind every tap is strong, modern and reliable. The Wazirabad project is a major step in that direction. We are not planning only for today; we are building a water system that can serve Delhi for decades," said the Minister.

The project, which was conceptualised in 2013, remained stuck for several years before being revived, said a senior official.

Under the project, old, damaged and undersized pipelines are set to be replaced while new transmission and distribution lines will be laid wherever required, the official said, adding that the existing networks will be interconnected to improve pressure, distribution and reliability.

"The Wazirabad water treatment plant, underground reservoirs, pumping infrastructure and distribution network will be upgraded," said Mr. Singh.

He added, "House service connections will be improved and regularised while areas without official water connections will be brought into the planned network as infrastructure is expanded."

Government of Punjab
(Department of Health & Family Welfare)

Bid Ref No:- E-tender/PHSC/Proc/2026/41

The Punjab Health Systems Corporation, SAS Nagar (Mohali) invites online bids for the Rate Contract of Two Years for the supply of **various types of Drugs under EDL** as per list enumerated in the tender document available on the website **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**.

Date, time and place of pre bid conference	:	17.08.2026 at 11:30 am in the Committee Room of Punjab Health Systems Corporation, Punjab School Education Board Building, 2nd Floor, E-Block, Mohali-160062. Phone No. 0172-2232245, 2232247
Closing Date and Time	:	01.09.2026 till 11:30 am

For details log on **https://eproc.punjab.gov.in**).

Note : Any Corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only & shall be considered as valid notice to all the prospective bidders. No separte communication shall be given.

--sd--
MANAGING DIRECTOR
PHSC Mohali

1722/12/2026-27/14067

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB **TENDER NOTICE**

SR. NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK/ NOTICE/ TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN LACS	NODAL OFFICER / CONTACT / EMAIL
1.	Principal Resident Commissioner, Punjab Bhawan, New Delhi	Supply of Fresh Chicken and A-Grade Eggs.	11/08/2026 24/08/2026	10.00 Thousand	9871155820 punjabbhawan@gmail.com
	FOR FURTHER INFORMATION AND CORRIGENDUM & ADDENDUM IF ANY, KINDLY VISIT: https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/, www.punjab.gov.in				**RO Number: 1001/12/2026-27/14098**

J&K Bank
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Jammu & Kashmir Bank Limited
Technology & Development Department
Corporate Headquarters
M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001 J&K

Online Request for Proposal (e-RFP) For Selection of Consultant for providing consultancy services to Government of J&K for IFMS (Integrated Financial Management System)

RFP Notice along with complete documents outlining the minimum requirements can be downloaded from and BIDs can be submitted on the Banks' e-Tendering Portal https://jkbank.abcprocure.com w.e.f. August 10, 2026 16.00 Hrs. Tender Document can also be downloaded from Bank's Official Website https://jkb.bank.in/tenderNotice. Last date for submission of Bids is August 24, 2026, 17.00 Hrs.

e- RFP Ref JKB/CHQ/T&D/Consultant-Govt-IFMS/2026-1844
Dated: 07-08-2026

Registered office : Corporate Headquarters, M.A.Road, Srinagar 190001, Kashmir, India
CIN: L65110JK1938SGC000048 ; **T :** +91 (0)194 2481 930-35 ; **F :** +91 (0)194 248 1928;
E : info@jkbmail.com ; **W :** https://Jkb.bank.in

JAIPUR VIDYUT VITRAN NIGAM LIMITED
Office of The Superintending Engineer (TW), Old Power House Premises, Near Ram Mandir Bani Park, Jaipur-302006, TELE FAX NO. 0141-2201022
Regd. Office: Vidyut Bhawan, Jyoti Nagar, Jaipur 302005
Website: http://energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jvvnl, Email: setw@jvvnl.org

E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are hereby invited in two parts (Techno-commercial bid and Price bid) from eligible bidders for the work of Execution of deposit works, including the Supply, Erection, Installation, Testing, and Commissioning of materials/equipment for the construction of 33/11 KV sub-stations, 33 KV & 11 KV overhead Line, laying of 33 KV and 11 KV underground XLPE Cable, construction of 33 KV Bay, 11 KV Bay and shifting of 33 KV & 11 KV line, Metering under Kota circle on turnkey basis against TW/TN-631. Participating bidders can download complete set of bidding documents from e-procurement portal http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in. Last Date/Time for receipt of online bids through e-procurement portal is 25.08.2026 up to 05:00 PM. For further details regarding Works, Tender Notifications & Specifications please visit website **http://www.eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://www.sppp.rajasthan.gov.in & http://energy.rajasthan.gov.in/jvvnl.**

UBN : VVN2627WLOB00330

Raj.Samwad/C/26/9160 JPR-3207 (2026) SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER (TW)

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Despite the rain, students turned out in large numbers for the book discussion held outside the School of Social Sciences 2. ASHNA BUTANI

Day after JNU nixed discussion on Khalid's book, students' union holds event outdoors

Ashna Butani
NEW DELHI

A day after Jawaharlal Nehru University (JNU) cancelled permission to hold an auditorium discussion on a book by former student Umar Khalid, the students' union went ahead with the plan and held the talk outdoors on Monday.

Despite the rain, students turned out in large numbers for the event held from 3 p.m. to 5 p.m. outside the School of Social Sciences 2 to discuss *Fractured Communities: Adivasi Histories and the Politics of Power*.

The book discussion was held amid protests by the RSS-linked Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), whose members chanted slogans calling Mr. Khalid a "terrorist".

The former JNU student is lodged in Tihar jail in the 2020 north-east Delhi riots 'larger conspiracy' case and has been awaiting trial for nearly six years. Some students raised objections to the absence of tribal community members from the panel to discuss a book on Adivasis.

'Hypocritical stance'

Students from other colleges also attended the discussion. Delhi University student Aryan Singh said while he was at first sceptical about travelling all the way due to reports about the last-minute cancellation, he decided to travel anyway. "I had to turn up because he [Mr. Khalid] has been waiting six years for a trial. It is hypocritical that the same JNU where he completed his research is trying to erase his thesis," he said.

ABVP member Rajeshwar Kant Dubey said, "We have clarified our stance. If the government thinks that Umar Khalid is a terrorist, then who is the JNUSU to give him a clean chit?"

On Sunday, the administration announced the cancellation of the talk at the School of Social Sciences 1 auditorium, citing "non-disclosure of full facts about the programme".

The move invited criticism from the JNUSU.

First round of Manipur govt.'s talks with UNC 'fruitful, an icebreaker'

Both sides agree to continue discussions to find solutions to the issues raised by the Naga apex body, including abrogation of SoO pact; won't lift blockade until demands are met, says UNC chief

Press Trust of India
SENAPATI/ IMPHAL

The first round of talks between the Manipur government and the United Naga Council (UNC) was "fruitful and cordial", with both sides agreeing to continue discussions to find solutions to the issues raised by the Naga apex body, a government spokesperson said on Monday.

A delegation of Ministers and nine MLAs, led by Deputy Chief Minister L. Dikho and Home Minister Govindas Konthoujam, held talks with the UNC representatives at the Senapati district headquarters.

The UNC has been demanding abrogation of the Suspension of Operations (SoO) pact with Kuki militant groups, declaration of the Kuki National Front-President (KNF-P) as a terrorist organisation, removal of the Deputy CM, and arrest of KNF-P cadres allegedly involved in the killing of six Naga civilians.

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand holding a meeting with a delegation of the United Naga Council in Imphal. FILE PHOTO

Government spokesperson Thokchom Radheshyam described the meeting as an "icebreaker" and said further rounds of talks would be held. "Today, the United Naga Council and the Manipur government representatives, led by Mr. Dikho and Mr. Konthoujam, came to Senapati to discuss and find solutions to several issues. We had fruitful and cordial discussions. This is the first round of discussions and a series of talks will follow to find a solution," he said.

On the demand for abrogation of the SoO agreement, he said, "That is the policy of the government of India. Manipur is part of India and we have to go by the policy and decision of the Centre."

UNC chief Ng Lorho, however, said the group would not lift its blockade of national highways until its four-point charter of demands is fulfilled.

'Bringing peace'

"We discussed with the Ministers and the legislators the way forward on how to bring peace. We discussed our four-point charter of demands and we stick to it," Mr. Lorho said after the meeting.

The UNC chief warned that the organisation could take "more stringent actions" if its demands are not met. He said further talks should be held in Senapati and not Imphal.

NRC ID: SC seeks reply from Centre, Assam

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday sought responses from the Union government and the State of Assam to petitions for issuance of identity cards to persons included in the National Register of Citizens (NRC) of August 2019.

The Bench comprising Justices P.S. Narasimha and Alok Aradhe sought the replies on petitions filed by the Jamiat Ulema-i-Hind, the Assam Sankhyalaghu Sangram Parishad, and others. Senior Advocate Kapil Sibal, for the Jamiat, said the Centre and the State were yet to respond despite issuance of notice by the Supreme Court.

Senior advocate Manish Goswami, for former NRC coordinator Hitesh Dev Sarma, sought re-verification of the NRC list. He contended there were several inaccuracies in the list.

The petition stated that the appeal process had not commenced for those who were excluded from the NRC. Over 3.11 crore people on the NRC list have not received their national identity cards while about 19 lakh were excluded from the register.

"The exercise is virtually at a standstill as the follow-up steps – issuance of National Identity Cards to included persons – have not been undertaken," a petition by the Assam State Jamiat Ulama, represented by senior advocate M.R. Shamshad, stated.

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M ND-NDE

INBRIEF

SC to hear plea against Ram Rahim's acquittal in 2002 case

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to hear a plea against the Punjab and Haryana High Court order acquitting Dera Sacha Sauda chief Gurmeet Ram Rahim Singh in the 2002 murder case of a journalist. "This matter requires consideration," a Bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana said. The apex court posted the plea filed by Aridaman, son of the slain journalist, for final hearing in the week commencing November 16. The counsel appearing for Mr. Ram Rahim told the Bench that the State has not preferred any appeal challenging the High Court's order. PTI

Surrendered militants call off stir following govt.'s assurance

Two surrendered militant groups in Tripura on Monday called off their proposed national highway and railway blockade scheduled for August 13, following assurances from the State government, a leader said. The Joint Action Rehabilitation Committee and Joint Action Committee representing a group of surrendered militants, on August 6, had called for a protest demanding proper rehabilitation. "We have decided to postpone the protest following a request from the government to address our grievances," Jibanjoy Reang, convener of both organisations, said in Agartala. PTI

Suvendu admits police negligence in custodial death of TMC worker

Day after Mamata Banerjee's vehicle was attacked, CM visits family of Birju Keot; he orders probe by a magistrate, offers ₹10 lakh compensation to victim's wife; IO suspended, station in-charge transferred

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Monday visited the residence of Trinamool Congress (TMC) worker Birju Keot, who died in police custody at Halisahar in North 24 Parganas district, and announced compensation for his family.

Keot died in police custody on August 8, and his family has alleged that the police tortured him to death. The Chief Minister said a magistrate-level investigation would be conducted into the death in police custody "as per protocol" laid down for custodial death.

Mr. Adhikari said the investigating officer behind the arrest of the deceased has been suspended, and the officer-in-charge of the police station has been "closed" to Barrackpore Police lines. The State government has announced a compensation of ₹10 lakh and a job for the wife of the deceased.

The Chief Minister said the death had occurred in custody, and that police negligence was "clear as daylight". ANI

Complaint to CM

Mr. Adhikari said the death had occurred in custody, and that police negligence was "clear as daylight". Jenny Sharma Keot, wife of Birju Keot, and a former TMC councillor, said more than compensation, she wants justice for her husband. She submitted a complaint to the CM.

"I have expressed gratitude to the family on behalf of the government. They did not allow anyone to do politics over the death. The former Chief Minister [referring to Mamata Banerjee] came. But the family did not even meet her. The deceased's elder brother told the former Chief Minister that they want justice, and only the administration can grant the family justice. They have trusted the government and the administration. This is a big debt to us," the West Bengal Chief Minister said.

Vehicle attacked

Ms. Banerjee, the TMC chairperson and former CM, had visited the residence on Sunday. During the visit, her vehicle was attacked, and she claimed it was a conspiracy to kill her. Locals gathered at the site and raised slogans against Ms. Banerjee.

Mr. Adhikari said the police had provided Ms. Banerjee adequate protection, and the sloganeering was a result of public anger.

Supporters of Ms. Banerjee held protests across the city on Monday. Trinamool MLAs who have stayed with the former Chief Minister also staged a protest in the State Assembly over the attack.

Centre did not say T.N.'s State song must be sung last: ASG

Mohamed Imranullah S.
CHENNAI

There is no directive issued by the Centre with respect to the order in which the State song should be sung, the ASG said.

The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has not insisted that the State song *Tamil Thai Vazhthu* should be sung last, after the rendition of the national song *Vande Mataram* and the national anthem during official events, Additional Solicitor General (ASG) AR.L. Sundaresan told the Madras High Court on Monday.

Appearing before the first Division Bench of Chief Justice Sushrut Arvind Dharmadhikari and Justice G. Arul Murugan during the hearing of a public interest litigation petition, the ASG said the case had become infructuous since it had challenged a January 28, 2026 notification of the MHA, which had been replaced by a new notification on July 9.

Seeking a week's time to place the latest notification before the Bench, the ASG said: "The petitioner wants the *Tamil Thai Vazhthu* to be sung before the national song and the national anthem. But there is no issue at all. We are not saying that the State song must be sung at the last. We only say that if the national song and the national anthem had to be sung together, then in which order should they be sung."

When the Chief Justice felt nothing would survive to be decided in the case in view of the submission, the ASG replied: "Yes, we have just said the national song must be sung first, followed by the national anthem when they both have to be sung together. There is no directive issued by the Union with respect to the order in which the State song should be sung"

After hearing him, the judges directed the HC Registry to list the PIL petition after a week to enable the ASG to place the July 9, 2026 notification before the Bench. The case had been filed by Ananya Radhakrishnan of Chennai, who identified herself as a public-spirited individual.

Punjab passes nine Bills in a day; Oppn. calls it a 'display of majoritarian arrogance'

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Opposition parties in Punjab lashed out at the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government after nine Bills were passed in the House on Monday, describing the exercise as a "display of majoritarian arrogance".

The State Assembly passed nine Bills pertaining to various sectors, including education, infrastructure, taxation, and employment.

The Bill included the Punjab Common Infrastructure (Regulation and Maintenance) Amendment Bill, 2026, the Punjab Regulation of Fee of Un-aided Educational Institutions (Amendment) Bill, 2026, the Punjab Goods and Services Tax (Amendment) Bill, 2026, the Punjab State Outsourced Personnel (Transition to Contractual Engagement) Bill, 2026, the Punjab Panchayati Raj (Amendment) Bill, 2026 and the Punjab Protection of Trees Bill, 2026.

Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann during the Assembly session in Chandigarh. FILE PHOTO

The House also passed three Bills pertaining to universities, including the Cloud University, Hoshiarpur Bill, 2026, the MS Digital University, Patiala Bill, 2026 and the Physicswallah Digital University, Patiala Bill, 2026.

Bharatiya Janata Party's Punjab president Kewal Singh Dhillon called it "a gross insult to Punjab's legislative system and democracy". He said passing Bills that could have far-reaching consequences for the lives of the people of Punjab without giving legislators adequate time to read, understand, and scrutinise is not law-making. "Rather, it is a display of the arrogance of the majority," he said.

Punjab Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring in a post on X said: "On the very last day of the Assembly session, Congress MLAs were handed nine Bills this morning. This is nothing short of a joke with democracy."

SP fears BSP the most, says Akash Anand, asks voters to be wary

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) national coordinator Akash Anand on Monday claimed the Samajwadi Party (SP) fears his party the most.

"Samajwadi Party fears BSP the most. It was [party chief] Mayawati*ji* who worked the most for the uplift of Dalits. That's why SP members keep shouting 'PDA, PDA'," he said at a party workers' conference in Hathras, referring to the SP's Pichchda, Dalit, Alpsankhyank or Backwards, Dalits and minorities plank. "Mayawati*ji* always cautions people from all walks of life to be wary of the deceptive SP and its narrow casteist politics," added Mr. Anand.

The BSP leader also accused the Bharatiya Janata Party-led Uttar Pradesh government of failing on employment, education and law and order, and alleged that more than ₹7,000 crore had been spent on advertisements over the past decade to "hide its shortcomings". "More than four lakh government posts are lying vacant in the State while several competitive examinations witnessed paper leaks," he said.

BSP leader Akash Anand

Meghalaya's district council okays amendments to bar non-tribals from poll process

Press Trust of India
TURA (MEGHALAYA)

The Garo Hills Autonomous District Council in western Meghalaya on Monday approved amendments to its election rules that will bar non-tribals from voting or contesting council elections, while paving the way for a separate electoral roll for the Sixth Schedule body, officials said.

The amendments to Rules 128 and 129 were approved by the council to establish a separate electoral roll specifically for GHADC elections, replacing the practice of using the electoral roll prepared for Assembly election.

The amendments followed violent incidents in the Garo Hills region earlier this year after the authorities issued a notification seeking to bar non-tribals from contesting the GHADC election.

> The amendment marks a significant step in protecting the rights and interests of the tribal people of Garo Hills
> **M. DHORMONATH CH SANGMA**
> Chief Executive Member of the council

The Meghalaya High Court later cancelled the notification, while the State government postponed the elections, scheduled for April 10, in view of the violence that claimed two lives.

Under the amended rules, only persons belonging to Scheduled Tribes recognised by the Meghalaya government and fulfilling other prescribed conditions will be eligible to be included in the GHADC electoral roll.

"The amendment marks a significant step in protecting the rights and interests of the tribal people of Garo Hills," said Chief Executive Member of the council, M. Dhormonath Ch Sangma.

The amendment also follows a change approved by the council in March this year, which introduced Scheduled Tribe status as an eligibility criterion for contesting GHADC elections. The move also comes in line with the commitment made by Meghalaya CM Conrad K. Sangma to address the issue of a separate electoral roll for the GHADC.

Protectors turn predators: how son preference fuels female foeticide rackets in Maharashtra

Radheshyam Jadhav
KOLHAPUR

A man once tasked with saving Maharashtra's daughters has now been unmasked as one of their most prolific predators.

For decades, Dr. Chandrakant Gunda Gaikwad sat comfortably within the upper echelons of the State health establishment, serving as a district civil surgeon and assistant director. He was also part of the government's 'Save the Girls' campaign for years.

Retirement did not signal an end to his medical career, but marked the expansion of a dark underground enterprise. Dr. Gaikwad was arrested by the Kolhapur police on July 31 for allegedly orchestrating a sophisticated female foeticide ring. During interrogation, he allegedly admitted to performing around 200 to 250 illegal abortions, the police said.

The racket operated out of Kolhapur in western Maharashtra, the home district of State Health Minister Prakash Abitkar. The Minister called it a "serious matter" that a former health official was involved in such a crime. He announced that the State will soon introduce a new law to invoke the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act against female foeticide, ensuring that doctors, family members, pharmacists, and anyone else supporting the crime face prosecution.

However, when mediapersons pressed the Minister about how implicated doctors and individuals routinely escape punishment and continue running their rackets after securing bail, he had no concrete answer. It underscored a grim reality: culprits easily slip through the cracks and accountability remains elusive.

According to Sunanda Patil, an octogenarian and resident of Kolhapur, female foeticide "is nothing new". She said women face two choices: empty their wombs if it is a girl, or keep giving birth until a son is born. She chose the second option, delivering three daughters before finally having a son. She considers herself lucky that her husband stopped there.

Quiet tragedies

For daily wage worker Maloji Kharat and his agricultural worker wife Lankabai, the reality was starkly different. By 38, Ms. Lankabai had 21 pregnancies and struggled to recall the names of all her children. Of her 11 surviving children, nine are girls. The other 10 died either shortly after birth or during delivery. When their story was reported a few years ago, the couple vanished from public view.

Kolhapur Police personnel with Dr. Chandrakant Gaikwad (third from right) following his arrest on July 31. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Beed district in the Marathwada region has long carried a dark reputation for illegal abortion rings. The most notorious was run by Dr. Sudam Munde and Dr. Saraswati Munde from Parali who operated a sex determination racket for years.

In one of the most chilling revelations, investigators found that the Mundes fed aborted female foetuses to a pack of dogs to hide the evidence, reportedly aborting up to 20 female foetuses a day for decades.

Beed-based activist Manisha Tokale noted that it has been over a decade since the Munde case, yet illegal abortion networks continue to operate in secret. The issue makes headlines briefly when a case is uncovered, she said, before things slip right back to normal.

This generational pressure drives quiet tragedies across the State. After delivering two sons, Renu (name changed) became pregnant a third time. Her husband, a daily wage worker, expected another boy. Fearing that her family history of having only daughters meant she would carry the same genes, he routinely took her for ultrasound tests.

"We went, had a sonography, and the family suggested abortion," Ms. Renu said, without needing to specify that the third child was a girl. Phrases like "*khali karun ye* (empty it and come back)" or "*tapasun baghu* (let us check)" echo across both rural and urban Maharashtra. When she went to a private clinic in Beed for the abortion, the doctor botched the procedure. She said the clean-up was not done properly, leaving her with lasting physical pain and nowhere to turn for justice.

According to Roopa Shah, founder of the Kolhapur-based Dilasa Samajik Vishwast Sanstha, female foeticide happens everywhere in the State without exception.

Society's mindset has not changed, regardless of whether people live in rural or urban areas, or are rich or poor, she said.

Having spent three decades fighting crimes like child marriage and female foeticide, Ms. Shah feels conventional measures have utterly failed. Because the police, courts, administration, and government have not been able to stop these atrocities, she believes the time has come for women to take a stand themselves. "It is not easy though," she said.

Deep-rooted bias

The National Family Health Survey 2019-21 offers a window into the mindset of this social fabric. Maharashtra has shown a strong preference for sons. While 9% of women and 12% of men express a desire for more sons than daughters, only 4-5% of women and men want more daughters. A large majority of women and men wish to have at least one son while fewer desire at least one daughter. These figures capture a deep-rooted gender bias in the State, one that starts at birth and follows girls throughout their lives.

"Those who survive have to carry the burden of being a girl forever," said Dhondabai Ningule, a resident of Dharashiv district.

In Marathi households, names like Dhondabai, derived from *dhonda* (stone), or Nakushi (unwanted) are often given to girls born merely as stopgap arrangements until a son arrives, serving as a constant, grudging reminder from their families of their unwanted existence.

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INBRIEF

Telangana CM and Minister perform ritual for better rain

As the prospect of deficit rainfall looms large with less than two months remaining for the monsoon to recede, the Telangana government organised *Varuna Yagam,* a traditional ritual to invoke the blessings of Varuna, the rain God, in the Krishna and Godavari catchment areas on Monday. Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy and Irrigation Minister N. Uttam Kumar Reddy took part in the ritual, conducted by priests of the Yadadri Sri Lakshmi Narasimha Swamy temple.

Hindutva ideologue gets bail in derogatory remarks' case

A court in Kerala on Monday granted bail to Hindutva ideologue T.G. Mohandas in a case over alleged derogatory remarks he made in a YouTube video against students who protested at Jantar Mantar in Delhi. The Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Court in Thiruvananthapuram granted him conditional bail after directing him to appear before the investigating officer for three consecutive days. He was former head of the BJP's intellectual cell in Kerala.

Man kills daughters, attempts to end life in Bengaluru hotel

A 40-year-old man, a senior manager at a cab company, allegedly strangled his two minor daughters before attempting to end his life at a hotel near the Kempegowda International Airport at Bengaluru, Karnataka, on Monday, the police said. He was found in a critical condition and shifted to hospital by the hotel's staff. The police recovered a note in which he allegedly referred to marital disputes. *(If you are in distress, call TeleMANAS at 1-8008914416)*

SC to hear Tamil Nadu's plea on Cauvery dispute this week

Shortfall in release of river water has left farmers in perilous situation, says T.N.; it seeks judicial direction to Karnataka to implement CWMA order to ensure release of 3,500 cusecs for 15 days

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Tamil Nadu government on Monday sought an early hearing of its application over the Cauvery water allocation dispute with neighbouring Karnataka.

Appearing for Tamil Nadu, senior advocate C.S. Vaidyanathan highlighted before Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant that the deficit in allocation of the river water has left farmers in a perilous situation. The CJI listed the State's application for hearing on Thursday.

The State government sought a judicial direction to Karnataka to implement the July 30 decision of the Central Water Management Authority (CWMA) to ensure the release of 3500 cusecs for 15 days from its two reservoirs at Kabini and Krishnaraja Sagar.

The CJI listed T.N.'s application over the Cauvery water allocation row with Karnataka for hearing on Thursday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Tamil Nadu has approached the top court for the release of 4.536 tmc ft (at the rate of 3,500 cusecs for 15 days) on or before August 12.

The State urged the court to direct the CWMA to issue an appropriate direction to Karnataka to make good, on a pro-rata basis, the shortfall at the inter-State point of Biligundulu for the period from June 1 to August 12, and in this regard release 26.954 tmc ft of water forthwith. It further sought an order to the CWMA to monitor the flows in the reservoirs of Karnataka every 10 days and ensure stipulated monthly/daily releases at Biligundulu.

The State claims that Karnataka had continued to defy the orders of the Cauvery tribunal for allocation of water to its neighbour except a few times when there were inevitable surpluses in the reservoirs on account of floods.

Man dies after 'assault' by *kanwariyas* over mishap; cross-FIRs filed

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A 24-year-old driver, Mohd. Azeem, from Moradabad in Uttar Pradesh, died in a Delhi hospital on the night of August 4, four days after he was allegedly assaulted by a group of *kanwariyas* following a road accident near Brijghat in Hapur, the deceased's father has alleged.

As per the FIR lodged by Azeem's father, Mohd. Intezar, his son was driving a goods vehicle from Moradabad towards Delhi on July 31 when it collided with an autorickshaw driven by 19-year-old Mohd. Farman and ferrying several *kanwariyas* near the Brijghat toll plaza. "Following the collision, Farman and passengers Manish, Ankit, Lokesh, Shivam and two others assaulted my son severely," states the FIR.

Garhmukteshwar Station House Officer Devendra Singh said another FIR was registered on August 3 based on the complaint by Mr. Farman's father. "His father told us that Azeem turned his vehicle 'into a weapon', ramming his vehicle into the auto twice. He has alleged that Azeem ran the vehicle over Farman's abdomen and chest before fleeing. Farman is also admitted to a hospital. But now that Azeem is dead, we are initiating the process of filing a closure report in the FIR against him," Mr. Singh said, adding that the probe into the first FIR will continue.

A fifth of Telangana voters face exclusion

Swathi Vadlamudi
HYDERABAD

More than a fifth of the electors throughout Telangana are likely to be deleted in the draft electoral rolls to be published at the end of the enumeration phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in the State.

Around the same number of electors who submitted the form might receive notices from the office of the Electoral Registration Officers for verification.

The enumeration phase ended at midnight of August 10, after two extensions since July 24. Draft electoral rolls will be published after a week, on August 17. As at 6 p.m. on the final day, a total 73,47,075 enumeration forms have been categorised as Uncollectable, which, the Chief Electoral Officer C. Sudharshan Reddy has explained, are the forms not returned by the electors. They constitute close to 22% of the total State electorate.

Saini deflects SAD tie-up talk, says BJP's alliance is with the people of Punjab

The Hindu Bureau
CHANDIGARH

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday said the Bharatiya Janata Party's (BJP) alliance is with the people of Punjab, even as he asserted there was no need to view anyone's meeting with the Prime Minister through a political lens. He was replying to questions about the possibility of an alliance again between Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) and BJP for the upcoming 2027 Assembly election in Punjab against the backdrop of the meeting last week between Akali chief Sukhbir Singh Badal and Narendra Modi in New Delhi.

Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini

"The people of Punjab have now understood that the State's development and the welfare of its people are possible only through a double-engine government. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is the voice of the hearts of 140 crore countrymen. If anyone wishes to meet the Prime Minister, they are free to do so. There is no need to view anyone's meeting with the Prime Minister through a political lens," he said at a press conference here.

Even as leaders from both parties remained tight-lipped about the deliberations, speculation is rife that the former alliance partners could join hands again. The SAD and BJP were allies since the late 1990s; however, amid the controversy over the Centre's three farm laws that were later repealed, the Akalis - one of the BJP's oldest alliance partners - decided to break away from the NDA coalition in 2020.

11 people lose ₹1 cr. in fake treasure scam in Hyderabad; four arrested

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The promise of a buried treasure turned out to be coal, fake gold coins, and a well-rehearsed trick for 11 victims, who were allegedly cheated of nearly ₹1 crore by a four-member gang in Hyderabad, Telangana.

The Commissioner's Task Force, Shamshabad Zone, in coordination with the Rajendra Nagar police, busted the racket and arrested four persons who allegedly lured people with claims that they could identify and retrieve *Gupta Nidhulu*, or hidden treasure, buried beneath houses.

According to the police, the group approached people with claims that they possessed special knowledge to locate underground treasure. The accused allegedly convinced their targets that valuable treasure was buried beneath their residential premises. After obtaining their trust, they would dig the ground and plant a sack containing coal and duplicate gold-coated coins.

They would then tell the victims that the coal needed time to transform into gold and then leave the place with the money collected from them.

Task Force personnel seized two cars, an autorickshaw, two motorcycles, four mobile phones, 25 duplicate gold coins, 6 kg of coal, 4 kg of soil and puja material from the accused.

The police have urged the public to report about such gangs immediately to the police.

Flying to freedom

A six-month-old Indian vulture (*Gyps indicus*) being released at the Sri Ramadevarabetta Vulture Sanctuary in Ramanagara, Karnataka. The vulture had been rescued and treated by the People for Animals (PfA) Wildlife Hospital in coordination with the Forest Department. PTI

PMLA case after conviction for predicate offence doesn't amount to second trial: HC

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

When a person is convicted for offences under the Indian Penal Code (IPC) or other laws that are described as scheduled/predicate offences under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), the subsequent prosecution of such persons under the provisions of the PMLA does not amount to a second trial for the same offences, the Karnataka High Court said.

"The prosecution under the PMLA is neither the second trial for the same offence nor a Constitutional transgression. The offence under the PMLA derives its existence from the laundering of proceeds of crime, though emanating from the commission of predicate offence," the court observed.

Notes exchange scam

Justice M. Nagaprasanna passed the order while dismissing the petitions filed by 11 persons, who were convicted for various offences under the IPC, for looting some persons in 2016 in the guise of exchanging the demonetised notes, and cheating the people of several lakhs of rupees.

The petitioners were convicted and sentenced to imprisonment for six years in 2024 by the trial court, and their appeals against conviction are pending before the High Court.

"It is a prosecution of an independent statutory offence [under PMLA], in which the petitioners have to come out clean in a full blown proceeding before the special court, as the prohibition under Section 300 of the Criminal Procedure Code extends only to a second trial for the same offence and not to a prosecution for a distinct offence under another enactment," the High Court said while dismissing their petition.

No ambiguity in BJP's stand on Bidadi farmers, says Vijayendra

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A day after a video of his alleged comments on the Bidadi Township Project went viral embarrassing the party, Karnataka BJP president B.Y. Vijayendra said on Monday that there was no ambiguity within the party regarding protection of farmers' interests in Bidadi.

"The BJP will fight for the protection of farmers' land not only in Bidadi, but across the State," he told presspersons here.

'Symbolic' support

His response comes a day after the video of a conversation between Mr. Vijayendra and Minister Madhu Bangarappa went viral, in which the former is heard saying that Bidadi farmers are gradually accepting the compensation. He had termed the BJP's support to the farmers' cause as "symbolic."

B.Y. Vijayendra

Without directly referring to the controversial video, Mr. Vijayendra said there was no need for anyone to be confused about the Bidadi padayatra. He said he had spoken with Janata Dal (Secular) leader H.D. Kumaraswamy about the possibility of the BJP and the JD(S) jointly taking out the padayatra and Mr. Kumaraswamy had responded positively.

However, since the JD(S) had already announced the date, the BJP decided to extend symbolic support, he said, adding that there is no room for any confusion.

Mr. Vijayendra, who had skipped the inauguration of the padayatra to attend a party programme in Kolar and Chickballapur districts, clarified that there was no political reason behind it.

Karnataka has 6,805 charging stations for EVs, second-highest in country: govt. data

Darshan Devaiah B.P.
BENGALURU

Karnataka has emerged as one of India's leading States in electric vehicle (EV) charging infrastructure, with 6,805 electric vehicle charging stations (EVCS) installed as of July 29 this year, according to data by the Ministry of Heavy Industries.

The data, released in response to an unstarred question on August 7 in the Rajya Sabha, show that Karnataka has the second-highest number of installed EV charging stations in the country, marginally behind Maharashtra, which has 6,985 stations. Karnataka's tally is 180 stations lower than Maharashtra's and accounts for nearly 13% of the 52,718 charging stations installed across India.

Eco-friendly: Experts attribute Karnataka's success in the sector to the State's early and proactive policies. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Karnataka's charging infrastructure is also substantially higher than that of southern States. Tamil Nadu has 3,839 charging stations, Telangana 3,739 and Kerala 3,399. Andhra Pradesh has 1,976 stations and Goa 314. At the national level, Uttar Pradesh has 4,493 charging stations and Rajasthan 2,827. The reply shows wide variation among States, with several northeastern and smaller Union Territories having fewer than 100 stations.

However, the Ministry clarified that centralised data on the number of fast- and slow-charging stations are not maintained.

Meanwhile, experts attribute Karnataka's success in EV infrastructure to the State's early and proactive policy decisions, particularly its 2017 EV policy. "The extensive network of charging stations in Bengaluru demonstrates how infrastructure can help build consumer confidence. However, the focus must now shift towards improving interoperability, standardising charging tariffs and providing real-time information on charger availability to enhance the overall user experience," said transport expert M.N. Srihari.

Case for consensus

The government needs to build a consensus on delimitation

The monsoon session of Parliament is in its last week without any substantive deliberations or legislative outcomes. There may be several reasons for the stalemate, but at its core are the controversial FCRA amendments and the opacity around the government's delimitation proposals. Overall, it is as if the government views Parliament as an obstacle to be circumvented rather than a forum for deliberation and consensus-building on national issues. That is the attitude that offers no resolution to any question, while it may create winners and losers on some. But in the absence of good-faith conversations and consensus, what may appear to be a victory for the government or the Opposition at one moment could turn out to be a net loss for parliamentary democracy and the nation. A parliamentary majority is a necessary technicality, but democracy is not limited to that. The effort must always be to expand consensus and reduce conflict across the spectrum of opinion on any given issue. India, being as diverse as it is, naturally has multiple views, not only between the government and the Opposition but also within each side. Unfortunately, expressing and reconciling those opinions is given far less priority than marshalling the numbers to support any given move.

The impact of the forthcoming delimitation is going to be far-reaching; it must be preceded by as wide a consensus as possible. The country's representative system is on the cusp of a revision, but the government that is anxious to modify its timeline and terms also wants to be extremely secretive about it. Passing legislation with very little prior deliberation or parliamentary debate has become routine in recent years. Delimitation is a topic about which there is a great deal of misunderstanding and serious concern. A large segment of even the political class may be oblivious to its scope and implications. Rather than trying to change the laws regarding delimitation and the size of the Lok Sabha by somehow aggregating the required number of votes behind it, the government should circulate its proposals and receive feedback from all stakeholders. An all-party meeting, as demanded by the Opposition, can be a good start to the deliberations that should take place in the polity at large and inside Parliament. Anything that is technically legitimised through subterfuge will be seen by the public as such. It must be recalled that in 1976 and in 2001, under a Congress government and a BJP government, respectively, decisions with regard to delimitation were taken unanimously. The government and the BJP should once again take the initiative to build a consensus on delimitation for the sake of the nation's unity and progress.

Tracking nursing

A fully updated live nurses portal will be of immense benefit to the nation

For a country where the human resources in health care will always fall short of the recommended patient-professional ratio, it is important to make sure that every single resource is harnessed. However, government data tabled in the Lok Sabha have shown that the Nurses Registration and Tracking System, created over seven years ago, has registered less than a third of the total nurses in the country. Only 14.24 lakh of the 46.02 lakh registered nursing personnel have been enrolled, leaving 31.78 lakh outside the national system. Clearly, the move to create an accurate national registry and streamline registration-related services on a single platform for all nurses is far from yielding satisfactory results. There are also stark regional disparities, and unexpected performances with the large southern States (Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, and Andhra Pradesh) figuring among the laggers, while Bihar, Jharkhand and Odisha show between 80%-99% enrolment rates. The Indian Nursing Council has attributed the delays to issues rooted in jurisdiction, and federal tension, on the grounds that primary registration is legally the responsibility of individual State Nursing Registration Councils. To receive a National Unique Identity card and nurse passbook, nurses rely on verification by their respective State Nursing Councils. Further, the charge is that several State councils have resisted migrating fully to the central portal and continue operating independent parallel systems.

Poor nurse registration – irrespective of whether it is caused by incomplete digital tracking systems, outdated State registries, delayed licensing, or regional autonomy – has widespread consequences across health-care systems, apart from personally affecting nurses. For nurses, there will be delays in sanctioning their requests for inter-State transfer and credential verification for overseas employment. For the nation, without a centralised live registry that can provide a true measure of how many nurses (with specialisations) are available where, there might be artificial surpluses or deficits on paper, leading to less-than-ideal deployment of resources, and implementation of policy decisions. Fragmented registries also make it easy for unverified individuals, impersonators, or personnel with revoked licences to practise using fraudulent credentials, thus compromising patient safety. A live tracker would be of utmost use during public health emergencies – including disease outbreaks and natural disasters. Else, it could be impossible for state agencies to track, mobilise or deploy specialised nursing personnel to high-alert zones. Given the crucial complementary role, and in some areas, even the primary role that nurses play in the health-care system, efforts must be made to ensure that all nurses are brought into the portal.

English in India, a language that has earned its place

Y.L. Srinivas

Professor of English currently serving as the Vice-Chancellor of Sammakka Sarakka Central Tribal University, Mulugu,Telangana

What makes a language Indian? A recent observation by the Supreme Court of India has revived the debate over whether English can be considered an indigenous language of India. The debate over the place of English in India has often been framed as a contest between English and Indian languages. Such a binary is both historically misleading and politically unhelpful. The promotion of Indian languages such as Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Odia, Kannada, or Marathi need not – and should not – be predicated upon denying recognition or patronage to English. The future of India's linguistic diversity lies not in choosing one language over another but in nurturing multilingualism. English may not be an indigenous language in the same historical sense as Sanskrit or Tamil, yet, over two centuries, has acquired a legitimate claim to belong to India.

A language transformed

The strongest objection to treating English as an Indian language is that it arrived with British colonialism. It was introduced to facilitate administration, commerce, missionary activity, and what the colonial rulers described as their civilising mission. In its early history, English undoubtedly served the interests of the Empire. Yet, languages cannot be permanently imprisoned by the circumstances of their arrival. Their identities are continually reshaped by the people who speak them. Once English entered India, Indians appropriated it, transformed it, and made it serve Indian aspirations rather than colonial objectives.

By the early 19th century, English had already become an instrument of Indian political and intellectual expression. In 1823, Raja Ram Mohan Roy and his associates submitted one of the earliest petitions in English defending the freedom of the Indian-language press in Calcutta. Later in the century, Dadabhai Naoroji marshalled his famous "Drain Theory" in English to expose the economic exploitation of India under British rule. Swami Vivekananda addressed educated India in English through his celebrated lecture, 'My Plan of Campaign', delivered in Madras in 1897. Mahatma Gandhi himself translated *Hind Swaraj* into English, recognising that the language could carry Indian ideas to both national and international audiences. To deny English a place in India is, in some measure, to overlook the contributions of generations of Indians who employed the language to articulate Indian nationalism, social reform, and cultural renaissance.

After Independence, India indeed found a place for English. The Constituent Assembly debates on the language question adopted a balanced resolution. Moved by K.M. Munshi and N. Gopalaswami Ayyangar, it recognised Hindi as the Official Language of the Union and retained English for official purposes. Over the subsequent decades, English has evolved into one of the principal languages of Indian academic and administrative domains, including but not limited to the legislature, the executive and the judiciary.

> English is no longer colonial and has evolved into a language, shaped by how Indians speak, think, and imagine themselves

India has also recognised English as a language of Indian creativity. The Sahitya Akademi has treated English as one of the languages of Indian literature, conferring annual awards. Indian Writing in English has developed into one of the richest literary traditions in the postcolonial world. From R.K. Narayan, Mulk Raj Anand to Amitav Ghosh and Vikram Seth, Indian writers have demonstrated that English can express Indian experiences with authenticity, subtlety, and artistic distinction.

Reach and scale

It is often argued that only a small section of Indians speak English. This is not exactly the case. The Census of 2011 reports that nearly 129 million Indians chose English as a first, second or third language. These numbers make India one of the largest English-speaking countries in the world. Nearly 2,60,000 people reported English to be their mother tongue. A whopping 83 million identified it as their second language. About 46 million spoke it as their third language. Scholars observe that the number of Indians who possess at least a functional knowledge of English may well have further increased to the range of 180 million to 250 million given the rapid expansion of English-medium education over the last decade. These statistics suggest that English has become the language of aspiration for a large segment of the Indian society.

As an aspirational people, Indians invest considerable effort and money in education. Nearly 31,000 schools affiliated to the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) impart education primarily through English. So do the 3,000 schools which are affiliated to comparable boards such as the Council for the Indian School Certificate Examinations. Let us not forget that English is also the principal medium of education in all premier higher educational institutions of India.

In a wide range of professional fields that produce wealth and service, English has become the language through which India engages with the world. This is an advantage that India presently possesses over several other competing nations, and it would be wise for it to continue to invest its resources in further expanding the English language skills of Indians.

It also needs to be pointed out that India has Indianised English. Raja Rao spoke about it in the well-known Foreword to his novel *Kanthapura* way back in 1938. Just as Canada and Australia had fashioned their own versions of English, Rao felt, so would India. That prediction has been fully realised. Indian English today possesses its own pronunciation, vocabulary, idioms, and rhetorical conventions. It reflects Indian social realities and cultural sensibilities while remaining part of the larger global family of Englishes.

Taking root

This process of linguistic naturalisation is captured in V.K. Gokak's poem 'English Words': "O winged seeds! You crossed the furrowed seas/To nestle in the warm and silent earth./...You ripened into nectar in fruit-jars/That hung like clustered stars." Gokak's metaphor is striking. English words arrive as seeds from distant shores, but they do not remain foreign. They take root in Indian soil, acquire new life, and bear fruit that belongs as much to India as to anywhere else. A similar sensibility informs A.K. Ramanujan's 'Prayers to Lord Murugan', where an Indian poet employs English not as a borrowed medium but as a natural vehicle for expressing Indian mythology, philosophy, and devotion. Such works demonstrate that languages are ultimately shaped not by their origins but by the communities that inhabit them.

Ironically, many of the strongest advocates of Indian languages have themselves turned to English when addressing a pan-Indian or international audience. Kannada scholar and Jnanpith awardee V.K. Gokak argued for the unity of Indian literature through English in works such as *The Concept of Indian Literature* and *Pathways to the Unity of Indian Literature*.

Monolingualism has never been the historical reality of Indian society. India has always deeply cherished languages that Indians speak in their homes and among kith and kin. At the same time, they have spoken in other languages with considerable facility and comfort. English is not in competition with Hindi or Tamil. Rather it is a language that provides Indians with an already historically familiar bridge to connect with other language-speaking communities both within and beyond India.

It is not an important question, therefore, whether English is an indigenous language. It is not. More important is the realisation that through history and literature, constitutional practice and governance, and through everyday usage, English has earned the right to be regarded as one of modern India's own languages. It is useful to remember that English has long ceased to be the language of colonial rulers. It has evolved into one of the several languages in which Indians imagine themselves. Indian English belongs to India.

Do not write the obituary of international law yet

Jyoti Singh

Advocate based in Delhi and a former legal consultant to the Legal and Treaties Division, Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India

Is international law really dying? The question has become increasingly difficult to ignore. The ongoing conflicts in Ukraine and Gaza, instability in West Asia, violence against civilians, and the inability of international institutions to respond effectively, have led many to conclude that international law is no longer relevant.

International law was premised on the idea that relations between states should be governed not merely by power, but by rules and legal principles built on consensus. When wars still take place, the effectiveness of the system is naturally exposed to scrutiny. However, it would be too early to write an obituary for international law.

'It will prevail'

In July 2026, while addressing the International Law Commission recently, United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres remarked that "international law is under pressure – but it will prevail". The second half of the statement deserves as much attention as the first. International law undoubtedly faces serious challenges, but it continues to shape the conduct of states and remains the language through which international disputes are contested.

Paradoxically, wars actually demonstrate why international law still matters. Had it really become irrelevant, the states concerned would not bother to justify their actions by referring to international law. They invoke the UN Charter, sovereignty, territorial integrity, self-defence and international humanitarian law. Even states accused of violating international law rarely argue that the law itself is meaningless. Rather, they claim that their actions are consistent with it. A legal system under which states continue to justify their conduct cannot simply be described as dead.

International law scholars Abram Chayes and Antonia Handler Chayes argued that states often comply with international law not because they are threatened with sanctions, but because they are influenced by the dynamics created within the treaty regimes to which they belong. It is a pertinent observation even today. The significance of international law cannot be determined only by instances of violation; it also lies in providing a framework through which state conduct is assessed, disputes are addressed and cooperation is sustained. The difficulty is that compliance goes unnoticed whereas violations dominate headlines.

> International law remains relevant in a troubled world

The quiet power of international law

The quiet accomplishments of international law are visible every day. Aircraft fly across international boundaries because states comply with international aviation regulations. Ships sail across seas because of international maritime law. Diplomacy functions because governments observe established legal norms. International trade, communications and travel continue because states honour thousands of international obligations. Even as armed conflicts continue to dominate headlines, states still negotiate multilateral legal agreements. Recent endeavours such as the High Seas Treaty, international efforts towards pandemic preparedness, and the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime demonstrate that states continue to rely on international law. International law also affects individuals. The moment a person crosses an international border, international law begins to matter. The recognition of passports, consular assistance, international air travel and the protection of refugees all depend upon international legal rules. We often notice international law only when it fails, but millions of people rely on it every day.

The continued relevance of international law is perhaps most evident in the way states seek peace, which is built through negotiations, commitments and legal arrangements. Whether these are described as peace agreements, ceasefire arrangements, diplomatic understandings or negotiated settlements, even adversarial states recognise the need for legal commitments that establish expectations and obligations for the future. India provides a good example in this respect. India's experience with the Indus Waters Treaty demonstrates that even during periods of political discord, legal frameworks continue to provide a basis for engagement between states. That is precisely why international law remains indispensable for India and the wider Global South. The problems of climate change, pandemics, cyber-attacks, and economic instability cannot be addressed unilaterally by any state. They require cooperation, which in turn depends on agreed rules of conduct. A rules-based international order provides an opportunity to developing states to protect and advance their interests through negotiations rather than power alone.

There are imperfections

The reality is that international law has never been perfect. It has always coexisted with political realities and has frequently been condemned for reflecting unequal power structures. Recent conflicts have reinforced these criticisms, revealing the structural limitations within the UN Security Council and the broader international legal order. However, these are not reasons enough for the abandonment of the system altogether. No legal system can guarantee perfect compliance. Its significance lies in establishing the standards against which conduct can be judged. History suggests that crises have rarely marked the end of international law. More often, they have prompted its adaptation and renewal.

International law is under pressure, but it is far from dead. The greater danger is the growing belief that its violations prove its irrelevance, a conclusion that serves only those who prefer a world in which might makes right. As long as states continue to invoke, interpret and rely on international law, its obituary is being written far too soon.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Issue of accountability

The article by the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha (Editorial page, August 10) makes sound points. Parliament has been in session for a while, yet the Home Minister has not made a statement on the brutalities unleashed on students. The students who protested were not aliens from outer space threatening the government, but India's sons and daughters seeking accountability for examination paper leaks and education reforms. Even by its own standards, the government of the day cannot defend the alleged use of pellet guns on unarmed students, which has left deep scars on many of us.

G. David Milton,
Maruthancode, Tamil Nadu

The government has exhibited its total inefficiency in ensuring tamper-proof examinations. When paper leaks continue unabated, they become a political issue. Student victims collectively voicing their protest being brutally crushed, and the Prime Minister expressing forgiveness instead of offering an apology, reflects both culpability and incompetence. Due corrections are imminent.

A.G. Rajmohan,
Anantapur, Andhra Pradesh

Peace, political courage

The Israeli Prime Minister's rejection of a U.S.-backed peace plan, even as Hamas signals acceptance, underscores how electoral calculations often overshadow the pursuit of peace. The tragedy is that both sides seem trapped by their internal politics, with civilians paying the price. Sustainable peace requires leaders on both sides who are willing to risk their political careers for the sake of human lives. That courage seems rare today.

K. Chidanand Kumar,
Bengaluru

Corrections & Clarifications

NATO's Article 5 was invoked once, in the aftermath of 9/11, and not "never invoked" (Editorial page, "A new security triangle emerges with the Makkah Pact", August 10).

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How personality cults derail democracy

Nirupama Rao
is a former diplomat

In 1937, as the country stood poised between colonial subjugation and the uncertain promise of freedom, an essay appeared in *The Modern Review*, titled 'The Rashtrapati' and was signed, cryptically, "Chanakya." Its author, as we know now, was Jawaharlal Nehru, but the reader at that time, was unaware of this. The piece remains one of the strangest acts of political self-examination in modern history: a leader at the height of his popularity writing anonymously about the dangers that his own popularity posed to the country.

Nehru was, by then, much more than a politician. To millions, he symbolised India's aspirations and was the embodiment of its longing for freedom. The adulation for him overflowed and, as the writer of the essay recognised, it was also unsettling. "Therein lies danger for Jawaharlal and for India," he wrote. "For it is not through Caesarism that India will attain freedom, and though she may prosper a little under a benevolent and efficient despotism, she will remain stunted and the day of the emancipation of her people will be delayed."

Nehru wrote in the shadow of Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany, but the anxiety around despotism transcended his own age. The gravest threat to democracy as he understood it, is not always tyranny imposed from above. Sometimes it emerges from below, from the yearning of ordinary people to surrender the burdens of citizenship to a figure who appears larger than life.

Leave devotion out of politics

Politics is a fertile field for mythmaking. Nations tell stories about themselves; stories that crystallise around individuals – Washington crossing the Delaware, Mao's famous crossing of the Yangtze in 1966 and the like. A society pours its hopes and fears into what is perceived as a messianic figure. But democracy rarely survives the elevation of leaders into objects of worship.

Nehru understood this. The phrase that leaps out from 'The Rashtrapati' is not "despotism" but "stunted." It was not that India might become authoritarian. It was that India might cease to grow. A people habituated to looking for salvation in a single individual would lose habits that sustain republican life: scepticism, argument, participation and responsibility. Freedom was never simply the transfer of power from British hands to Indian hands. It was the emancipation of the citizen's mind.

A dozen years later, on the eve of the Republic's birth, B. R. Ambedkar returned to the same theme, though in a much more severe language. Addressing the Constituent Assembly on November 25, 1949, he offered what remains one of the most profound warnings in Indian political thought. "Bhakti in religion may be a road to the salvation of the soul. But in politics, Bhakti or hero-worship is a sure road to degradation and to eventual dictatorship."

A profound understanding of Indian civilisation inspired these words. Devotion occupies a sacred place in our spiritual traditions. But politics, Ambedkar insisted, belongs to another realm. Scrutiny supplants devotion, and accountability rejects surrender.

More than dictatorship in its classical form, Ambedkar feared the slow erosion of democratic culture. Constitutions can be drafted and elections will be held. But republics depend, ultimately, on habits of the mind. They depend upon citizens who are willing to ask difficult questions, to distrust concentrations of power, and to distinguish between loyalty to a nation and loyalty to a leader.

This age-old anxiety defines our century. Recently, Ezra Klein, reflecting on Christopher Nolan's adaptation of *The Odyssey* and the age of Elon Musk and Donald Trump, suggested that we are witnessing a clash between two visions of human greatness. One prizes restraint, reciprocity and the difficult art of belonging to a community larger than oneself. The other celebrates disruption, conquest, and the charismatic individual who breaks rules and bends institutions to his will.

> The tragedy of personality cults is that they encourage us to outsource our judgment and to mistake admiration for patriotism

Making a messiah

The attraction of the modern strongman, whether political or technological, lies in the promise of transcendence. The entrepreneur who will colonise Mars; the outsider who promises to sweep away corruption and inefficiency. In an age of social media, these narratives acquire an almost epic quality. Politics becomes theatre and citizens become spectators.

Homer would have appreciated this irony. Odysseus, after all, is not merely a conqueror. He is flawed, cunning, restless and often consumed by his own legend. The greatness of *The Odyssey* lies not in its celebration of heroic power but in its recognition of heroic limits. The epic ends not with conquest but with homecoming. Its lesson is that no individual, however gifted, can exist apart from the obligations of community.

That is the lesson Nehru and Ambedkar were trying to teach India in their own way. The Republic is an argument against the idea of the indispensable man. It argues that institutions matter more than personalities and that power must remain accountable to something larger than itself. Democracies require visionaries, but they also require sceptics.

The tragedy of personality cults is that they encourage us to outsource our judgment and to mistake admiration for patriotism. They tempt us into believing that history is made by singular heroes rather than by the often invisible labour of millions of ordinary men and women. The true measure of a republic is not whether it can produce extraordinary leaders. It is whether it can renew itself without becoming dependent on them.

Row in Kerala over pension delivery

Government needs to find a balance between various modes of welfare transfers

STATE OF PLAY

Tiki Rajwi

An in-principle decision taken by the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government in Kerala to end doorstep delivery of welfare pensions and fully shift to the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mode has drawn sharp reactions from the Opposition alliance, the Left Democratic Front (LDF).

At present, the social security pensions for the elderly and distressed sections are paid either into their bank accounts via DBT or delivered to them under a Direct-To-Home (DTH) method through primary agricultural credit societies. A little over 23 lakh social security pensioners receive their monthly payment of ₹2,000 through the DTH method. In Kerala, the monthly welfare pensions paid out to roughly 60 lakh people – social security and welfare fund board pensions combined – enjoy considerable space in the political discourse, given the beneficiary size and the fiscal commitment. The prestige this welfare measure commands was evident during the 2026 Assembly elections. A promise that the pensions would be hiked to ₹3,000 had ranked high on the manifestos of all three fronts.

At the centre of the current political controversy is a July 27 State Finance Department order stating the government's intention to fully replace doorstep delivery of social security pensions with Aadhaar-linked bank transfers. While the abruptness of the decision had come as a surprise, it was apparently based on a recommendation by the Kerala Social Security Pension Ltd (KSSPL) which advocated for DBT as the preferred mode. The reasons given included the delays in returning unpaid pension money, payments made to ineligible individuals, and in some cases, multiple payments made to the same individual. Other reasons included the financial burden caused by the 'incentive' paid to people making the delivery and a possible loss of central financial assistance for non-compliance with DBT requirements.

Strong backlash

The reaction of the Communist Party of India (Marxist)-led LDF to the order was swift. The Leader of the Opposition, Pinarayi Vijayan, demanded an urgent roll-back of the decision on the grounds that it would bring needless hardship to senior citizens, particularly people with limited access to banks. K.N. Balagopal, who was Finance Minister in the 2021-2026 LDF government, accused the Congress-led government of harbouring an ulterior motive to weaken and phase out the pensions.

The doorstep delivery mechanism was introduced by the LDF when it came to power in 2016. Prior to that, pensions were paid through local self-government institutions or post offices. The LDF's rationale for replacing it was that the system was inefficient. The government's claim that Kerala could lose central assistance is baseless, since the 8.4 lakh welfare pensioners eligible for a central share in their payments were already receiving it through the DBT method, the LDF said.

However, it is pertinent to recall that the Comptroller and Auditor General of India (CAG) had, in 2023, flagged serious issues with the doorstep delivery mode. The CAG wanted Kerala to bring more beneficiaries under DBT in order to curb malpractice and possible fraud. Besides, finance department data revealed that Kerala had spent ₹434.89 crore across eight fiscals from 2016-17 on the incentive given to individuals for physically delivering the pensions.

While it will be interesting to see how Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan responds to the Opposition backlash, the controversy has coincided with his plans to develop a 'Kerala silver economy.' On taking charge, the CM had created a dedicated department for elderly welfare and announced plans for a 'comprehensive silver economy policy.'

Although not without drawbacks, DBT is widely regarded as a model that eliminates intermediaries and prevents fraud. What is equally true is that Kerala's cooperative sector is a robust, nationally-acclaimed institution with strong grassroots connections. Kerala's large ageing population, social structure and time-honoured thrust towards decentralisation make it inevitable that its local cooperative networks should have a role in the welfare of senior citizens. Under such circumstances, it would not be amiss for the government to take a considered decision on the matter after weighing the pros and cons and consulting with stakeholders.

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How India climbed up the Commonwealth ranks

India's medal share rose from 0.5% in 1934 to a peak of 12.2% in 2010, and stood at 5.8% in Glasgow, where it finished fourth

DATA POINT

Devyanshi Bihani
Gauri Singavarapu

India finished fourth at the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, which concluded last week on August 2, with 39 medals – 13 gold, 17 silver and nine bronze. The result came despite the absence of several sports disciplines that have historically supplied the bulk of India's Commonwealth haul, marking another chapter in a medal history that has grown from one medal in 1934 to 603 across editions.

India's Commonwealth success has long been concentrated in a handful of sports. Shooting, wrestling and weightlifting alone account for 390 of India's 603 medals, roughly two-thirds of the total. Boxing, badminton, and table tennis have added another 113 **(Table 1)**.

Shooting, wrestling, badminton, table tennis and hockey, all important contributors to India's past medal tallies, were absent in this year's games. Glasgow hosted a pared-down programme of 10 sports after the Commonwealth Games was forced to find a replacement host following Victoria's withdrawal. The 2026 programme included athletics, swimming, track cycling, weightlifting, 3x3 basketball, lawn bowls, netball, artistic gymnastics, judo and boxing, alongside para events.

Even without many of its traditional medal-producing sports, India still finished fourth.

A brief history

India's Commonwealth journey began in London in 1934, when wrestler Rashid Anwar won India's first medal, a bronze in the 74kg freestyle category and a 12th-place finish. India missed the 1930, 1950, 1962, 1986 editions, won no medals in 1938, and remained unranked in 1954. Its first gold medals came in 1958, when Milkha Singh won the 440-yard race and wrestler Lila Ram triumphed in the 100kg category, and Lachmi Kant Pandey won a silver. The tally steadily grew, reaching 10 medals in 1966, 12 in 1970 and 15 in 1974, when India finished sixth each time. By 1990, it had risen to 32 medals and fifth place.

Women gradually became a larger part of India's medal haul **(Chart 1)**. Their first Commonwealth medal came in 1978, when badminton players Ami Ghia and Kanwal Thakar Singh won bronze in the women's doubles at Edmonton. India then won two women's medals in 1994 and three in 1998.

The breakthrough came in 2002, when the tricolour began to rise on the Commonwealth stage. India crossed the 50-medal mark for the first time, winning 69 medals and finishing fourth. It followed that with 50 medals and another fourth-place finish in 2006. Then came its greatest Commonwealth campaign at Delhi in 2010, where India won a record 101 medals – 64 by men, 36 by women and one in a mixed event – finishing second.

In Glasgow 2026, India won 39 medals, with women accounting for 41% of India's tally.

The longer-term trend puts Glasgow in perspective. India accounted for just 0.5% of all medals awarded in 1934, when it won its first Commonwealth medal. Its share crossed 5% for the first time in 1990, when it won 32 of the 638 medals awarded. The share rose sharply from 2002 onwards, reaching 7.7% in 2002 and 6.7% in 2006. At the Delhi 2010 Games, India reached its peak, winning 101 of the 828 medals awarded –12.2% of the total. Its share remained above 7% in 2014 and 2018, at 7.8% and 7.9%, respectively, before falling to 7% in Birmingham in 2022.

In Glasgow, India won 39 of the 671 medals awarded, accounting for 5.8%. This was its lowest medal haul since 1958, when it won three medals. However, the smaller programme and the absence of several sports in which India had historically performed strongly make direct comparisons with earlier editions difficult.

Overall, India won 603 of the 10,636 medals awarded across editions, accounting for 5.7% of the total **(Chart 2)**.

Australia back on top

Australia finished first in Glasgow, returning to the top of the Commonwealth medal table after England topped the standings at Birmingham in 2022.

Australia's dominance is also striking when viewed against India's much larger population. It has accumulated 2,773 Commonwealth medals, compared with India's 603, despite having a population of roughly 28 million against India's 1.46 billion.

Canada has won 1,709 medals with a population of about 41.7 million, while New Zealand has won 743 medals with just 5.3 million people **(Chart 3)**.

The comparison is not intended as a medals-per-capita ranking – the countries have competed in different circumstances and across different numbers of Games – but it highlights the very different sporting systems behind their Commonwealth records.

Australia has consistently converted a much smaller population into a far larger medal haul, as children have access to many sports, usually experimenting with multiple sports before finding their specialisation. Its nation-wide 'Little Athletics' is their initial introduction to athletics, equipped with experienced coaches, who are unrestricted by bureaucratic central bodies. Australian athletes aren't pushed to perform young, and many gain experience in American colleges before competing officially. In contrast, India's medals have historically been concentrated in a relatively narrow group of sports.

With inputs from Sachin Swaraj who is interning with The Hindu's Data Team. Gauri Singavarapu is also an intern with the team.

Medal milestones

The data for the charts were sourced from World Bank, International Olympic Committee, Indian Olympic Association and Australian Bureau of Statistics

TABLE 1: India's Commonwealth medal tally by sport since 1934

Sport	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total medals
Shooting	63	44	28	135
Wrestling	49	39	26	114
Weightlifting	47	57	37	141
Boxing	18	16	20	54
Badminton	10	8	13	31
Table Tennis	10	5	13	28
Athletics	6	19	21	46
Para Athletics	3	2	1	6
Archery	3	1	4	8
Judo	2	6	7	15
Hockey	1	4	1	6
Squash	1	2	2	5
Tennis	1	1	2	4
Lawn Bowls	1	1	0	2
Powerlifting	1	0	2	3
Gymnastics	0	1	2	3
Cricket	0	1	0	1
Swimming	0	0	1	1

India's Commonwealth success has long been concentrated in a handful of sports. Shooting, wrestling and weightlifting alone account for 390 of India's 603 medals, roughly two-thirds of the total. Boxing, badminton, and table tennis have added another 113

CHART 1: India's Commonwealth medals by gender across editions. The chart excludes 16 medals won in mixed/team events, as these cannot be categorised by gender

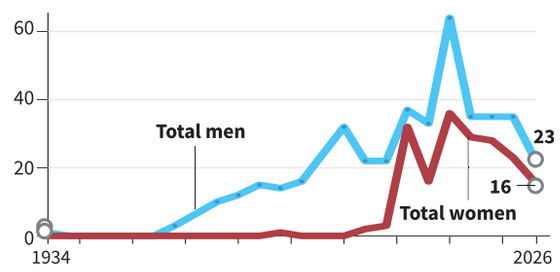


CHART 2: India's share (%) of total medals awarded in the Commonwealth Games it participated in since 1934

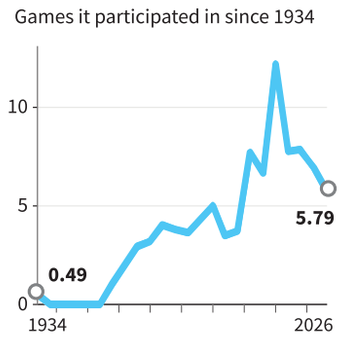
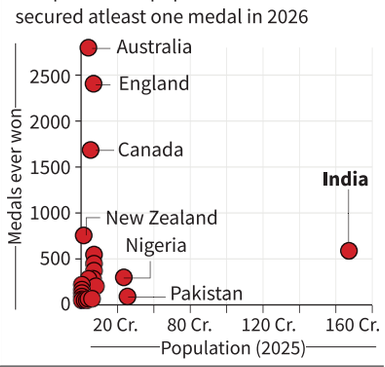


CHART 3: Commonwealth medal haul compared with population of nations that secured atleast one medal in 2026



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 11, 1976

Choice of IIT courses not based on aptitude

New Delhi, August 10: The choice of course of the candidates seeking admission to the five Indian Institutes of Technology does not appear to be related to their aptitudes or interest. They are guided much more by their assessment of job opportunities that will be available at the end of the five-year course, according to Prof. A.K. Basu Chairman of Admissions.

He told Samachar, however, the assessment in most cases was not based on facts. The pattern of choice of courses, on the whole, remained the same this year as in the last year with electrical (electronics), mechanical and chemical engineering being the top three popular courses respectively. Ample opportunities were available in these institutes for teaching and research in all courses including the so-called unpopular ones and there was good scope of securing jobs on completion of the courses, he said.

A total of 4,531 candidates applied for the joint entrance examination this year. Of them, 282 came on the merit list. The corresponding figures for the last year were 3,936 and 216.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 11, 1926

More wonders of science

An "Englishman" cable dated London, August 8, says:-

"The Daily Mail" says the latest scientific instruments exhibited at the meetings of the British Association bring nearer the discovery of the source of life, and a new source of power with a trigger to set it off and a boiler to control it. Some scientists foresee the day when an engine will be driven from London to Edinburgh on a handful of cobblestones.

This year's meetings of the Association show that women are participating more in scientific inquiry, but they are better analysts than creators.

Perhaps the most curious feature of the sectional meetings has been Professor Macdougall's demonstration of the intelligence of rats, which can move fourteen different catches separating them from food locked in a box. Professor Macdougall believes that rats have intelligence similar to man's and that the intellectuality of later generations of them can be increased, but the general view will probably be that rats are cunning enough already.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Suspected illegal immigrants detained by Bengaluru Police

100 The Bengaluru city police have detained over 100 people suspected of being illegal immigrants, officials said on Monday. Some of those detained are suspected to be Bangladeshi nationals, though their documents are being verified, they said. PTI

Indian institutions in QS World University Rankings

52 The number of Indian institutions featured in the QS World University Rankings increased from 11 in QS WUR 2015 to 52 in QS WUR 2027, since the launch of the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF) in 2015, the government informed the Lok Sabha on Monday. PTI

Increase in India's Asiatic lion population as of 2025

891 India's Asiatic lion population increased from 523 in 2015 to 891 in 2025, Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav said. The Project Lion, launched in 2020, focuses on habitat enhancement, disease monitoring, scientific population tracking and community participation. PTI

Medals India won at U-23 Commonwealth Fencing Championship

17 India won 17 medals, including four gold, four silver and nine bronze, on the opening day of the U-23 Commonwealth Fencing Championship in Lagos, Nigeria. Indian fencers reached the podium in all six individual events across Sabre, Foil and Epee categories. PTI

Number of migrants who crossed the Channel in single boat

230 A record 230 migrants, including more than 20 children, crossed the English Channel to Britain in a single small boat, France's lifeboat service SNSM said. The number breaks the previous record of 165 people set last month. AFP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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UPI and the cost of policy reversal

The government's proposal to allow an MDR of 0.25–0.5% on UPI transactions above ₹2,000 reverses a decade-long policy; taxing the payment rail could weaken incentives for banks and fintechs to invest in UPI while undermining its role in financial inclusion, formalisation and wider digital adoption

ECONOMIC NOTES

Parag Waknis

The government has just given itself the legal room to tax the very payment habit it spent a decade building. Tucked into the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, is an amendment to Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, which would allow the government to notify charges on specified electronic payment modes. The number being proposed is a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) of 0.25-0.5% on UPI transactions above ₹2,000. The official stand is that this threshold would touch only about five per cent of transactions by volume, sparing the milk-and-vegetable payments that make up the bulk of UPI's use. But it would cover roughly 65% of transaction value, which is precisely why it matters.

This is not a small, technical fix. It runs counter to a decade-long policy commitment and deserves more scrutiny than it has received.

The official stand is that this threshold would touch only about five per cent of transactions by volume, sparing the milk-and-vegetable payments that make up the bulk of UPI's use. J. ALLEN EGENUSE

The policy reversal

Consider the arc. Demonetisation in November 2016 was justified, among other things, as a push towards a less-cash economy. UPI, launched earlier that year, became the vehicle for that push, and its zero-MDR regime was a deliberate subsidy to get merchants and consumers off cash. It worked spectacularly. UPI now processes more transactions each month than most of the world's card networks combined. Having successfully weaned the country away from cash and towards electronic payments, the government now wants to undercut the very success it engineered.

There seems to be a continued pattern of privileging one payment mode over others via policy. India has long taxed even credit cards. Credit card interest and fees attract 18% GST, making the use of credit cards unnecessarily costly. Taxing interest on revolving credit is unusual by international standards; most jurisdictions treat consumer credit interest as a private financial cost, not a taxable service. India taxes it as if using a credit card itself is a luxury.

Now UPI, the payment rail the government spent political capital promoting, is in line for similar treatment. The pattern suggests a need for a more coherent payments policy than giving in to the temptation to tax every transaction that can be observed.

There are at least two problems with this specific move beyond the optics.

Who really pays?

First, basic economic theory tells us that the person on whom a tax is levied and the person who actually bears its cost are not always the same. Moreover, UPI or any payments interface is a two-sided market, and taxing two-sided markets is genuinely tricky.

The MDR would nominally fall on merchants, as argued by the government, collected via banks and the National Payments Corporation of India's ecosystem. But whether that cost gets passed through to merchants, on to consumers, or absorbed by banks and payment service providers depends on competitive intensity on each side of the market. Banks and fintechs compete for merchant relationships and cannot easily raise prices without losing volume to a rival offering free UPI acceptance.

The more likely outcome is that intermediaries – the banks and PSPs that built and maintain the plumbing – absorb the cost, which erodes their incentive to invest in reliability, fraud prevention and expansion into underserved segments. A tax that cannot be reliably passed through does not disappear; it most likely shows up later as degraded service or slower innovation. This is completely counterintuitive if government is proposing this tax as necessary to fund the next stage of UPI growth.

Cost to inclusion

Second, UPI has done real work on financial inclusion at the margin. It has pulled informal transactions into a recorded, traceable digital trail – the very outcome that formalisation and tax-compliance advocates have wanted for years. There have also been attempts to provide credit based on the digital trail created by electronic payments. Every rupee that moves through UPI instead of cash is a rupee the financial institutions can eventually see and use to build a spending profile.

Charging the rail directly could undercut the incentive to use it, cutting against long-standing financial inclusion goals. The government does not need to raise revenue from every rupee that moves electronically; it needs those rupees to keep moving electronically, because that is what delivers the inclusion and compliance dividends it has been chasing since 2016.

Ideally, which payment mode to adopt should be an economic decision for participating actors. Factors such as the size of the business, consumer preferences, and relative cost of using alternative payment systems should determine their usage. Deliberate policy intervention and the current government's war on cash tilted the scales in favour of UPI. Taxing it now – however nominal or small – could change its usage patterns, and policymakers should not be surprised if one outcome is reduced UPI usage.

The proposal is being dressed up as a modest, targeted measure affecting only large-value transactions. But modest measures on payment rails have a way of expanding once the legal architecture exists. Section 10A, once amended, does not expire when this particular MDR proposal is shelved. The better outcome is for the government to leave the payments system alone, let UPI's network effects keep compounding, and find its revenue elsewhere.

(Parag Waknis, Professor & Head, Economics Department, SRM University AP)

THE GIST

- The proposed framework could allow payment charges to expand beyond the current MDR plan, creating a broader revenue lever once the legal architecture is in place.
- UPI's network effects depend on keeping digital payments cheaper and more convenient than cash, making any new cost a potential distortion in how businesses and consumers choose payment modes.

Why does handloom remain a key part of India's economy?

The sector supports millions of livelihoods, but declining returns and fragmented markets threaten its future

Priyambada Jayakumar

The story so far:

From the Swadeshi Movement's boycott of British textiles to Mahatma Gandhi's adoption of the spinning wheel as a symbol of self-reliance, weaving became an instrument of economic resistance and national identity. National Handloom Day, marked on August 7, commemorates the launch of the Swadeshi Movement in 1905 and honours generations of Indian weavers.

A legacy beyond craft

Today's handloom sector is often viewed as a small artisanal activity – important culturally but peripheral economically. Long before the Industrial Revolution transformed manufacturing in Europe, India's handlooms were among the world's greatest industrial enterprises. Indian textiles travelled across continents, powered global trade and established India's reputation as one of history's foremost manufacturing economies. Handloom was the backbone of India's manufacturing strength and one of the foundations of its global influence.

The sector remains far more significant than it is generally acknowledged. It provides livelihoods to more than 35 lakh weavers and allied workers across over 31 lakh households, with women constituting nearly 70% of the workforce. It remains one of rural India's largest sources of non-farm employment while producing nearly 15% of the country's cloth despite relying largely on manual technology. Few manufacturing sectors create as many jobs with such modest capital investment.

While celebrated traditions continue to enjoy strong recognition, hundreds of lesser-known weaving traditions face gradual extinction. Younger generations are leaving the profession as returns diminish, markets remain fragmented and traditional skills are no longer transferred within families. Every disappearing weave represents not merely the loss of a product but the disappearance of centuries of accumulated knowledge, distinctive design vocabulary, and cultural identity. Therefore, protecting handloom heritage is not only an economic necessity but also our civilisational duty.

The government's recent policy and programme support seems to be making a difference. The National Handloom Development Programme has focused on skill development, design innovation, technology adoption, branding, and improved market access. Greater integration with e-commerce platforms and expanding export opportunities have enabled many artisan clusters to reach consumers who were previously inaccessible.

Several success stories illustrate what targeted intervention can achieve. The revival of *Tangaliya* weaving in Gujarat, the transformation of Badturang village in Odisha's Sambalpur district and the growing popularity of Siddipet *Gollabhama* sarees demonstrate that traditional crafts can thrive when design, market access and institutional support converge. It was more than just a fashion statement when Brad Pitt wore a handcrafted shirt in the traditional *Tangaliya* weave in the *F1* film.

The Office of the Development Commissioner for Handlooms, in collaboration with UNESCO, has initiated the identification and documentation of India's languishing and endangered weaves. This should be extended to every nook and corner of the country. This aligns with Textiles Secretary Neelam Shami Rao's focus on promoting India's rich, Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged handloom and handicraft products and strengthening their presence in domestic and international markets.

Making handloom aspirational

The next phase of policy must shift from preservation to aspiration. For younger consumers, especially Gen Z, handloom must become contemporary, fashionable, and aspirational rather than merely traditional. Celebrity ambassadors, collaborations with leading designers, limited-edition collections, digital storytelling, and partnerships with influencers can reposition India's weaves as premium lifestyle products. The objective should not be to celebrate handloom because it is old, but because it represents craftsmanship, sustainability, and exclusivity. Limited production should become a premium feature.

India must also think beyond domestic markets. The world increasingly values authenticity, sustainability, and handcrafted luxury – all areas where Indian handlooms enjoy a natural competitive advantage. Expanding exports, however, will require consistent quality standards, stronger branding, better GI protection, and vigilant action against cultural misappropriation.

Measuring the contribution

India should leverage its traditional weaves, which for some global markets are ancient imports, to build its soft power. Unlike most manufacturing sectors, India's handloom economy is inadequately measured. Policymakers need reliable data on its contribution to GDP, exports, tax revenues, employment and household incomes. Better measurement will enable better policy and allow the sector to be recognised for the economic value it already creates.

Similarly, establishing a national platform through which States, producer organisations and cooperatives can exchange successful practices would accelerate innovation across the sector.

Handloom is not a relic of India's past; it is a strategic asset for its future. Few sectors simultaneously generate rural employment, empower women, preserve cultural heritage, promote sustainability, and strengthen India's global brand. As the country pursues the vision of Viksit Bharat, handloom deserves to be viewed as a serious economic sector. The measure of success will be how many looms remain active, profitable, and capable of attracting the next generation of weavers.

(Priyambada Jayakumar is a historian, public speaker, handloom advocate, and the author of 'The Man Who Fed India')

CACHE

Photo of a satellite image, used for representational purposes. REUTERS

How did Google's AI satellite images raise safety concerns?

Google rolled back its AI image-generation feature in Google Earth within a day after users created satellite deepfakes that appeared to show violence, disasters, and other policy violations; the feature raised concerns over the misuse of fake satellite imagery for misinformation and scams

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far:

A new AI feature launched by Google in late July remained active for around a day before it was pulled down by the company, amidst serious safety and misinformation concerns. The launch of the feature and its quick rollback showed how easily even casual internet users broke past Google's enterprise-level safeguards in order to create deepfake satellite images, in spite of the risks they pose.

What was the AI feature launched by Google?

Put simply, users could open Google Earth – the company's immersive satellite map of the planet – in order to zoom into a place, choose the "create image" option, and type whatever they wanted to see built on top of the original imagery.

On July 30, Google Earth's Product Manager Bryan Horowitz shared a blog post that invited users to "transform any place," with AI, the process powered by the company's image generation Nano Banana technology.

Google suggested several wholesome use cases for the feature, such as re-imagining (not visualising) how modern-day landmarks looked in ancient times, as well as generating mock-ups of completed real estate projects, creating educational infographics, and giving real-life locations a fantasy feel. Teachers, architects, and urban planners were invited to get creative with the prompts, and Google shared examples as well.

Why was the AI feature taken down?

On July 31, the company posted an update to its launch blog post, confirming that the AI feature in Google Earth had been rolled back over possible policy violations by others.

"We know that people uniquely trust Google Earth for a reliable view of the world. We've seen geospatial professionals using this feature for a range of useful purposes, however we've also seen people sharing screenshots of generated imagery that appear to violate our policies. So we're rolling back this feature in Google Earth while we work on implementing stronger guardrails," stated the update, adding, "It's important to note that generated images didn't appear in the main Google Earth experience for others to see and were watermarked as AI generated."

While the official notice did not blame specific parties or provide examples of the offending images, the social media platform X (formerly Twitter) showed satellite deepfake screenshots that depicted terrorist attacks, human crises, industrial accidents, environmental destruction, and more.

Some of these images were generated by casual users who managed to access the feature, while others were the result of safety tests run by researchers. The deepfakes ranged in quality from unrealistically violent to highly natural, sparking experts' concern.

Many users online criticised Google over the rollout of the feature, claiming that the potential for misuse of AI in satellite images far outweighed any benefits such a feature could have. Others questioned why the enterprise-level safeguards were so weak and easy to bypass when creating satellite image deepfakes that depicted violence.

What are the risks of fake AI satellite images?

Google defended its feature by highlighting that the AI-generated images did not appear as part of the public Google Earth experience. Even so, there are risks in allowing casual users to create AI satellite deepfakes for personal, commercial, or entertainment value.

Watermarks can be easily cropped out of such media, and the average user may lack the time and knowledge to further investigate a suspicious-looking satellite image – especially if it is presented in a short-form news video that is shared on social media and designed to go viral.

Satellite image deepfakes could also be used to run real estate scams by changing land or geographic details, to the buyer's detriment. Furthermore, these images would not be appropriate to use in serious academic projects or scholarly works.

At a higher level, satellite image deepfakes could be created to spread harmful misinformation about ongoing conflicts, humanitarian tragedies, or even natural disasters.

This is not a hypothetical danger; during the Iran war in February and March this year, the Tehran Times account on X shared an AI image that appeared to show the aftermath of bombing a U.S. target. This was made with older satellite images, which helped researchers classify it as a fake.

Furthermore, satellite images themselves are not a perfect source of evidence. Multiple regions across the world have not been accurately updated over time, either due to inaccessibility or security regulations that prevent detailed street-level mapping. India and Israel are examples of such countries. To integrate high-quality AI deepfake generation features into these still fallible yet necessary resources adds yet more layers of risk.

The rollback of AI image generation in Google Earth shows that the world's largest internet company is still not ready to address these basic risks.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

Here is a quiz on the 'king of beasts' on the occasion of World Lion Day that is observed every August 10

V.V. Ramanan

QUESTION 1
Name the conservation charity that came up with the idea of World Lion Day in 2013.

QUESTION 2
What is the scientific name for the Asiatic Lion subspecies found in India?

QUESTION 3
If 'Project Tiger' was launched in 1973, on which date and year was 'Project Lion' announced in the country, and what is the current population of the Asiatic lions as of 2025?

QUESTION 4
Which lion was the subject of the first of the Twelve Labours of Heracles?

QUESTION 5
In Frank Baum's '*The Wonderful Wizard of Oz*', which quality does the Cowardly Lion seek from the Wizard?

QUESTION 6
In the famous flick, '*The Lion King*', if the protagonist is Simba, what are the names of his father and villainous uncle?

QUESTION 7
Which famous sculptor designed the four enormous bronze lions at the base of Nelson's Column in London's Trafalgar Square?

Visual Question:
This is the inspiration for India's National emblem. Where can one see the Lion Capital now?

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. The establishment of the museum is closely linked with this paramount event in 1789. Name the event. **Ans: The French Revolution**
2. A steel-and-glass pyramid, known as the Louvre Pyramid, serves as the entrance to the museum. Name the architect who designed it. **Ans: Chinese-American architect I. M. Pei**
3. During the Nazi occupation of France in the Second World War, many treasures of the museum, including the Mona Lisa, were transported to secret hiding places. Name the director of the museum who was responsible for ensuring the safe transport of these artifacts. **Ans: Jacques Jaujard**
4. The Louvre was once the official residence of French Monarchs. When did it stop becoming the royal seat? **Ans: 1682**
5. Last year, the Louvre was burgled by brazen thieves who entered the museum disguised as construction workers. What did they steal? **Ans: 8 pieces of the French Crown Jewels**
Visual: What is this building and where is it located? **Ans: Louvre Abu Dhabi on Saadiyat Island, United Arab Emirates**
Early Birds: Sunil Madhavan | Piyali Tuli | Suchit Narottam | Dodo Jayaditya | Sitaram Saharay

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

"How was your trip to Madras? Was your sister happy to see you?"

"I don't know if she was happy to see me or not. But she was definitely happy to note that my water bottle was full."

"Your water bottle!"

"...there's an acute water shortage there. If you were to walk into a stranger's house with a couple of bottles of water, he would welcome you with open arms!"

"It's that bad, eh? Did you inform that you were planning to take up a job in Bombay?"

"No, I didn't..."

"...you should have informed that you were...."

"....informed her."

"What?"

"You should have informed her. You don't merely 'inform', you 'inform someone' of something. You have to let the listener know who that someone is."

"Would it be wrong to say 'I informed that there would be a meeting tomorrow'?"

"Yes, it would."

"I see. Then how about this? The Principal informed some of the students that there would be no school tomorrow."

"Wishful thinking on your part. But the example is fine."

"The teacher informed me that I had done fairly well in the test. How does that sound?"

"Sounds great! I must say that you cotton on fast."

"What's that supposed to mean?"

"Why don't you guess the meaning?"

"Well, let me see. I gave you an example and then you said that it was right. And then... Does cotton on mean that I understand things quickly?"

"When you 'cotton on' to something, you begin to understand it or realise it."

"Is it an expression that is used often?"

"It is an expression used by native speakers of English in informal contexts."

"I see. How about this example then? At long last Harish cottoned on to the fact that Chitra wasn't interested in him at all."

"That's a pretty good example. Most of the students cottoned on to what the teacher was trying to say."

"That never happens in my case. Whenever my Physics teacher says something, it takes me at least half an hour to cotton on to what it is she is saying."

"That's because you don't cotton to physics like some of your other classmates."

"You mean cotton on to, don't you?"

"No, I mean 'cotton to'. Jaya doesn't cotton to Karunanidhi."

"That example makes everything clear. Everyone knows that the two can't stand each other. So does 'cotton to' mean to like someone."

"When you 'cotton to' someone or something, you like the person or thing."

"How is your friend Namratha doing? Last I heard she was trying to find a job.

"She won the lottery about six months ago. And since then she has been in tall cotton."

"Not cotton again."

"You don't cotton to expressions with the word cotton, do you? Anyway, any idea what 'in tall cotton' means?"

"Not a clue."

"When you say that someone is in 'tall cotton' it means that he or she has life made. The person is fairly successful and has absolutely no problems with money."

"I wish I were living in tall cotton."

Published in The Hindu on July 24, 2001

Word of the day

Pugnacity:
a natural disposition to be hostile

Synonyms: aggression, defiance, irritability

Usage: *His pugnacity often led to unnecessary arguments.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/pugnacity

International Phonetic Alphabet: /pʌɡnæsəti/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

Protesters march to Assembly; 5 injured

The protest, which began around 10.30 a.m. near the old Assembly complex in Dhurwa, was largely peaceful initially. Carrying the Tricolour, placards and portraits of Bhagat Singh, Ambedkar, former Chief Minister Shibu Soren, and activist Nirmal Mahato, protesters walked towards the Assembly, chanting slogans against the government and demanding action. Jharkhand Loktantrik Krantikari Morcha (JLKM) leader Devendra Nath Mahato, who has been on a hunger strike for several days, was brought to the site on a stretcher. He followed the march in an ambulance for a brief while.

Tensions arose after noon as protesters broke through barricades to approach the new Assembly building. A large number of security personnel from the Jharkhand Police, Jharkhand Jaguar, the Rapid Action Force and district forces, along with riot-control vehicles, were deployed in the area. The police then used water cannons, fired tear gas and resorted to lathi-charge to disperse the crowd. Protesters retaliated by throwing bottles, slippers and shoes at the police. The JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch and JLKM leaders said their protest will not end till their demands are met. Protesters held a sit-in near the Assembly complex till night.

City DSP Ajay Aryan denied that the police had resorted to a "deliberate lathi-charge". "No force was used but police had to push back to control the crowd and ensure no one is injured," he said.

Ready for discussion on protests, says govt.

Doubling down on the Opposition's demands, the Leaders of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha and Rajya Sabha, Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge, respectively, at a press conference, demanded accountability over the use of pellet guns, an apology from the Prime Minister for the police action and a statement on the alleged theft of offerings at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya.

They claimed that neither had the "courage to come to the House for the past 15 days for what they have done to the students".

Hitting out at the Union government, Mr. Gandhi asserted that the question was never about Union Home Minister Amit Shah giving "a speech on general topics" but always about who authorised "the shooting of our youngsters in Delhi". "He [Mr. Shah] is Home Minister. Pellet guns were fired, students were beaten with 'lathis' with nails on them. The question was if Mr. Amit Shah should come clean: did he order it or did he not? If he ordered it, he is guilty of getting our children shot. And if he didn't know about it happening, he is incompetent. Either way, he should go," he said.

Over 100 killed in major earthquake in Colombia

Colombian President Abelardo de la Espriella declared an emergency which will expedite funding for the quake recovery, and said he would visit the disaster zone, centered round the rural region of Choco. "We aren't going to leave people alone. They are in our hearts and we are going to tend to people with our full determination," he said.

European Union chief Ursula von der Leyen said the bloc was "ready to provide more support" for rescue efforts in the Latin American country. "Tonight, Europe's heart is with the people of Colombia. We have already mobilised Copernicus, our satellite service, to help with rescue operations," she said on social media.

The earthquake left cities across the west of the country – Pereira, Quibdo, Cali, and Manizales – ravaged. Residents and search teams picked through the rubble of collapsed buildings amid concerns by authorities of aftershocks. Colombia's Interior Minister said over 20 municipalities across the country had been hit.

Authorities also reported that flights were suspended in the airports of Manizales, Quibdo, Armenia, Cartago, Buenaventura and Pereira.

(With AFP inputs)

AI flight faced 'technical failures' before plunge

As the aircraft in question pitched up during the flight and a stall warning was triggered (indicating loss of lift or height), one of the pilots took manual control and attempted to push the nose down, according to another Air India source familiar with the sequence of events.

The pilot may have applied significant control input while attempting to recover the aircraft, the source said, causing the aircraft to lose around 300 feet of altitude in a matter of moments and throwing passengers and crew upward.

The available technical records do not show further fault messages after this sequence. Sources said this indicates that the flight-control systems recovered following the pilots' intervention, although the precise relationship between the technical failures, the flight-control response and the subsequent altitude excursion remain subject to investigation.

The pilots decided to continue to Delhi rather than divert to a nearby airport seemingly due to the availability of better medical facilities for the injured passengers as well as aircraft engineering support.

Jharkhand battling paper leaks, exam cancellations for 26 years: protesters

As police foil march to Assembly, job aspirants say they want CBI probe into recruitment issues as they don't trust State; they question police for putting up barbed barricades like 'on border' and for beating them up like 'criminals'; protester warns that youth will give an answer through votes

Suruchi Kumari
Aniket Singh Chauhan
RANCHI

Pankaj Yadav, 28, lay on the road, one kilometre from the Jharkhand Assembly, with a swollen foot, trying to explain to those around him where the police lathi had struck him. His knees and leg were hurting, he said, and there was pain near his stomach too.

Yet even as he sat amid the chaos outside the Vidhan Sabha on Monday evening, Mr. Yadav was talking about the examinations that had brought him there.

A JPSC and JSSC aspirant, Mr. Yadav had appeared for the State-level job recruitment examinations four times. Each time, he said, the process had been marred by irregularities.

On Monday, he joined thousands of other aspirants marching towards the Assembly, carrying with them a frustration that had long outgrown any single examination.

Tensions flare: Police personnel deploy water cannons to disperse protesters during a 'Vidhan Sabha Gherao' protest march towards the Jharkhand Legislative Assembly in Ranchi on Monday. PTI

For Sonali Agrawal, a JPSC-CGL aspirant, the march was about the years students were losing while waiting for a recruitment system they could trust. "As students, we are constantly dealing with exam cancellations and paper leaks. Since the formation of Jharkhand, this has been a consistent issue for 26 years," she said. "These exams are a lifeline for this State's youth and that is the reason why this issue is still alive."

The march called by the JPSC-JSSC Reform Manch and the JLKM began at the old Vidhan Sabha around 10.30 am. They came demanding cancellation of the JSSC-CGL recruitment examination, accountability for the alleged examination irregularities and a CBI investigation into them.

As the crowd moved closer to the Assembly, the police lathi-charged the protesters and used tear gas and low-pressure water cannons on them. Later in the evening, the police used heavier force and lathi-charge to disperse those who remained.

Around 8.30 pm, YouTuber Parth Kumar told *The Hindu* that his camera had been destroyed by police personnel near the Vidhan Sabha complex. "They forced me to delete the footage of lathi-charge and then pushed me to the ground with my camera and it broke," he said.

The police action deepened the anger among the aspirants. "They should directly hit us with a gun. The government is already sucking our youth years," said 32-year-old Shubam Kumar, an aspirant.

'Are we terrorists?'

For many in the crowd, the barricades themselves had become part of the message they felt the government was sending them.

Binod, a protester, pointed to the barbed wire around the barricades. "We see these barbed wires on the border with Pakistan. Does the government think that we are terrorists in our own country?" he said.

The anger intensified after the first round of lathi-charge. Anand Sagar, 26, suffered an arm injury in the police action. "This dictatorial government is beating us, but we will give an answer for this treatment through our votes," Mr. Sagar said. "We came to wish the Chief Minister on his birthday but they beat us black and blue. I can't even stand up."

Jitendra, who was present during the lathi-charge, questioned the government's response to students who had come out to protest. "This government says that students are like their family. Then is this the way to treat family?" he said. "If we are protesting as per the laws, then why is the government beating us like criminals?"

"We demand a CBI investigation because we do not trust the State authorities," Ms. Agrawal said. "We are not against any party, we just want reforms in the system."

Panel in Jammu to study 'demographic changes' near border

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The panel members are likely to visit a detention centre where around 450 Rohingyas are lodged

Four members of the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC) arrived in Jammu on Monday as part of their first-ever field visit to study demography changes in border areas, as mandated by the Union Home Ministry.

The committee is led by former Supreme Court judge Justice Prakash Prabhakar Naolekar (retd), who is not part of the visit.

The committee is likely to meet civil society members on Tuesday and visit settlements along the Pakistan border in Kathua and Samba districts over the next two days.

Organisations that have received invitation from the panel include Brahmin Sabha; Team Jammu, which works on anti-narcotics programmes; Pannun Kashmir, an organisation of displaced Kashmiri Pandits; Jammu State Morcha; Transporters Association; and Private Schools Association. The panel is meeting groups shortlisted by the district administration, an official said.

The panel members are likely to visit a detention centre in Hiranagar where around 450 Rohingyas are lodged. As per the Home Ministry's estimate in 2017, around 13,000 Rohingyas have settled in Jammu.

Census Commissioner Mritunjay Kumar Narayan, former IAS officer Durga Shanker Mishra who served as the U.P. Chief Secretary, former IPS officer Balaji Srivastava who retired as Director General Bureau of Police Research and Development, and Shamika Ravi, who is part of Prime Minister's Economic Advisory Council, are members of the visiting panel. The Joint Secretary (Foreigners-I), Home Ministry, is the Member Secretary of the panel.

BJP asks Cong. to withdraw support to Soren govt.; Rahul slams police action

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

The BJP on Monday stepped up its attack on the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha-Congress government in Jharkhand even as Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi condemned the police action against protesting students.

Leader of the Opposition in the Jharkhand Assembly and senior BJP leader Babulal Marandi dared the Congress leadership to withdraw support to the Hemant Soren government if it was serious about the students' demands.

"My message to Jharkhand students is very clear. We condemn any violence against peacefully protesting students," Mr. Gandhi said at a press conference in Delhi.

"It does not matter where it is happening; we are against it and we do not support it. There is no confusion in our minds. As long as the protests are peaceful, we are against attacking them with violence," he added.

Jharkhand Leader of the Opposition Babulal Marandi, State BJP president Aditya Sahu and supporters stage a dharna in Ranchi. PTI

In a post on X, he said the use of force against students protesting in Jharkhand was wrong and that students had a right to peaceful protest.

"Only dialogue can yield solutions," Mr. Gandhi said, urging the State government to hear the students out and resolve their issues immediately.

BJP leaders detained

Mr. Marandi and BJP Jharkhand State president Aditya Sahu led a protest outside Mr. Soren's residence in Ranchi in support of the students. The BJP demanded a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) inquiry into alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations and sought Mr. Soren's resignation. The leaders were detained by the police.

Mr. Marandi said the lathi-charge on the students would prove to be the "final nail in the coffin" for the JMM-Congress government. He alleged that the JMM-Congress government was "openly selling" Jharkhand Public Service Commission and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission jobs.

Mr. Marandi said the students had been protesting for more than 17 days and alleged that the government had remained a "spectator" despite several protesters falling ill. "It is an injustice done to the lakhs of poor, Dalit, tribal, rural, and hardworking youth of Jharkhand who dream of securing employment after years of struggle," he said, adding that the lathi-charge on students was an "act of cruelty and barbarism".

Mr. Sahu termed the Jharkhand government as "oppressive and dictatorial", saying that the manner in which BJP leaders were forcibly dragged and bundled into a bus was "not a good sign for democracy".

He accused the government of suppressing the students' voices through force and said the Congress and Mr. Gandhi should either pressure Mr. Soren to accept the students' demands or withdraw support to his government.

"The police lathi-charge on unarmed students marks a dark chapter for democracy. While the Congress party staged protests outside the Prime Minister's residence in Delhi, it remained silent regarding the oppression committed by its own government in Jharkhand," Mr. Sahu said.

At least 10 people injured by pellets on July 20: RTI replies

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

According to Right to Information (RTI) responses by two hospitals to Trinamool Congress spokesperson Saket Gokhale, at least 10 people were injured by pellets during the march to Parliament on July 20.

Lady Hardinge Medical College in the national capital said in its RTI response that nine people were injured by pellets. Hospital sources confirmed the authenticity of the response.

Safdarjung Hospital said in its response that one person was injured by pellets.

While the Delhi Police first denied the use of pellet guns, a general diary entry filed at the Parliament Street police station on July 22 said that the Rapid Action Force (RAF) fired two rounds from an anti-riot gun.

Saket Gokhale

Among those who were injured by pellets included 25-year-old artist Prashant Kumar Singh, 25-year-old Shaikh Irshad Mansoori, 19-year-old student Sahil Lochab, and a journalist.

A 32-year-old woman, Nutan, was injured by a "blunt weapon" as per her medical reports.

Posting photos of the RTI responses on X on Monday, Mr. Gokhale said: "Until now, there were reports of 5 people with pellet gun injuries during the Jantar Mantar protests on 20th July. However, records procured from hospitals show that the confirmed number is at least double, i.e. 10 persons."

Records awaited

He said that records are still awaited from the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) and Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital.

"Why hasn't the Modi Govt released a confirmed number for pellet gun victims?" the Trinamool spokesperson asked.

High Court upholds religious conversion of 2 U.P. women

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court last week directed the release of two adult Hindu women who claimed to have voluntarily converted to Islam. Holding that their father had unlawfully confined them because of their religious choices, the court also ordered him and the Uttar Pradesh government to jointly pay ₹25 lakh in compensation for the violation of their fundamental rights.

Justice Sandeep Jain, hearing a *habeas corpus* petition on August 6, held that the siblings aged 35 and 20 years were entitled to decide their faith, residence and personal affairs as adults.

"Ms. Diya Bhatia alias Zoya Diya Bhatia and Ms. Anshu Bhatia alias Amina Anshu Bhatia are declared to be free to reside at any place and with any person of their own choice, without any interference from respondent No. 4 (father of the girls) or any other person or the State and its functionaries," the court said, while describing the case as an exceptionally grave violation of constitutional rights.

The High Court orders ₹25 lakh to be paid as compensation.

While ordering the ₹25 lakh compensation, the court permitted the State government to recover 50% from the father, Anil Kumar Bhatia, and the remaining 50% from any delinquent public servant whose acts contributed to the unconstitutional deprivation of the women's liberty, subject to law and due process.

The High Court also directed the father not to interfere with either woman's personal liberty, movement, residence, profession or religious choices. The father was additionally ordered to hand over his daughters' original documents and belongings within seven days.

Tribunals Reforms Bill passed amid din in LS

Bill to set up a panel to oversee appointments to various national tribunals was cleared without a debate; Law Minister says it will bring uniformity to selection process and improve transparency

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Lok Sabha on Monday passed a Bill to establish a National Tribunals Commission to oversee the appointment of chairpersons and members of various tribunals, without a debate amid persistent Opposition protests demanding the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

The Opposition has been demanding that Mr. Shah make a statement on the police crackdown on students during the July 20 protest in New Delhi against paper leaks.

The Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, introduced by Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal, was passed by voice vote after Opposition members, who had given notices opposing its introduction, chose not to speak amid the din.

Once passed by both Houses, the new law will repeal the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021.

No discussion: Proceedings in the Lok Sabha during the Monsoon Session of Parliament, in New Delhi on Monday. ANI

The proposed commission, to be headquartered in New Delhi, will comprise a chairperson and four members – two judicial and two technical members. A retired Supreme Court judge or a retired Chief Justice of a High Court will be eligible to head the commission.

Speaking on the Bill, Mr. Meghwal said it sought to bring uniformity to the process of selection and appointment of tribunal members and would improve efficiency, transparency and independence.

He said the legislation did not alter the jurisdiction of any tribunal. The Minister described the measure as part of the government's "reform express".

The Bill comes against the backdrop of the Supreme Court's intervention in the functioning of tribunals.

The court had struck down provisions of the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021, holding that some of them were contrary to the principles of separation of powers and judicial independence and inconsistent with earlier judgments laying down standards for the appointment, tenure and functioning of tribunal members.

SC's direction

The court had also directed the establishment of an independent National Tribunals Commission with professional expertise, transparent selection procedures and an oversight mechanism for appointments.

The proposed legislation provides for the qualifications, selection and appointment of tribunal chairpersons and members, besides prescribing their salaries, allowances, tenure, resignation, removal and other service conditions.

Rajya Sabha clears two Bills; Minister says consumers will not pay UPI charges

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Amid the Opposition walkout, the Rajya Sabha passed the Bankers' Books Evidence Bill and returned the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill on Monday.

Countering the Opposition's charge that the Taxation Bill proposed further burden on small traders and consumers by imposing a tax on Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transactions, Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said they would remain free for consumers.

She added that once the Bill was passed, the National Payments Corporation of India could finalise the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR), which would be applied to to certain categories of merchant transactions. The Upper House had witnessed disruptions and adjournments in the morning too.

CPI(M) member John Brittas moved a statutory motion to disapprove an ordinance brought by the Finance Ministry in June. The statutory motion and the Bill were discussed together. He accused the government of being subservient to the United States and said the charges of UPI transactions were based on the U.S. diktats. "The Prime Minister promised that UPI will be free for everyone," he reminded the government.

Nirmala Sitharaman

During the debate, AAP member Sanjay Singh said the new Bill would create problems for the public as digital transactions had become a part of trade and commerce.

Countering all these arguments, Ms. Sitharaman said UPI had remained free for consumers since its launch, and every Indian would continue to make instant digital payments without paying a transaction charge. "Will consumers pay any UPI charge? No, consumers will not have to pay any charges on UPI transactions," she said. Adding that vast majority of merchant transactions, including low-value transactions to roadside vendors, would continue to remain free.

When Mr. Brittas walked out soon after his reply, Ms. Sitharaman said Communists in this country were total cowards and they could not face facts, but "they will go on filibustering, making noise."

Earlier, the Rajya Sabha proceedings were interrupted twice in the morning session with continued protests from the Opposition demanding a statement from Union Home Minister Amit Shah on the police action on July 20 on protesters in Delhi.

Bihar students subjected to brutality by police: Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday alleged that the Bihar Police had subjected students protesting in solidarity with the agitation at Jantar Mantar to "extreme brutality", including the use of AK-47s, and questioned the role of Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary and Union Minister Amit Shah.

The allegations were made at a press conference after fact-finding teams of the Congress submitted reports on police action against students in different parts of Bihar to the party leadership.

Congress in-charge of Bihar Krishna Allavaru alleged that the police had conducted midnight raids, arrested students and unleashed a "reign of terror" in an attempt to break their morale. In Siwan, AK-47s were used against protesting youth, injuring three students, he claimed.

Mr. Allavaru questioned the use of such weapons against civilians, saying they were meant to be used against terrorists.

NCP(SP) MPs meet Modi, discuss 'issues related to Maharashtra'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and MPs of the Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) on Monday triggered fresh speculation about a possible shift in the party's position on delimitation.

The party's working president, Supriya Sule, however, claimed the delegation had discussed issues concerning Maharashtra.

All eight NCP(SP) Lok Sabha MPs, led by Ms. Sule, met Mr. Modi at the Prime Minister's Office.

The meeting came amid uncertainty over the proposed delimitation exercise, and speculation that the NCP may change its position and support the Bill.

Party spokesperson Mahesh Tapase sought to dispel speculation that the meet had any political significance, or was linked to delimitation. The delegation had raised constituency-specific issues, including drought, onion prices, and pollution in the Chandrabhaga river, he said.

The party's position on delimitation would be decided only after the government introduced a Bill in Parliament, he said. "There is no proposal or discussion on delimitation in Parliament today. First, the Bill should come," he said, adding that the issue would then be discussed within the INDIA bloc.

(With PTI inputs)

Congress slams new rural jobs law amid fall in employment generation

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday criticised the Centre over a sharp decline in employment generation under the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin), which replaced the United Progressive Alliance (UPA)-era Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA), and said the new law should be renamed "rozgar chori" (employment theft).

Data from the Union Rural Development Ministry show that the number of person-days generated under the scheme during its first implementing month of July 2026 was 49.94% lower than the number generated under the MGNREGA in the corresponding month of the previous year.

A person-day is a unit that measures the amount of work done by one person in a working day.

> Under the Modi government, the MGNREGA was scrapped, stripping millions of families of their 'right to work', and in its place, VB-G RAM G was imposed, which wiped out the employment of 50% of labourers
>
> **MALLIKARJUN KHARGE**
> Congress president

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, in a post on social media platform X, said the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) had wielded the "lathi" not only against the youth but also against the country's labourers.

"Under the Modi government, the MGNREGA was scrapped, stripping millions of families of their 'right to work', and in its place, VB-G RAM G was imposed, which wiped out the employment of 50% of labourers. Has the payment of ₹17,144 crore in pending MGNREGA funds been made to the States?" Mr. Kharge said in an online post in Hindi.

On drought assistance

Mr. Kharge also questioned whether any assistance had been provided to drought-affected States. "There is a 26.50% shortfall in sowing for the kharif crop. Does anyone care? Has the Central government taken any steps regarding the funding pattern of VB-G RAM G, on which BJP-ruled States had demanded a review? When the country's poor labourers are suffering the most, the Modi government is snatching away their minimum economic and social security and mocking them," he said.

Congress general secretary (communications) and former Rural Development Minister Jairam Ramesh said the data from the first month of implementation of VB-G RAM G exposed "the cost of destroying the MGNREGA". He argued that the MGNREGA had empowered gram panchayats and freed workers from dependence on "the political whims of the government of the day".

"The Modi government has instead centralised the scheme, imposed a heavy financial burden on State governments, made access increasingly dependent on technology and biometric authentication, removed the guarantee of employment, and made it harder for workers to claim their rights. the VB-G RAM G is simply 'rozgar chori'," Mr. Ramesh said.

Rahul is changing goalposts and disrupting functioning of Parliament, says Nadda

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) on Monday accused the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, and the Congress party of changing goalposts, preventing the House from functioning, and attempting to "create chaos by spreading confusion".

At a press briefing, Union Health Minister J.P. Nadda challenged Mr. Gandhi to debate any issue in the Lok Sabha, saying he would be given a "befitting reply".

"Essentially, their intention is to prevent the House from functioning, and that is why they have been disrupting the proceedings for the past 15 days," Mr. Nadda said, calling the Congress an "irresponsible" Opposition.

"Their objective is not to engage in dialogue but to spread chaos. At the start of the parliamentary session, they demanded a discussion on National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test (NEET) [paper leak issue]. When we agreed, they moved on to the Ram Mandir Trust. Then, they demanded a statement from the Home Minister on the Jantar Mantar matter," Mr. Nadda said.

J.P. Nadda

"Today, after it was decided that the Jantar Mantar issue would be taken up, they are misleading the people and the country by claiming that shots were fired at Jantar Mantar. In reality, no shots were fired there, and no such order was issued," he said.

'Spreading confusion'

"Today, they have shifted the goalposts and are trying to spread confusion. When the Home Minister has said that he is ready to answer every question raised by the Opposition, why are they running away from the discussion," Mr. Nadda said.

The government had never shied away from taking up any issue, Mr. Nadda said. "You wanted to discuss SIR (special intensive revision of electoral rolls). We held the discussion, but you walked out. You demanded a discussion on price rise, but did not even have the courage to remain in the House when it was debated. This is your track record," he said.

AMARAVATI GROWTH AND INFRASTRUCTURE CORPORATION LIMITED (AGICL)
2nd Floor, APCRDA Office, Rayapudi, Thulluru Mandal, (A.P.)

E-Procurement Tender Notice

RFP. No. 17/MD/CE/AGICL/2026 Date: 10.08.2026

Name of Work: "Request For Proposal for Development of Amaravati Eye (Ferris Wheel) in Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh on Public Private Partnership (DBFOT) Mode." The bid can be downloaded on AP e-procurement portal from **11-August-2026 15:00 hrs.** For further details, please refer to **www.apeprocurement.gov.in** and **www.agicl.org**

Sd/- Managing Director, AGICL, Amaravati

KERALA STATE ELECTRICITY BOARD LIMITED - TENDER NOTICE

O/o the Deputy Chief Engineer, Transmission Circle, Vydyuthi Bhavanam, Kannur.
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_864663, PAC: Rs. Rs.1,13,12,678/-, Last Date: 21.08.2026, 05.00 pm

O/o the Deputy Chief Engineer, Transmission Circle, Malappuram
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_864698_1, PAC: Rs. Rs.8,21,70,307/-, Last Date: 29.08.2026, 04.00 pm

O/o the Executive Engineer, Transmission Division, Mavelikara, Alappuzha.
E-Tender ID No.2026_KSEB_864197_1, PAC: Rs. Rs.1,16,86,021/-, Last Date: 03.09.2026, 03.00 pm

Visit **www.etenders.kerala.gov.in** and **www.kseb.in**
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NATIONAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING (NCB)/OPEN TENDER ENQUIRY (OTE)

BRBNMPL invites bids under two-bid systems from eligible bidders for following e-tenders through MSTC portal:

1. **Tender No. 016/MYS/MMD/2026-27, MSTC EVENT No. BRBNMPL / Mysuru Press/MMD/17/26-27/ET/37[Renovation of Community Centre] -** Renovation of Community Centre at BRBNMPL Township, **Note Mudran Nagar, Mysuru.**
2. **Tender No. 017/MYS/MMD/2026-27, MSTC EVENT No. BRBNMPL/ Mysuru Press/MMD/18/26-27/ET/39[HDPE Woven Bag] -** Supply of HDPE Woven Bags (Type-A & Type-B) at BRBNMPL, Mysuru Press & Salboni Press.
3. **Tender No. 018/MYS/MMD/2026-27, MSTC EVENT No. BRBNMPL/ Mysuru Press/MMD/20/26-27/ET/41[O&M of Township Electric]-** Operation and Maintenance of Township Electric at BRBNMPL, Mysuru.

Last date and time of tender submission is on or before 11/09/2026 by 11:00 AM.
For downloading tender documents, and other details, kindly visit our website **www.brbnmpl.co.in** and **www.mstcecommerce.com**. Any modification will be notified on above websites only.

Sr. General Manager

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Invitation For Bids - Bid Identification No.624/EM/BDA/2026-27 Date: 07/08/2026

Engineer Member, BDA on behalf of Bhubaneswar Development Authority, Bhubaneswar invites percentage rate bids in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for civil works as mentioned below :

1. Nature of works : **Development of Parks and Market Place at K 7, Kalinga Nagar, Bhubaneswar.**
2. Total No. of works : **01 (One) No.**
3. Amount put to tender : **Rs.1.95 Crore**
4. Class of Contractor : **"B" and "A" Class**
5. Period of Completion : **04 (Four) Calendar months**
6. Cost of Bid Documents : **Rs.10000.00 + 18% GST=Rs.11800.00** (Online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids)
7. Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) : **1% of estimated cost put to tender** (Online transfer by the last date & time for receipt of bids)
8. Availability of Tender : **From 12.08.2026, 10.00 AM to 5.30 PM of 28.08.2026 https://tendersodisha.gov.in.**
9. Date of opening of Tender : **Dt.29.08.2026 at 11.30 AM**
10. Place of opening of Tender : **O/o - Engineer Member, BDA, Bhubaneswar.**

Further details can be seen from the website: **https://tendersodisha.gov.in.** Any addendum / Corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.

CE-Cum-EM, BDA, Bhubaneswar.
13001/1465/2627
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Phone: 044 –27472104, 27472113, 27472423, 27472046, Toll Free No: 18004250345
www.niepmd.nic.in
E-mail: niepmd@gmail.com, niepmdhrd@gmail.com, niepmd@gov.in

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- For details on application process: eligibility, norms, guidelines and curriculum please refer to the RCI website.
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Schedule of EOI document publish on BESCOM website is as below :

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Date: 10.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Tenders are invited by **KS&DL** in two cover system through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal (Website **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/)** with respect to supply of following Goods/Services/Works.

Sl. No.	Tender Number	Tender Name	Tender Quantity/ Tender Category	Published date	Last Date of Submission
1	KSDL/2026-27/IND1302	Procurement of 50g. Fluoridated Tooth Paste with Tooth Brush Free	3960000 Nos.	08-08-2026	24-08-2026
2	KSDL/2026-27/IND1303	Procurement of Fluoridated Tooth Paste 100g	4320000 Nos.	08-08-2026	24-08-2026
3	KSDL/2026-27/SE0255	Disposal of Mixed Waste Paper at KSDL, Bengaluru Complex on AS IS WHERE IS BASIS	Services	10-08-2026	24-08-2026

For any further queries/clarifications please contact the undersigned.

Sd/- Asst. General Manager (Materials)

INBRIEF

India donates five peacocks to Geneva's United Nations Office

India has donated five peacocks, including a rare white-feathered one, to the United Nations Office at Geneva (UNOG), reviving a decades-old tradition. At a special ceremony held on Friday, India's Permanent Representative to the UN in Geneva, Arindam Bagchi, formally handed over the five peacocks to UNOG Director-General Tatiana Valovaya. "The Indian Peacock, a symbol of grace, beauty and resilience, represents India's enduring commitment to the conservation of biodiversity and environmental stewardship," the Indian mission said. The five young peacocks comprise four blue peafowl and one white-feathered male. PTI

Unemployment rate increases in April-June quarter: survey

The unemployment rate for persons aged 15 years and above rose to 5.4% in the April-June 2026 quarter, up 0.4 percentage points from the previous quarter, according to the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) released by the Union Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation on Monday. The rural unemployment rate was 4.8% (4.3% in January-March) while the urban rate edged up to 6.7% from 6.6%. Among rural males, the unemployment rate was 4.8%, and for rural females, it was 4.7%. Among urban females, the unemployment rate was 8.7%, compared to 6.1% among males.

Bangladesh urges India to expedite Hasina's extradition

Indian High Commissioner Trivedi calls on Bangladesh PM Rahman; 'somewhat reassured' after the meeting, says Minister; exchanged views on 'matters of mutual interest', says Indian mission

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Bangladesh has urged India to "expedite" the extradition of former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, who took shelter in India after being deposed in 2024. The matter featured in a discussion when Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi called on Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman on Monday.

The meeting took place amid tension in bilateral relations following Ms. Hasina's virtual press conference on August 5, in which she had criticised Mr. Tarique Rahman's government.

Following the meeting in Dhaka, Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman said that he felt "somewhat reassured" by the conversation that took place between Mr. Tarique Rahman and Mr. Trivedi.

"Bangladesh hopes that India will expedite the process of extraditing Sheikh Hasina," said Shahadat Shadhin, the Prime Minister's Deputy Press Secretary. The meeting took place at the Bangladesh Prime Minister's Office in the Secretariat in Dhaka, Mr. Shadhin said, and added, "Prime Minister emphasised on the need to create a conducive environment to further advance India-Bangladesh bilateral relations."

Dinesh Trivedi (right) with Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman during a meeting in Dhaka on Monday. PTI

Positive development

Mr. Khalilur Rahman and Foreign Affairs Adviser Humayun Kobir were present during the meeting.

"The Prime Minister at the same time reiterated the request to extradite the suspected killers who are connected to the assassination of Shaheed Osman Hadi," said Mr. Shadhin, referring to reports that the individuals connected to the December 2025 killing of Hadi had fled to India.

The Indian High Commission in Bangladesh said the two sides "exchanged views on matters of mutual interest" to strengthen relation with a "people-centric approach".

Following the meeting, Mr. Khalilur Rahman said, "On August 5, Ms. Hasina undermined the Justice Department of Bangladesh, which is a pillar of our nation. The Government of India had allowed her to do that. We want all states in the world to respect our state institutions. We hope the Government of India will understand that matter."

"After talking to them, I am somewhat reassured that such incidents will not be repeated," said Mr. Khalilur Rahman while speaking to the presspersons after the meeting. He further said that Mr. Tarique Rahman has two invites from India, one for the BRICS summit in September and another for a bilateral visit.

Diplomatic sources here have interpreted the meeting as a positive development as it came at a time when Dhaka is also hosting a high-level security-related delegation from India.

Hasina's conference

The Bangladesh government had said that it was "outraged" by the remarks made by Ms. Hasina in the press conference held in New Delhi's Foreign Correspondent Club. Mr. Kobir had met Mr. Trivedi before the conference saying that Ms. Hasina's political activities from India could "harm" positive movements in bilateral ties.

SC proposes special courts for violence cases in Manipur

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

CBI's status report revealed that out of 904 witnesses in the CBI cases, 891 were yet to be examined

The Supreme Court on Monday proposed special courts to exclusively hear Manipur ethnic violence cases investigated by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) and the National Investigation Agency (NIA).

A Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant made a request to the Chief Justice of the Gauhati High Court to constitute special courts, separately to hear CBI and NIA cases linked to the 2023 Manipur violence on a day-to-day basis. The court sought a status report on this aspect by the next date of hearing.

Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati submitted from the latest status report that out of the 31 cases investigated by the CBI, final reports were filed in 27, including 22 chargesheets and five closure reports. Four cases remain under investigation.

Ms. Bhati said cognisance was already taken in 20 of the 22 chargesheeted cases. The law officer said only one of the 22 cases was triable by a Magistrate, while the remaining involved serious offences to be tried by a Sessions court. Ms. Bhati said the NIA had investigated a total 30 cases, of which chargesheets were filed in 15 while the remaining 15 were still under investigation.

Earlier hearings had seen the top court insist on status reports on the investigation detailing evidence to "bring home the guilt" of persons accused of various heinous offences, including the sexual assault and gang rape of women during the sectarian violence that rocked the northeastern State.

The CBI's status report had revealed that out of 904 witnesses in the CBI cases, 891 were yet to be examined. "Having regard to the total number of witnesses proposed to be examined, we request the Chief Justice of the Gauhati High Court to consider the feasibility of allowing the CBI/NIA court to exclusively deal with Manipur-related cases. Other cases be transferred to some other court," the top court said.

9 of family killed as van swept away in flooded drain in M.P.

The Hindu Bureau
BHOPAL

Nine members of a family, three of them children, were killed on Monday after the van they were travelling in was swept away while crossing a swollen drain in Rajgarh district of Madhya Pradesh amid flood-like conditions caused by heavy rain.

Of the 11 people in the van, only two, including the driver, were rescued, Sarangpur Sub-Divisional Officer of Police Arvind Singh said.

The victims, hailing from Satwas in Dewas district, were travelling to a shrine in Kadlawad when the incident took place around 9 a.m. at a small bridge over the drain in Padana village.

The driver of the van reportedly ignored warnings from people about water flowing over the bridge and attempted to cross it, an official said.

A crane lifts the van out of a flooded drain at Padana on Monday. PTI

"When we were in [the middle of] rescue efforts elsewhere in the morning, we received information from Padana about the van. The rescue teams reached the spot soon and all nine bodies were recovered by afternoon. The van was pulled out using a crane," Mr. Singh said, adding that teams from the State Disaster Emergency Response Force and the Home Guard were also involved in the efforts.

Financial aid of ₹4 lakh to the next of kin of each of the deceased has been announced by the administration.

The police are conducting a preliminary investigation, and legal action will be taken against the driver if negligence is found on his part.

Post-mortem examinations have been conducted on the rescued bodies, Mr. Singh said.

Vande Mataram to be sung at Red Fort during Independence Day ceremony

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

The National Song, *Vande Mataram*, will be sung from the ramparts of the Red Fort for the first time as Prime Minister Narendra Modi arrives for the 80th Independence Day celebrations on August 15, while young students and members of Gen Z will get greater representation at the ceremony, with student achievers to be seated on the ramparts.

Youth in focus

Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh on Monday said that the move assumes significance as 2026 marks 150 years of the National Song, which played a prominent role in mobilising people during the freedom struggle. The song will be rendered upon the Prime Minister's arrival, after which he will unfurl the National Flag and deliver his customary address to the nation. The celebrations will have a pronounced focus on "*Yuva Shakti*", with the contribution of young Indians to the government's vision of a "Viksit Bharat by 2047" being highlighted.

The song will be rendered upon the PM's arrival, after which he will unfurl the National Flag. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

As part of the commemoration of *Vande Mataram*, 2,500 National Cadet Corps cadets and MY Bharat volunteers will form the words "*Vande Mataram*" on Gyanpath opposite the Red Fort ramparts. An Indian Air Force Mi-17 helicopter will fly over the venue carrying a banner marking 150 years of the National Song and shower flower petals over the gathering, he added.

He said the youth-centric theme will also be reflected in the participation of 19 Indian medal winners from the International Physics, Chemistry, Biology and Mathematical Olympiads 2026. They will be seated on the ramparts during the ceremony.

Pan-India guests

Nearly 5,000 special guests have been invited, including young innovators, entrepreneurs, start-up founders, skilled workers, farmers, artisans, sanitation workers and beneficiaries of various government schemes. More than 1,500 Delhi-based guests from different States and Union Territories, dressed in traditional attire, will showcase the country's cultural diversity. Around 600 winners of quizzes and competitions organised by the Defence Ministry in collaboration with MyGov will also attend the celebrations.

For visitors, 25 cloak rooms at six locations and 20 wheelchairs have been arranged. Metro services will begin at 4 a.m. on August 15, with free travel for invitees.

11 new entry points added for e-visa holders: govt.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Union Home Ministry has expanded the number of international ports through which foreign nationals holding e-visas can enter the country, adding 11 new entry points, including nine land ports and two airports.

The move is aimed at facilitating travel and boosting the attractiveness of the electronic visa regime.

The Ministry said the newly notified entry points comprise the airports at Bhopal and Tirupati, and the land ports of Agartala, Darranga, Gede, Ghojadanga, Haridaspur, Jaigaon, Dawki, Moreh and Attari (Road).

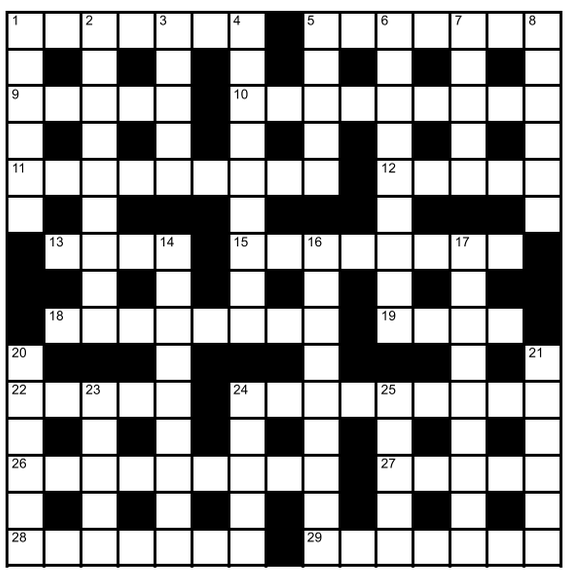
With the latest addition, the total number of international ports authorised for entry of e-visa holders has risen to 88.

TH CROSSWORD + 14869

(set by Arden)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Run over chasing main pirate (3,4)
5 Ran around carrying oil through a cloud of gas and dust (7)
9 In the plan aims to accommodate a verandah (5)
10 On record it is a complaint (9)
11 In an extremely wretched way, getting through with modest investment in a year (9)
12 Panic on seeing some of these figures (5)
13 Reward if leader goes for duty (4)
15 Worries about touring team's ID badges (4,4)
18 Passionate check over macho males (8)
19 Animal brought back in a rush (4)
22 True male specialty (5)
24 Sadness on coping with any misbehaviour (9)
26 Original art, new nation follows American actor (9)
27 Love putting our middle name in front (5)
28 Sunday worship helps farmers (7)
29 Refuse to return and receive attention one longed for (7)

Down

1 Extremely scary, left in front amid all the trees (6)
2 Anyone can get agitated and show displeasure (9)
3 Number starts with one — payment is usually monthly (5)
4 Independent cover up inland (9)
5 Trendy Times in denial (5)
6 Counsel picks up knight in exchange (9)
7 Besotted bachelor goes for a game of chance (5)
8 Counter is found among others (6)
14 First thing needed for business growth (4,5)
16 Many houses fit only for marriage (9)
17 Party with Trump as an apprentice (9)
20 Bottom string for instrument picked up for free (6)
21 Happy birthday, missing at compound (6)
23 Dry outside on the clothesline (5)
24 He assisted the abbot earlier (5)
25 In Tuscany, a large animal is found (5)

SUDOKU

					6			
		5	7				8	4
			8		2	9		5
9	4						2	
5		1				4		8
	7						9	6
6		2	4		1			
8	3				7	2		
			9					

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★☆

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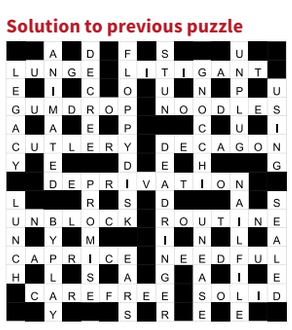
Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

1	2	6	9	8	4	5	3	7
9	3	4	6	5	7	2	1	8
5	8	7	1	2	3	9	4	6
2	5	3	4	6	1	7	8	9
4	1	9	2	7	8	3	6	5
6	7	8	3	9	5	1	2	4
7	4	5	8	3	2	6	9	1
3	6	1	5	4	9	8	7	2
8	9	2	7	1	6	4	5	3

FAITH

Somasimaara Nayanar

Sekkizhaar, the Chief Minister of Kulothunga Chola II, composed the Peria Puranam, in order to highlight the correct philosophy of life, at a time when material prosperity was high and worldly pleasures and material wealth were celebrated. The work celebrates the lives of the 63 Nayanmars (Saivite saints) from various walks of life, bound together by their selfless love of humanity and a latent spirit of service and sacrifice.

The Nayanmars were true devotees of Siva, chanting the Panchakshara mantra, of five letters, serving servitors of Lord Siva, founded on an unshakable base of enduring love for God. Somasimaara Nayanar was one such, said P. Swaminathan. Born in Ambar, Somasimaara gained the name due to his habit of conducting yagas. A staunch devotee, he chanted the Panchakshara in his waking hours as well as in his dreams, for gaining clarity of mind. Not only did he serve the men of God personally, but he also fed them to their satisfaction. Sekkizhaar says Somasimaara held that 'whatever be their nature or status, if they are devotees of the Lord, people of such nature are my rulers.' Desirous of serving Vanthondar (Sundarar), and impelled by the prevailing piety in that town, Somasimaara went to Tiruvarur. Desiring to conduct another yaga, he humbly beseeched Sundarar to ask Siva and Parvati to attend his yaga. Siva and Parvati came in disguise, accompanied by Vinayaka and Muruga and readily accepted the oblations. The revelation of the celestial family was an eye-opener to all that one who renders service and remains steadfast in one's faith is Siva's delight. Sundarar himself said, "*Servitor am I to the man from Ambar, Somasimaraa.*"

INBRIEF

Under-recovery on domestic LPG narrows to ₹188/cylinder

State-owned oil-marketing companies narrowed their under-recoveries on domestic liquified petroleum gas in August to about ₹188 per cylinder, Minister of State for Petroleum and Natural Gas Suresh Gopi told the Lok Sabha. Mr. Gopi said despite compensating for subsidies in FY23, FY26 and FY27, accumulated OMC losses rose to ₹59,000 crore as on July 31 this year. While under-recovery was ₹500 per cylinder in July, it was over ₹700 per cylinder in June.

TRAI directs use of 1601-series for service, transactional calls

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) on Monday directed the use of a separate 1601-series number for transactional and service calls by entities in sectors other than Banking, Financial Services & Insurance (BFSI) and Government. In the first phase, the series will cover transactional and service calls made by entities in utilities, courier and logistics sectors, TRAI said, making it clear that it should not be used for promotional voice calls by any entity. PTI

Purvah Green Power, ReNew sign ₹4,859-crore solar deal

RP-Sanjiv Goenka Group (RPSG) subsidiary, Purvah Green Power Pvt. Ltd., the renewable energy platform of CESC Ltd., is set to buy 1.4 GWp solar portfolio from ReNew Solar Power Pvt. Ltd. for ₹4,859 crore. An agreement was signed to buy the portfolio comprising six special purpose vehicles (SPVs) across Rajasthan and Karnataka. The acquisition would be funded by parent company and likely to be completed by October, CESC Ltd. said in a filing.

Russia's share in India's oil imports jumps to 48% in June

The U.S. Senate has passed a bill that will see tariffs of up to 100% being levied on top 5 countries importing Russian oil and gas; the Bill now awaits passage in the House of Representatives

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

At a time when the U.S. looks all set to enact legislation to impose a tariff of up to 100% on India for its Russian oil imports, an analysis of the latest data shows Russia's share in India's oil imports rose to an all-time-high of 48% in June 2026.

The U.S. Senate last week passed the bipartisan Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 which seeks to levy tariffs of up to 100% on countries that continue to buy Russian oil and gas, and that were the largest purchasers of these products from Russia over the previous year. India qualifies for tariffs under these criteria. The Bill still requires to be passed by the U.S. House of Representatives before it becomes law.

An analysis by *The Hindu* of the latest data from the Ministry of Commerce and Industry shows that India significantly lowered its total crude oil imports in June 2026. In terms of volume, June crude oil imports at 18.2 million metric tonnes (MMT) were down 16.5% compared with May 2026, and were 13% lower than in June last year.

However, elevated crude oil prices this year have meant that the oil import bill, while 22% lower in June 2026 than in May, was still 40% higher than in June of last year.

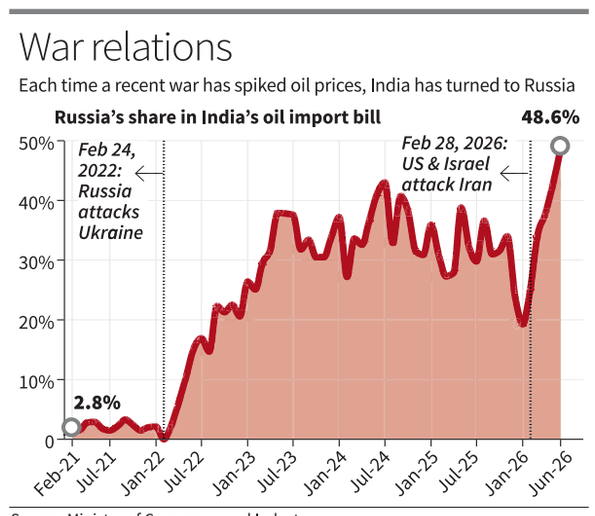
While India drastically cut down on overall oil imports, its purchases from Russia bucked this trend. That is, India imported 8.7 MMT of Russian oil in June 2026, just 1% lower than in May, and 25% higher than in June of last year.

As a result of this strategy, Russia's share in India's crude oil imports jumped to 48% in terms of quantity and 48.6% in terms of the value. Russia's share has been rising consistently every month since March and the outbreak of the war in West Asia.

According to the U.S. Bill, the tariffs would apply on a country that was among the five largest importers of crude oil or natural gas from Russia during the 12 months preceding the date of the enactment of the Act, and that then continues to import oil or gas from Russia after 30 days of the enactment.

China and India are the top two importers of Russian oil and India's rising dependence on Russian oil shows it cannot quickly cut back on this source at a time when supplies through the Strait of Hormuz are still constrained.

The premium Russia has charged India for its oil has been steadily declining, data shows, from $77.7 per tonne in April 2026 to $10.6 per tonne in June. Russia had been providing India a discount until as recently as February 2026.



Sanctions exposure

The Bill also specifies that tariffs could be imposed on countries that have helped Russia evade sanctions. The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoPNG) told *The Hindu* that India has specifically taken measures to pre-empt any sanctions exposure.

"It [sanctions exposure] was pre-empted through ship-to-ship transfer operations in international waters via the Red Sea route through Yanbu and Fujairah precisely so that a single choke point, or a single sanctions regime, could not halt India-bound cargo," MoPNG said in a clarificatory note it had sent *The Hindu* in late July.

It is unclear as of now whether India's actions would entail helping Russia evade sanctions.

Apart from Russia, the United Arab Emirates (UAE) too saw its share in India's oil imports rise to historic highs. India sourced 17.5% of its oil imports by volume from the UAE in June 2026 and 18% by value, the highest share for both so far.

Taken together, this means that Russia and the UAE together accounted for nearly two-thirds of India's oil imports in June 2026, the highest-ever combined share enjoyed by any two countries. The MoPNG, however, said that such concentration was not a matter of concern given Indian oil marketing companies stand ready to diversify quickly.

"Indian refineries had spent a decade acquiring the logistical flexibility to switch between crude grades and shipping routes the moment disruption struck, which is the definition of a diversification strategy, not its absence," the note said.

GEC third phase in final stages, up for Cabinet approval

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The government is in the final planning stages of instituting the third phase of the intra-state Green Energy Corridor (GEC), senior government officials privy to the development told *The Hindu*, adding that it had been sent to the Union Cabinet for the final approval.

Separately, another official said that the scheme would carry an outlay of more than ₹50,000 crore.

The Hindu also learnt from officials that the focus in the third phase would be on augmenting the intra-state transmission lines further in "renewable-energy rich States" among other things.

"Most of the packages under the second phase have been awarded. It is expected to complete in the next 2 years," a senior official said, adding, "Now we are mulling another scheme [that is, the third phase], we are seeking to institute a scheme for renewable energy-rich States for developing transmission lines to evacuate renewable energy from one location to another."

The purpose of GECs is to transmit electricity produced from renewable sources, as solar and wind, from areas rich in the sources to distant places by synchronising them with conventional power stations in the grid.

In a submission to the parliamentary standing committee on Energy on August 6, the Ministry for New and Renewable Energy had stated that it aimed to "evacuate about 135 gigawatts of renewable energy in the third phase."

Focus would be on augmenting intra-state transmission lines in renewable-energy rich States

In the same report, the committee had flagged concerns that had led to delays in completion of Phase-I and Phase-II of the GEC. These relate to "right of ways (RoW), delay in award, forest clearances and Great Indian Bustard (GIB)-related clearances" in the first phase.

It added that "non-participation of States during tending process, consultation of tender and regulatory issues, etc," were among the issues observed in the second phase.

The committee had also observed that seven out of eight States, that is, excluding Gujarat, had completed their work under the first phase, with States part of the second phase having sought an extension with the ministry "actively monitoring the completion through dedicated review mechanisms".

'Geopolitics driving valuation discipline for IPOs in H12026'

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

Valuations of companies planning to get listed on the stock markets have moderated to more 'disciplined' levels, following increased market volatility driven by geopolitical uncertainties.

"Investors are rewarding firms with strong fundamentals. Clear earnings visibility and reasonable valuations continue to receive strong demand, while aggressively priced initial public offerings (IPOs) are seeing a more cautious response," said Sumeet Lath, associate director and co-head - ECM execution at Anand Rathi Advisors Ltd.

Current pricing may mark the start of the next IPO cycle.

This was not the case last year when several issuers sought to maximise valuations by pricing IPOs at the upper end of listed peer multiples, he added.

Companies that seek listing have adjusted to this reality. Many of the entities, which may have planned to list in the beginning of the calendar year, deferred plans as geopolitical tensions turned stock markets volatile and listing outcomes uncertain.

"This is working well for investors. IPOs with market capitalisation of between ₹8000 crore to ₹40,000 crore are sweet spots for investments as these falls under multiple investment mandates" said Bharat Lahoti, president and co-head, factor investing, Edelweiss MF.

Race against time

There is also a race against time to complete the listing as favourable issuance windows are becoming fewer and less predictable, especially with the expiry of the listing application looming, according to Mr. Lath.

"As of June, 176 firms had valid Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) approvals with 74 more awaiting approval."

An IPO is usually a 3-4 year journey with SEBI nod as the last milestone.

Many firms hence choose to proceed despite lower-than-desired valuations or reduced issue size than wait for ideal market conditions and risk letting nod lapse, said Pranav Haldea, MD, PRIME Database.

A slower IPO market has led to the start of the next cycle. This transition period of pricing discipline is the start of the next IPO boom, Mr. Lahoti said.

AAI got request for waiver of airport-airline cross ownership restriction: Govt.

Jagriti Chandra
NEW DELHI

The Airports Authority of India (AAI) received a request seeking a waiver from provisions that bar cross-ownership of airports and airlines, the government told Parliament amid reports the Adani Group sought relaxations as it explored entering the airline business.

"Request seeking waiver of the relevant agreement provision has been received by Airports Authority of India," Minister of State for Civil Aviation Murlidhar Mohol said responding to a question from CPI (M) MP John Brittas in the Rajya Sabha.

Though Adani Enterprises denied the media reports, a prominent business daily subsequently cited a letter from Adani Airports CEO Arun Bansal seeking relaxations from the government.

Mr. Brittas also asked if the Centre had assessed the potential impact of such cross-ownership on competition, conflict of interest, slot allocation, airport charges, ground handling and fair access to airport infrastructure for competing airlines.

"The matter has not yet been examined by the Ministry of Civil Aviation," Mr. Mohol replied, without naming the entity that sought the waiver.

The concession agreements for Delhi and Mumbai airports cap aggregate airline ownership in the airport operator at 10%, while those for the Noida International Airport (Jewar) and Navi Mumbai airport allow up to 26% ownership in an airline. These provisions can also be applied in the reverse, restricting airport operators from acquiring significant stakes in airlines.

Life insurers' new business premium rose 20% in July

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Life insurers mobilised ₹47,004.84 crore new business premium (NBP) in July or a 20% rise vis a vis July 2025. State-owned LIC led the segment with more than a 23% rise in NBP or first year premium to ₹27,993.61 crore. Private life insurers (26) secured ₹19,011.23 crore, a 16% rise.

Emkay Research said life insurers' stocks saw corrections over the past few months on regulatory overhang. At current level, valuations inadequately reflect franchise strengths – brand, distribution and scale – of the players.

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LEGAL NOTICE

In the Court of the III Addl. District Judge:: Nellore, A.P.
A.O.P.No.93/2024
Shaik Sulthan ... Appellant
Vs
1.M/s. SBI Cards & Payments Service Ltd., New Delhi-110 034.
2.Shri Yash Anand, Arbitrator ... Respondents
Notice to 2nd Respondent
Shri Yash Anand, Arbitrator CH.No.X41 Civil Side, Tis-Hazari Court, Delhi-110054.
Please take notice that the above named appellant filed the above A.O.P.No.93/2024 against you and the matter stands posted to 20-08-2026 for your appearance. you are here by directed to appear before the Hon'ble Court on 20-08-2026 at 10.30 A.M. either in person or an Advocate, failing which the matter will be decided in your exparte against you.
S.P.S. Vijaya Saradhi, B.Com., B.L., K.Shafie, B.A., B.L., Advocates for the Appellant, Nellore

PERSONAL
CHANGE OF NAME

I, HITHERTO known as S.Nagalakshmi w/o k sunmugam r/o 16, F–block, Mangolpuri, delhi –110083 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Nagalakshmi.

I, ZEBUN Nisa, r/o 971, St 30/9, Jafrabad, Delhi–53, have changed my name to Zaibun Nisha Begum, w/o Yunus Ali for all future purposes.

I, ASIF Ali Ansari, r/o 971, St. No. 30/9, Jafrabad, Delhi–53, have changed my minor daughter's name from Maryam to Maryam Ansari.

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ENTREPRENEURSHIP FEST HELD

Bal Bharati Public School, Rohini, organised 'Pitch Perfect 1.0', their first two-day Inter-School Entrepreneurship Competition, bringing together 20 teams from various schools. Organised by the school's Entrepreneurship Cell with Gitarattan International Business School (GIBS), the event featured orientation sessions and ideation workshops by GIBS faculty, with students designing business solutions on AI for Everyday Problems, Financial Empowerment and Inclusion, and Dignified Living for Seniors. Final presentations were evaluated by judges from Rukmini Devi Institute of Advanced Studies and Jamia Hamdard, who appreciated the originality and social relevance of the ideas, before winning teams were felicitated.

INTERZOID CELEBRATES INDIA

Delhi Public School, Ghaziabad, Vasundhara, hosted their 11th Interzoid, bringing together over 200 learners from schools across Delhi-NCR under the theme "Incredible India." The celebrations commenced with the lighting of the lamp, followed by musical and dance performances. Principal Dr Vinod Kumar inspired participants to embrace curiosity and lifelong learning before formally declaring the event open. Competitions included Runway Walk, Storytelling, Creative Clay, Doodle Art, Kavya Manch, Mega Quiz, Cod Eclectic, e-Insight, Terra Pitch and Tech Aware, judged by eminent guests whose encouragement elevated the celebration of learning and culture.

SCHOLAR BADGES AWARDED

Delhi Public School, Rohini, organised the Scholar Badge and Award Ceremony for Classes VI to VIII and XII. Principal Mrs. Kanika Sachdeva Govi welcomed the gathering and congratulated Class XII toppers Aditya Banerjee, who secured All India Rank 96 and Delhi State Rank 8 in NEET, and Saksham Goel, who secured All India Rank 2 in CUET (UG). Ms. Nikita Manocha conducted a session on digital well-being, followed by the dance presentation "Unheard." Scholar Badges were presented to meritorious students, and the ceremony concluded with the National Anthem in Sign Language.

For Subscription related queries, please contact Kapil Nagar:
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LAHORE

Final poll phase delayed in parts of Pakistan-occupied Kashmir

AP

The third round of regional polls in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir was marred by delays and security concerns on Monday, weeks after deadly protests erupted in the region. Polls in seven of the 11 constituencies were postponed. The ruling Pakistan Muslim League (N) has won 24 of the 34 seats contested in earlier rounds. REUTERS

TEHRAN

Saudi Arabia-Pakistan-Turkiye deal shows shifting stance with U.S.: Iran

REUTERS

Iran's Foreign Ministry said on Monday that a defence pact signed last week between Saudi Arabia, Turkiye and Pakistan was "a sign of a change in the perception" towards the U.S. "The countries of the region have realised that security is not a commodity that can be bought from false brokers," said spokesman Esmaeil Baqaei. AFP

PARIS

Most European countries brace for next round of summer heatwave

AFP

Much of Europe is bracing for yet another heatwave. Parts of Britain and France on Monday were already under extreme heat warnings. Unusually high temperatures were also forecast in countries not accustomed to the heat, such as Switzerland, Austria and Hungary. Greece reported its second wildfire this season on Monday. AFP

DHAKA

16 Bangladeshi nationals killed in Saudi Arabia sofa factory blaze

REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

Bangladesh's Foreign Ministry said it was in "deep shock" on Monday, following the deaths of 16 citizens in a fire at a sofa factory in Saudi Arabia's capital Riyadh the previous day. The Ministry said it will ensure speedy repatriation of the bodies of the deceased. Over three million Bangladeshis reside in the kingdom. AFP

Mojtaba rejigs Iran's top leadership; Trump demands war compensation

Mohsen Rezaei to head Iran's top security body; his predecessor Mohammad Baqer Zolqadr named as political adviser to the Supreme Leader; Iran Guards get new Commander-in-Chief; Trump responds to Tehran's call for U.S. to meet conditions

Reuters
DUBAI/TEHRAN/WASHINGTON

Iran has carried out changes in its political and national security establishments, with Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei naming former Revolutionary Guards commander Mohsen Rezaei as secretary of the Supreme National Security Council (SNSC), the country's top security body.

A separate decree from Mr. Khamenei named Mr. Rezaei as his representative to the council.

Mr. Rezaei, 71, is more of an outspoken public figure than his predecessor, Mohammad Baqer Zolqadr, who was appointed as political adviser to the Supreme Leader.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian with Mohsen Rezaei, then adviser to Iran's Supreme Leader, at a ceremony in July. REUTERS

On the military front, Revolutionary Guards general Ali Abdollahi was named head of the country's armed forces on Monday. Mr. Abdollahi had previously led Khatam al-Anbiya, Iran's inter-branch central military command tasked with coordinating operations. A statement on Ayatollah Mojtaba's website also confirmed Brigadier General Ahmad Vahidi as new Commander-in-Chief of the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC).

Meanwhile, U.S. President Donald Trump on Monday demanded Iran pay compensation for the deaths of people he said it had killed in wars, attacks and protests over the years, raising the rhetorical stakes with Tehran as hopes faded for an imminent deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

Mr. Trump said he was responding to Iran's earlier call for Washington to meet conditions. "I am likewise demanding compensation from Iran, for all of the people that they have killed and gravely wounded with their roadside bombs and many conflicts, for which they are famous," Mr. Trump wrote on his Truth Social service.

Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian told state media on Monday he had a nearly seven-hour meeting with Ayatollah Mojtaba where they discussed "people's livelihoods, employment, people's housing," as well as "problems being created as a result of the (U.S.) sanctions."

Most important, he said, was Mr. Khamenei's emphasis on unity.

(With inputs from AP and AFP)

13 killed in Ukrainian strike on Russian oil-refining city

Associated Press
MOSCOW

Ukraine attacked the petroleum hub of Nizhnekamsk in central Russia's Tatarstan region on Monday, killing 13 people, including a child, and injuring 75, local authorities said, in one of the deadliest attacks in the country in the four-year-old war.

Ukraine's General Staff said its forces struck a Taneco oil refinery in Nizhnekamsk, starting a fire.

The city came under a "massive" drone attack targeting industrial and civilian facilities, according to the press service of Tatarstan's head, Rustam Minnikhanov.

The city is home to two refineries and a petrochemical plant. Ukraine has targeted Russian oil facilities with long-range drones almost daily in recent months. The campaign has caused fuel shortages in Russia.

Caught in crossfire: Rustam Minnikhanov, Head of the Republic of Tatarstan, meets the injured at a hospital in Nizhnekamsk. REUTERS

Uzbek nationals killed

One of the drones hit a hostel, killing nine of the 13 victims, including citizens of Uzbekistan and Kyrgyzstan, officials said. Uzbekistan's consular office in Tatarstan said seven of its nationals were killed.

A child was among the dead, along with the 75 injured, the press service said, adding that Monday was declared a day of mourning in Tatarstan.

Meanwhile, a Russian glide bomb struck the city of Zaporizhzhia in southern Ukraine, injuring 24 people, authorities said.

Taiwan tests Internet 'throttling' for first time in war exercise

Reuters
TAIPEI

Taiwan slowed the mobile internet in a large swathe of the central part of the island on Monday for the first time during annual war games, simulating communication disruption in the event of a Chinese attack or natural disaster.

Democratically governed Taiwan, which China claims as its own territory, has long lived with the threat of a Chinese invasion and holds air raid drills along with its war games every year, clearing people from the streets for 30 minutes.

During the internet "throttling" drill on Monday on the central metropolis of Taichung, only basic mobile phone services worked, though key services, from ATMs and traffic signals, were not affected, and neither were landlines nor fixed internet services.

Earlier on Monday, Taiwan's military simulated repelling a Chinese air landing assault on the strategically vital Penghu Islands. The 10-day Han Kuang exercise kicked off last week.

Hundreds of Syrian Kurds head back to town after years of displacement

Agence France-Presse
HASAKEH

A first group of Syrian Kurds were headed for the northeastern border town of Ras al-Ain on Monday following years of displacement, months after an integration deal between the Kurds and Damascus.

The January agreement on merging Kurdish forces into the state included the return of displaced Kurds but residents of Ras al-Ain had still been waiting, prompting appeals to authorities for assistance.

Jawan Isso, from a committee representing displaced people from Ras al-Ain, said that a "first batch" of some 2,500 people were headed home on Monday.

Homebound: People wave to a Kurdish family as they make their way towards Ras al-Ain in Hasakah, Syria, on Monday. REUTERS

"This step is the result of efforts by all sides and ongoing coordination" between the Damascus and Kurdish authorities, he said.

Dozens of trucks loaded with furniture and other belongings were seen waiting to set off from near the city of Hasakeh, with men, women and children eager to depart.

"I've been waiting for this moment... it's like a dream for a person to return to their home," said returnee Nora Khodor, 37.

Tens of thousands of Kurds were displaced when Turkiye and allied Syrian fighters seized an Arab-majority strip of territory along the Turkish border, including Ras al-Ain, from Kurdish control in 2019 during Syria's civil war.

India's move to label places in Arunachal Pradesh illegal: China

Press Trust of India
BEIJING

China on Monday termed India's move to identify 27 places and features in Arunachal Pradesh by their standard names on the official Indian map as "illegal, null and void".

"China does not recognise the so-called 'Arunachal Pradesh' illegally set up by India," Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun said.

"India's move of attempting to replace names long been used by China with its so-called 'standard names' is illegal, null and void," he said in a reply posted on the Ministry's website.

"Still less will it change the fact that Zangnan region belongs to China," he said.

China calls Arunachal Pradesh as Zangnan.

India last week formally identified 27 places and features in the State by their standard names on the official Indian map. Beijing has been periodically releasing Chinese names for locations in the State since 2017 to assert claims over the area.

Sport

Dhamne earns maiden call-up for Korea tie

DAVIS CUP

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Manas Dhamne on Monday earned his first call-up to India's Davis Cup squad, while the team management has retained the core that produced a historic win over the Netherlands for the crucial round two qualifier tie against South Korea in Seoul on September 18 and 19.

Dhamne, World No. 362 and the country's No. 2 singles player, has been knocking on the doors of the senior team.

He joins India's singles group comprising seasoned campaigner Sumit Nagal (ranked 235) and Dhakshineswar Suresh (393), the breakout star of the previous tie in Bengaluru. Yuki Bhambri (ranked 28) and N. Sriram Balaji (57) form the doubles combination.

Sidharth Rawat (ranked 536) and promising youngster Arnav Paparkar, who has been competing in junior Grand Slams, have been named as the two reserves.

"Most players selected themselves. Manas was not available for the previous tie, this time he was. While he is in the main squad, the captain will decide if the conditions suit him or the other singles players. Arnav is in the side as we need to groom the future generation," a selection committee member said.

The selection reflects continuity after India's remarkable 3-2 victory over the Netherlands in Bengaluru in February, which took the country into the second round of the Qualifiers for the first time since the Davis Cup format was revamped in 2019.

Dhamne's inclusion is the only major change to the squad, with Nagal, Dhakshineswar, Yuki and Sriram Balaji retaining their places.

The 19-year-old has been among India's promising young players and his elevation gives the team another singles option ahead of the hard-court contest in Seoul.

The winner of the Seoul tie will qualify for the Davis Cup Final 8 in Bologna in November, giving India an opportunity to reach the elite stage of the competition for the first time in the current format.

The squad:

Sumit Nagal, Dhakshineswar Suresh, Manas Dhamne, Yuki Bhambri, and N. Sriram Balaji.

Reserves: Arnav Paparkar and Sidharth Rawat.

Big step up: The promising Dhamne has won a spot in the National team. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

Exclusive Black lives up to the billing in the feature event

HYDERABAD: Trainer A. Imran Khan's ward Exclusive Black, ridden by P. Trevor, claimed the P.G. Reddy Memorial Trophy (Div. I), the main event of Monday's (Aug. 10) races.

The winner is owned by Mr. Shankar Srinivas & Mrs. Smita Bajoria.

1. P.G. REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. III) (1,200M): VICTORIA DORESAANI (Akshay Kumar) 1, Clefairy (A.A. Vikrant) 2, Glorious Power (Neeraj) 3 and Torchbearer (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 2-1/2, Head and 2-1/4. 1m, 13.99s. ₹12 (w), 12, 19 and 12 (p). SHP: 45, THP: 33, FP: 44, Q: 48, Tanala: 72. Favourite: Victoria Doresaani.

Owner: Mr. Gundla Narender. Trainer: S. Sreekant.

2. ROYAL REVIVE PLATE (1,400M): LOVE ALL (R.S. Jodha) 1, Digital Empress (Akshay K) 2, Toshiro (Neeraj) 3 and Evan Sville (P. Sai K) 4. 4, 2-1/4 and 4-1/2. 1m, 26.04s. ₹86 (w), 20, 12 and 12 (p). SHP: 40, THP: 55, FP: 318, Q: 100, Tanala: 1,077. Favourite: Digital Empress.

Owner: Mr. M. Raghunath rep. Gava Racing Syndicate LLP. Trainer: K. Satheesh.

3. ADLER PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200M): BASILICA (Akshay Kumar) 1, Daring Spirit (Trevor) 2, Dream To Fly (G. Naresh) 3 and La Quinta (Ajay K) 4. 3/4, 3/4 and 3-1/2. 1m, 14.08s. ₹19 (w), 11, 11 and 16 (p). SHP: 31, THP: 41, FP: 44, Q: 26, Tanala: 290. Favourite: Basilica. Owner: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram. Trainer: D. Netto.

4. DEVARAKONDA TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,100M): VARADA (Dhanu S. Deora) 1, Sweet Dancer (P. Ajeeth K) 2, Glimmer Of Hope (B. Nikhil) 3 and Screenshot (Arjun) 4. 6-1/4, 2 and 1/2. 1m, 7.81s. ₹17 (w), 12, 13 and 15 (p). SHP: 29, THP: 80, FP: 32, Q: 23, Tanala: 140. Favourite: Varada.

Owner: Mr. Rohit Gupta rep. Roli Stud Dairy & Agri Farm. Trainer: Magan Singh.

5. P.G. REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): EXCLUSIVE BLACK (P. Trevor) 1, Sangreal (Ajay K) 2, Best Buddy (Md. Ekram) 3 and Federer (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 4-1/4, 3/4 and 4. 1m, 14.16s. ₹12 (w), 11, 74 and 14 (p). SHP: 145, THP: 34, FP: 399, Q: 241, Tanala: 778. Favourite: Exclusive Black. Owners: Mr. Shankar Srinivas & Mrs. Smita Bajoria. Trainer: A. Imran Khan.

6. DEVARAKONDA TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,100M): FEEL THE MAGIC (Dhanu S. Deora) 1, Golden Unicorn (Shivam) 2, Windsor (Surya Prakash) 3 and December Rain (Mohit) 4. 1-1/4, 5-1/2 and 2-1/2. 1m, 8.20s. ₹15 (w), 10, 15 and 32 (p). SHP: 29, THP: 110, FP: 33, Q: 23, Tanala: 583. Favourite: Feel The Magic. Owner: Mr. Ravi Duru Meghawat. Trainer: Magan Singh.

7. P.G. REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200M): STAR FOREVER (P. Sai Kumar) 1, Arthisha (Afroz K) 2, Warwick (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Arion One (B.R. Kumar) 4. Not run: Shadow Baby. 1/2, 3/4 and 3-1/4. 1m, 14.24s. ₹20 (w), 12, 10 and 25 (p). SHP: 34, THP: 69, FP: 55, Q: 39, Tanala: 310. Favourite: Star Forever.

Owners: M/s. Ashok Ranpise, Bollineni Krishnaiah, Seshadri Reddy Pochana, Teegala Sumant Reddy, Teegala Vijender Reddy, Satish Kumar Reddy Poondla, Giri Prathamesh Mahadev & Teja Gollapudi. Trainer: K.S.V. Prasad Raju.

Jackpot: 70%: ₹317 (1,468 tkts.) and 30%: 52 (3,781 tkts.).

Mini Jackpot: (i) 2,992 (21 tkts.), (ii) 140 (542 tkts.).

Treble: (i) 1,642 (17 tkts.), 57 (437 tkts.).

LIVE TELECAST

TNPL: Sony Sports Ten 4 Tamil & TNPL Official YouTube channel (youtube@tamilnadupremier-league.com), 3.30 & 7.30 p.m.

Durand Cup: Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 4 & 7 p.m.

RARING TO GO

World Cup triumph has made the team hungry, says Jemimah

FILE PHOTO: EMMANUAL YOGINI

Jemimah Rodrigues said India's ODI Women's World Cup triumph has made the team hungry for more success. "We know what it feels like to be at the top. The more you taste it, the more you want to be there. Our team is working towards that, and yes, the (inaugural) Champions Trophy (in 2027) is going to be very special," she said.

THANKS, BUT NO THANKS

Barcelona turns down PSG offer for World Cup winner Torres

AFP

Barcelona on Monday rejected an initial offer from Paris Saint-Germain estimated at €40 million for Spanish World Cup winner Ferran Torres. "Negotiations are ongoing" between Barca and PSG, sources said. Out of contract with Barca in June 2027, the 26-year-old striker remained vague about his future in interviews.

BOOSTING THE DEFENCE

Liverpool snaps up Araujo on a season-long loan from Barcelona

GETTY IMAGES

Liverpool has signed Uruguay defender Ronald Araujo from Spanish champion Barcelona on a season-long loan, the Premier League club announced on Monday. British media reported that the deal includes an option to buy the 27-year-old for about £47 million. Araujo arrives at a time when Liverpool is facing defensive issues.

FRENCH FLAVOUR

PSG signs defender Digne from Villa on a three-year deal

REUTERS

Champions League winner Paris Saint-Germain has strengthened its defence by signing left-back Lucas Digne from Aston Villa on a three-year deal. PSG announced the deal on Sunday without giving financial details. The 33-year-old was born in the Paris suburbs and previously played for PSG after joining from Lille in 2013.

SAI and BAI go all out to ensure a hassle-free World championships

After the backlash during the Indian Open owing to poor infrastructure, the venue has undergone massive upgrades and refurbishment over the past six months; innovative measures taken to prevent the entry of birds and monkeys

BADMINTON

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

Having suffered a massive backlash for poor infrastructure and entry of pigeons and monkeys during the India Open earlier this year, the Badminton Association of India and SAI have gone all out to ensure the upcoming BWF World championships go on without a glitch.

The Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, venue for the prestigious World Championships returning to India after 17 years, has undergone massive upgrades and refurbishment over the past six months, both structural and cosmetic.

"We started work in February itself. Since the infrastructure is very old, there were a lot of structural damages that we had to take care of.

"The old roof has been treated and repaired to make it waterproof, a lot of expansion joints have been treated, a lot of chairs in the seating area replaced," Ambar Pratap Singh, Executive Director of SAI's newly-formed engineering division, explained.

In ready mode: The venue for the World championships gets the final touches. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

As for invaders of the avian and simian variety, all entry points to the main arena of the three main buildings that are part of the complex – the main badminton arena, the velodrome and the K.D. Jadhav Hall – have been equipped with automatic glass double doors to prevent entry.

Non-toxic gel to prevent pigeons from perching over courts, imported machines to produce sound frequency to repel birds at night and employing three men to mimic langurs are among the more innovative measures being taken to ensure there are no complaints.

Among other technical upgrades is the lighting system that has been changed by SAI and additional lights being deployed by BAI to eliminate any shadows on the newly-laid wooden courts.

"Lighting was not an issue during India Open also but we have made it even better now. The Badminton World Federation (BWF) is satisfied with the lighting in both the competition and practice arena," BAI secretary Sanjay Mishra said.

Pratap Singh added that the recent heavy spell of rainfall had helped the officials identify any issues in the structure ahead of the event, to be held from August 17-23.

"There were a few leakages but they have all been plugged.

"One part of the K.D. Jadhav Hall has also been upgraded to be used for practice," he said.

'Just another match': Ayush ready to take on No. 1 Shi

Anirudh Velamuri
HYDERABAD

With the World championships around the corner and the draws now sealed, all eyes are on shuttler Ayush Shetty, who has been handed the toughest opening match among all Indian singles players.

Ayush, on his tournament debut, will face World No. 1 Shi Yu Qi. The odds are not in favour of the 21-year-old, having lost all three meetings to date, including the most recent one in the final of the Asian Championships.

"As soon as I got Shi (in the draw), I told myself that I was ready to face anyone. As I'm unseeded, I was prepared to play even the World No. 1. It's just another match, though I'm aware that it'll be a really tough battle," Ayush said in an online interaction on Monday.

Despite the daunting task at hand, Ayush cut a confident figure when asked about the rematch, stating that he has analysed all their meetings and is ready for the 'special' clash.

"Shi is a really tough opponent to play against. I remember my match against him in the Asian Championships final; he was really prepared. But I think I've gotten better and we'll be better prepared this time. I really have to work hard while playing against him. I'll have to be tactically better this time," he said.

Need of the hour: Ayush says he has to be 'tactically better this time'. GETTY IMAGES

"It gives me confidence that I have done well in the Thomas Cup and Asian Championships, but the World Championships is definitely higher-ranked for me and my team. It's a good challenge, and I'm ready."

This is the second straight edition in which an Indian will face Shi in the opening round, after Lakshya Sen went down 17-21, 19-21 to the Chinese player last year.

Lakshya, however, avenged that loss when the two met again in the first round at the All England earlier this year.

Shi, who will be defending his title, has been far from his best in recent weeks, and that gives a now fully fit Ayush a chance to cause an early upset.

"I had some pain (elbow injury) earlier, but now it's all good. I'll be at 100% during the Worlds," he stated.

Fulton and Marijne. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

New format presents an arduous path

HOCKEY WC

Aashin Prasad
CHENNAI

The new format of the upcoming FIH men's and women's World Cups in the Netherlands and Belgium presents teams with a challenging path to the final.

While the 16 teams will be divided into four groups of four, there will be no quarterfinal stage, which had a shortlived existence in the 2018 and 2022/2023 editions. The Indian men have been placed in Pool D alongside England, Pakistan and Wales while the women's team will battle it out against China, England and South Africa in Pool D.

The top two sides from each pool will progress to the second stage, which will be split into two groups of four. The top two there will qualify for the semifinals.

If the India men's team or one of England/Pakistan/Wales go through to the second round, they will be paired with the top two sides from Pool A. In this scenario, India's result against the other team which advances from its pool, will be carried forward into the second stage.

The Indian men's team head coach, Craig Fulton, stressed the need for a strong start.

"The format has obviously changed drastically – from having quarterfinals to not having them. So the emphasis on the pool games is really, really important, because it's obviously the top two that will go through. And the head-to-head result between those two teams matters: if one beats the other, those three points carry into the next round, and that puts you in the driving seat to get out of the next group and into the semifinals," said Fulton.

Sjoerd Marijne, the Indian women's team head coach, felt the new format robbed the tournaments of the excitement of an additional knockout game.

"It's an interesting schedule, but my preference is to have quarterfinals in a tournament format. The higher-ranked teams will prefer this, but I think quarterfinals are among the most exciting matches," said Marjine.

Russian federation files fresh CAS appeal

Reuters
LONDON

Russian Athletics has lodged a new claim with the Court of Arbitration for Sport (CAS), challenging sanctions imposed by World Athletics (WA) as the federation seeks to restore the participation of Russian athletes in international competition.

Latest development

The federation said on Monday that the latest appeal targets restrictions it argues infringe its rights and prevent it from fully representing Russian athletes internationally.

Russian athletes have been excluded from international competition under WA since Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

Russian Athletics said the measures have left it unable to participate in WA decision-making processes, including council meetings and votes, and have prevented Russian officials and specialists from taking part in coaching conferences, seminars and professional development programmes. "The sanctions against Russian Athletics are unprecedented. No other sports federation faces such severe restrictions," Boris Yaryshevskiy, Chief Executive Director, Russian Athletics, said in a statement.

Three confederations condemn FIFA president Infantino in joint letter

Agence France-Presse
LAUSANNE

Football's governing body FIFA's president Gianni Infantino came under renewed fire on Monday as a joint letter from three confederations – UEFA, CONCACAF and AFC – declared football "belongs to no individual".

Infantino has been the butt of scathing criticism ever since launching, and then withdrawing within days, a plan to bring private investment into FIFA competitions, including World Cups.

FIFA had hit back on Saturday at "a concerted and ongoing effort by some to undermine" it and Infantino.

However, Monday's letter from the governing bodies of European football (UEFA), North and Central America (CONCACAF) and Asia (AFC), showed his critics are unbowed.

The three confederations had been vociferous in their condemnation of Infantino's plan and had not let up after it was shelved.

CONCACAF president Victor Montagliani is viewed as a potential challenger to Infantino, who will seek a fourth and final term at the FIFA presidential election in Rabat next March. Candidates have to be declared by November 18.

Under fire: Monday's letter from UEFA, CONCACAF and AFC proves that Infantino's critics will not bow. FILE PHOTO

UEFA's threat to boycott World Cups if the private investment plan went ahead – in theory depriving the competition of teams including reigning men's champion Spain and 2026 semifinalists France and England – proved pivotal in Infantino withdrawing the proposal.

Prior to this debacle, Infantino had looked likely to be unopposed, after overseeing a successful World Cup in the United States, Mexico and Canada.

The 56-year-old Swiss, who has been in situ for 10 years, has received the backing of the Confederation of African Football (CAF) while South American governing body CONMEBOL are largely supportive. The confederations do not vote as blocs and there have been some supportive voices for Infantino from CONCACAF, Mexico, and two AFC members – Kuwait and 2022 World Cup host Qatar, where he has a house.

Although Infantino had received the "full support" of senior FIFA directors last week in an emergency meeting he called in Morocco, the confederations said it was meaningless.

However, the confederations made clear in the letter that it was not just Infantino who had made this possible.

"The growth over the past decade has been real. But that progress was never the work of one individual".

Scotland and Netherlands criticise ICC's World Cup format changes

Reuters
EDINBURGH

Cricket Scotland and the Royal Dutch Cricket Association (KNCB) have criticised the International Cricket Council (ICC) for changing the format of the 2027 Men's ODI World Cup.

The ICC introduced a new Super Series phase under which the teams ranked 12th, 13th and 14th in the qualification process will contest a tri-series, with only one progressing to the second round, where 12 teams will be split into two groups.

The two Associate Member boards described the lack of communication as "disappointing and disrespectful".

"These changes represent a setback to Associate Member cricket and risk undermining the progress made in recent years to grow the global game," they said in a joint statement on Monday.

"At a time when cricket is seeking to expand its reach, attract new audiences and strengthen its position on the international sporting landscape, reducing meaningful opportunities for emerging nations sends entirely the wrong message.

The ODI World Cup trophy. AFP

The ICC introduced a new Super Series phase under which the teams ranked 12th, 13th and 14th in the qualification process will contest a tri-series

While saying that the Associate members should have been given more time to understand the changes, CS and KNCB called for "greater clarity" in the process involved.

Associate Members are nations that belong to the ICC but do not hold Full Member status, which is reserved for the game's leading countries. The 2027 World Cup will be co-hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

INBRIEF

India clinches 17 medals at u-23 Commonwealth fencing

India secured 17 medals, including four gold, five silver, and eight bronze, on the opening day of the under-23 Commonwealth fencing championships in Lagos, Nigeria. In men's sabre, Nikhil Wagh claimed gold, Lakshay Badser took the silver, and Ashwini Arya and Laishram Moramba shared the bronze medals. In men's foil, Tejas Patil captured silver and Hemash Sanasam took the bronze. In men's epee, Lokesh Vemani brought home a silver, with Shaurya Ashwini and Godwin Anbkess earning bronze. Joys Ashita won gold in women's foil and Kanaglakshmi earned silver. In women's epee, Prachi Lohan clinched gold and Nivedhya Nair and Anupriya both claimed bronze. In women's sabre, Jeferlin won the gold and Aakhari took silver, while Shreya Gupta added a bronze medal.

Arihant and Pooja advance in PSA Challenger Tour Kolkata

Arihant K.S. and Pooja Raghu advanced to the next round after winning their respective men's and women's opening matches at HCL Squash PSA Challenger Tour-Kolkata in Kolkata on Monday. Arihant defeated Switzerland's Leandro Mannhart 11-6, 9-11, 13-11, 11-4 while Pooja beat Kaashvi Mangal 13-15, 11-6, 11-6, 7-11, 11-9.

The results: Men: Hassan Menshawy (Egy) bt Vedant Patel 11-7, 7-11, 11-7, 11-6; Ravi Dixit bt Pardeep Malik 11-8, 11-8, 11-6; Arihant K.S. bt Leandro Mannhart (Sui) 11-6, 9-11, 13-11, 11-4; Sandhesh Palanivel Ravikumar bt Harshal Rana 11-9, 12-10, 11-9; Fabian Igelbrink (Ger) bt Adarsh Banodha 11-6, 11-5, 11-8
Rahul Baitha bt Rounak Yadav 11-6, 11-5, 11-9; Deepak Mandal bt Miguel Mathis (Sui) 11-7, 11-5, 4-11, 11-4; Shaurya Bawa bt Mohit Bhatt 11-4, 9-11, 11-4, 11-2.
Women: Pooja Raghu bt Kaashvi Mangal 13-15, 11-6, 11-6, 7-11, 11-9; Reiva Nimbalkar bt Arnaa Dwivedi 11-5, 11-8, 11-8; Ananya Narayanan bt Aahana Singh 8-11, 11-2, 11-8, 11-8; Anjali Semwal bt Bria Sharma 11-7, 11-1, 11-6.
Vyomika Khandelwal w/o Goushika M.; Vasundhara Nangare bt Janet Vidhi 11-8, 11-5, 11-5; Anika Dubey bt Aryaa Dwivedi 11-9, 11-7, 11-6; Sahana Kalaivanan bt Rani Gupta 11-1, 11-2, 11-2.

Rahm three-peats as LIV Golf season champion

Jon Rahm captured his third consecutive LIV Golf season crown on Sunday while Chile's Joaquin Niemann took a wire-to-wire victory at LIV Golf New York for a record ninth series title. Niemann fired a two-under par 69 to finish 72 holes on 16-under 268 and defeat American Harold Varner III by three strokes in New Jersey. Rahm finished tied for 41st after a 76 on Sunday, but clinched the season trophy with an unassailable 219-point lead over Bryson DeChambeau going into the finale in two weeks at Indianapolis.

Bagan steamrollers Protectors to top the group and book spot in last eight

The Kolkata giant rides on Sahal's hat-trick and goals from Manvir, Maclaren and Abhishek to make it three out of three; Pena scores a double as Sporting Club Delhi shoots down Indian Air Force 7-1 at the Birsa Munda Stadium in Ranchi to storm into the quarterfinals with a perfect record

Triple treat: Sahal helped himself to three goals in the first half. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Joyous bunch: Sporting Club Delhi players celebrate one of their seven strikes. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

DURAND CUP

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Mohun Bagan Super Giant topped Group A of the 135th Durand Cup in style with a commanding 6-0 win over CISF Protectors at the Kishore Bharati Stadium on Monday.

Sahal Abdul Samad starred with a hat-trick, while Manvir Singh, Jamie Maclaren and Tekcham Abhishek Singh scored once each as the Mariners completed a perfect group-stage campaign with three wins from three matches.

Sahal opened the scoring in the 17th minute after being set up by Liston Colaco and doubled the lead two minutes later from a Dezan Drazic pass. Manvir made it 3-0 in the 24th minute before Sahal completed his hat-trick with a spectacular solo effort in the 37th. Substitute Maclaren added the fifth in the 68th minute, with Abhishek completing the rout five minutes later.

Bagan, which had beaten South United FC 8-0 in its previous game, confirmed a quarterfinal place as the group topper with nine points. East Bengal FC was second with six points.

Goal glut

Meanwhile, Sporting Club Delhi thrashed Indian Air Force 7-1 in a Group C match at the Birsa Munda Stadium in Ranchi to top the group with three successive wins and confirm a last-eight spot.

The results: Group A (Kolkata): Mohun Bagan SG 6 (Sahal Abdul Samad 17, 19, 37, Manvir Singh 24, Jamie Maclaren 68, Abhishek Singh 73) bt CISF Protectors 0.

Group C (Ranchi): Sporting Club Delhi 7 (Rodrigo Da Silva 11, Juan Sebastian Pena 38, 65, Duvan Viafara 54, Lalrinliana Hnamte 63, Clarence Savio 79, Richard Ndayishimiye 90+4) bt Indian Air Force 1 (Samuel Vanlalpeka 49).

Krish wins it for Lions in a truncated match; Purani Dilli 6 rides on Anuj's blistering 92

DPL

Sports Bureau
NEW DELHI

In a game severely truncated by rain, Krish Yadav's unbeaten 34 off 14 deliveries was valuable in handing West Delhi Lions an eight-wicket win against East Delhi Riders in the Delhi Premier League at the Arun Jaitley Stadium here on Monday.

Chasing 58 in seven overs after East Delhi Riders posted an underwhelming total of 95 for five in 15 overs, Krish's cameo helped Lions romp to the target revised via the Duckworth-Lewis-Stern (DLS) method in 4.1 overs.

East Delhi, which was sent in to bat, had its opener Dhruv Kaushik dismissed off the very first ball. While Arpit Rana and Sujal Singh steadied the innings with a 53-run partnership off 32 deliveries, Riders stuttered in the latter overs.

Krish scored 34 off 14 balls.

The run chase saw Krish take control at the top of the order. It was rather fitting that the opener sealed the game with a six over deep midwicket.

Later, Anuj Rawat smashed 92 as Purani Dilli 6 cruised to a seven-wicket win over Outer Delhi Warriors on Monday night. After Purani Dilli's bowlers bundled out Warriors for 165, Anuj took the lead with an authoritative knock to help his team chase down the target in 15.2 overs.

The scores: East Delhi Riders 95/5 in 15 overs (Arpit Rana 32, Sujal Singh 34, Shubham Dubey 2/17, Mayank Gusain 2/16) lost to West Delhi Lions (DLS target 58 in 7 overs) 58/2 in 4.1 overs (Krish Yadav 34 n.o., Simarjeet Singh 2/25).
Outer Delhi Warriors 165 in 19.1 overs (Priyansh Arya 46, Akshay Saini 49, Pankaj Jaswal 3/39, Rajneesh Dadar 2/29, Udhav Mohan 2/27, Digvesh Rathi 2/21) lost to Purani Dilli 6 169/3 in 15.2 overs (Aryan Gaur 57 n.o., Anuj Rawat 92, Harsh Tyagi 3/29).

Solid field for PGTI Coal India Open

GOLF

Sports Bureau
KOLKATA

Top golfers, including Order of Merit (OoM) leader Saptak Talwar, Veer Ahlawat, Om Prakash Chouhan, Khalin Joshi and defending champion Angad Cheema, will be seen in action in the Coal India Open starting at the par-70 Tollygunge Club course on Tuesday.

The DP World Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI) tournament, offering a total prize purse of ₹1 crore, will have a field of 132 players including one amateur and several foreign professionals.

Local golfers, such as former OoM champion Shankar Das, Rahil Gangjee, Viraj Madappa, Mohammad Sanju, Divyanshu Bajaj, Sunit Chowrasia, Feroz Ali Mollah, Indrajit Bhalotia and Karan Verma, will enjoy their outing in familiar conditions.

The winner will take home ₹15 lakh, while the runner-up will receive ₹10 lakh.

Taskin's task in Australia: learn from pace quartet

Excited: Taskin will be keen to make his maiden Test series Down Under a memorable one. FILE PHOTO: R. RAGU

CRICKET

ANI
DARWIN

Bangladesh pacer Taskin Ahmed, who will play his first-ever Test in Australia, is keen on picking the brains of the Aussie pace quartet of skipper Pat Cummins, Mitchell Starc, Josh Hazlewood and Scott Boland during the series.

The first Test of the two-match series between Bangladesh and Australia will begin on August 13 here.

Taskin, closing in on 300 international wickets, has played nine white-ball internationals Down Under, picking up 14 wickets at an average of 26.00. This will be his maiden series in whites in Australia.

"From my childhood, I have been watching the Australian players and now I have the opportunity to play against them. I am really excited," said Taskin. "Australia is my favourite place to bowl. I have been watching all of them (Starc, Hazlewood, Cummins and Boland)... if I get a chance to chat with them, I will."

Bangladesh arrives in Australia for the Tests after the 2-1 ODI series win against the same opponent in home conditions. Taskin, who finished as Bangladesh's second-highest wicket-taker with five scalps, felt that the triumph would boost the confidence of the players.

Lively pitch

"That was a good series for us. It is a slow and low wicket in Mirpur traditionally, but it was a lively pitch against the Aussies.

"There is a big difference playing home and away," said Taskin. Bangladesh also has a lot to play for as it lies fourth in the World Test Championship standings after four outings. Australia is on top of the standings.

Bangladesh's Test schedule: August 13 to 17 (Darwin) and August 22 to 26 (Mackay).

Head. FILE PHOTO: REUTERS

Head remains grounded ahead of Bangladesh Test series

Agencies
DARWIN

Australia's focus will once again shift back to their World Test Championship 2025-27 campaign against Bangladesh on Wednesday, with opening batter Travis Head urging his side to temper expectations as it begins their push towards second WTC mace.

Head, who was one of the architects of Australia's Ashes success, remained grounded ahead of the opening Test. "There's going to be a lot of scrutiny around what goes on - it's a Test match and we're playing for World Test Championship points," Head told *cricket.com.au*. "Sometimes playing the better countries, you sit there with expectation. You go into a Test going, 'I just hope I get through it'. "Then you may come up against a team like Bangladesh, with the week they've had and the expectation of, 'I really expect myself to get runs', and that's sometimes the hardest place to be, when you go out there expecting to (make runs)."

Upbeat Pragg takes on Sevian in Sinquefield Cup opener

Press Trust of India
ST. LOUIS

In high spirits after his victory in the St. Louis Rapid and Blitz, which elevated him to second place in the overall Grand Chess Tour standings R. Praggnanandhaa begins his campaign in the Sinquefield Cup against American Samuel Sevian.

Barring a debacle here, the Indian Grandmaster is likely to feature in the finale later this year. The Grand Chess Tour (GCT) Finals are contested by the top-four finishers on the tour, and currently, American GM Fabiano Caruana is ahead of Praggnanandhaa.

Sevian is a surprise entry in the Sinquefield Cup, a GCT event, after French GM Alireza Firouzja decided to withdraw from the tour. All nine regular tour players will be back in the event, making it one of the strongest tournaments of the year, alongside Norway Chess, which was also won by Praggnanandhaa.

The player to beat: After the rapid and blitz win, Praggnanandhaa will be in the spotlight in classical format. FLICKR/GRANDCHESSTOUR

Caruana starts as the favourite, as classical chess is his forte, while fellow Americans, Wesley So and Levon Aronian, will also be among the contenders for a podium finish.

Add to that, World championship contender Javokhir Sindarov of Uzbekistan, Germany's Vincent Keymer, Anish Giri of the Netherlands and Frenchman Maxime Vachier-Lagrave, and it is a formidable field.

The other player is Jorden van Foreest of the Netherlands, who, on his day, can beat anyone.

The 10-player tournament will be played on a round-robin basis, with a total prize pool of $475,000.

High jumper Pooja, women's 4x400m team disappoint

ATHLETICS

Press Trust of India
EUGENE (USA)

National senior record holder high jumper Pooja Singh finished seventh in the final as India ended its World Athletics U-20 Championships campaign with three medals on Sunday.

The 19-year-old Pooja could only clear 1.84m, way below her National record of 1.93m.

She failed to sail over 1.87m in three attempts.

Izobelle Louison-Roe of Australia won with 1.92m.

In May, Pooja had won at the Asian u-20 athletics championships with the record height of 1.93m.

She is also the reigning champion in the senior Asian athletics athletics championships.

The Indian women's 4x400m relay team of Bhoomika Nehate, Tahura Khatun, Tanu Chaudhary and Thiya Arumugam finished ninth and last in the final, clocking 3 minute 45.28 seconds.

USA took gold with 3:29.15s ahead of Australia (3:31.39s) and Great Britain (3:32.08s).

With two silver and one bronze medal here, India equalled its medals haul achieved in the 2021 and 2022 editions.

Ashish Yadav had opened the account with a silver in men's javelin while Basant Kumar Meghwal and Shahnavaz Khan added a silver medal and bronze medal respectively in men's high jump and long jump.

I would like to set my own benchmark

A little over a year into senior badminton, Ayush has learnt to live with the pace, pressure and expectations that come with playing the world's best. Now, on home soil, he gets his biggest test yet against World No. 1 Shi

GETTY IMAGES

INTERVIEW

Ayush Shetty

Anirudh Velamuri

He used to let his badminton do the talking. Laid-back by nature, Ayush Shetty rarely showed too much emotion on court. These days, there is more fire and aggression, something he says gives him energy.

He will need every bit of it at the World championships in New Delhi, which gets underway at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium on August 17 (Monday). Ayush, on tournament debut, will face Shi Yu Qi, the World No. 1, with the weight of a home crowd and the expectations that come with being India's next big hope in men's singles.

But the 21-year-old isn't walking into the Worlds burdened by what came before him. He is walking in believing he has finally learnt to match the pace of the best. Now he wants to test that belief on the biggest stage. Excerpts from an online interaction:

It has been a little more than a year on the senior circuit now. How has it been so far?

When I entered the senior circuit, playing against the top-20 players was really a great challenge.

Matching their pace, in particular, was really tough. But I've now adapted to it. I think I can push them and play at their pace. I'm a lot more confident now.

You're going to make your Worlds debut in front of your home crowd in New Delhi.

Yeah, that brings pressure, but there's also excitement playing at home. It's a really special feeling, and I'm really excited about it.

Indian badminton has a rich history at the World championships. When you walk into that arena, you will be carrying expectations that players from many other countries won't have...

I think there are some expectations. I won't say that people aren't thinking that I won't go deep. But, yeah, my first round match will be a great challenge against the World No. 1. I'll be expecting good support, and I'm looking forward to it.

You lost to Shi at the Asian championship earlier this year. How does that play on your mind ahead of your meeting at the Worlds?

There's no revenge or any other kind of emotion in my mind. It's a new tournament, and I'm not really thinking about that defeat. I'll definitely be analysing that match and I'll be more prepared, I feel. I'll be tactically better this time as I remember Shi outplayed me in that clash.

When you say better prepared to face Shi, what exactly do you mean?

I've lost to him thrice, and I've had some good learnings from those matches. In terms of the tactical aspects of the game, I think the Asian championships match was much better. We've been working really hard on those things right now and I feel a lot stronger. It'll again be a tough match, but I think it'll definitely be a different one this time.

Alwi Farhan and you have a long history, and you could potentially run into him in the round of 16. What makes him a difficult opponent?

Alwi plays at a really high pace. The variations he has from the backcourt are really amazing. He has one of the best drops in men's singles right now. That makes it really tough playing him. And he's also a bit cheeky on the court; he doesn't give his opponent a lot of space. Off the court, he's a good friend of mine. No doubt, it's not really nice when I'm playing against him.

You did defeat Alwi at the China Open...

That was more of a tactical contest. There was a lot of drift playing its part, too. My coach (Sagar Chopda) and I had a solid strategy, and it was executed really well. That's how we were on the winning side that day. I think it was really amazing. I lost to him twice before, but this was a good match for me.

After the first round, you might run into someone from Sri Lanka or Peru, whose playing styles would be very different. Is that on your mind going into the event?

I think we should always go match by match. Right now the main focus is on the first round, and it'll be a really good battle against Shi. I'm not thinking about who is coming later on.

Even though you're still very young, you have a lot of experience winning medals at big tournaments. Does that give you the confidence going into this competition, or do you see this as a very different and much bigger challenge?

That does give great confidence. I've done well at the Asian championships and Thomas Cup. But I definitely think that the World championships would rank bigger than all those events.

What are some of the things that you've been working on of late?

We've been preparing really well for the World championships. We're working on all aspects of the game, including the physical and tactical parts. We're working on being more accurate in shot-making.

There have been some changes to your training pattern. Do you think they will enhance your game in this tournament?

Yeah, definitely. The focus has been on peaking for these tournaments, and I think the preparations are going really well. I would definitely be at my best while playing at the Worlds.

How has it been working with Irwansyah Adi Pratama?

The training has been a lot tougher. We have been training really long as well and he's been focusing more on speed. I've been trying to get much more faster, much more agile, and play aggressively. Outside the court, he's a very good guy. I can share anything with him and he will guide me in the right direction. That way, he's been really open.

What are the things you expect from him during a tournament?

On match-day, it's more about the contest. We analyse the match, he has his inputs and we prepare accordingly. It's nothing too in-depth, we don't talk a lot about the match but we just focus on the specifics.

How has it been training and sparring with Sindhu?

We have a similar type of game. She is also tall and attacking. There's a lot to learn from her.

You've also slowly become more expressive on the court. Is that something you've worked on?

Yeah, I think it helps me get more energy. I've been consciously focusing on it. My natural style would be a bit more laid-back, not express much, but I've been trying to be more aggressive on the court now.

There's been a lot of praise for you from the likes of Sindhu and Viktor Axelsen, among others, in the past. As an upcoming player, how do you receive what's being said of you all around?

It's a great honour to be praised by big legends. But also, when you're having early exits, it's the opposite. I focus more on myself, on getting better every day and believing in the process. I am enjoying playing badminton, and that's been my motto all along.

When you look at the Indian men's singles players who have already created a legacy at the World championships, do you see that history as a benchmark to chase?

I don't see it as a benchmark to chase. I would like to set my own benchmark. I'm not focusing on what the legends of the game have done. I've been focusing more on myself, to keep playing better and winning matches.

Do you feel the weight of representing the next generation of Indian badminton?

I would not like to focus or think about setting a benchmark for the next generation. Since we'll be playing at home, there is definitely some pressure. But I also see it as a great opportunity for me to debut at a special tournament like the World championships in India.

Badminton is inching closer to the new 3x15 scoring system...

It will change the game a lot. I would prefer it to be 21 (points), but everyone will have to adapt. It is a new challenge for all players. It'll be a much faster and more explosive game. There won't be that many gruelling battles.

If a 10-year-old kid from a small town near Mangaluru is going to watch you at the Worlds this year, what do you want that kid to learn and take away?

I think it would be about how everyone comes to the stadium and supports the players. It would be amazing for any player to play with the crowd behind them, cheering for every point. I think that would inspire everyone, and that would mean a lot.

Agasthyamalai eviction orders still silence Forest Rights Act

The FRA does not require that traditional forest-dwellers need to occupy the land they are claiming for three generations before 2005 nor does it prohibit commercial activities on all forest lands – yet the administration and the judiciary have hampered its implementation on these grounds

C.R. Bijoy

Angry outbursts and tears of desperation swept the hillsides in the Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve (ABR), particularly in Theni. In the last few weeks, the Forest Department has issued eviction notices to thousands of households on the Tamil Nadu side alleging they had encroached on forest land.

Based on the findings and recommendations of the Central Empowered Committee (CEC), the Supreme Court directed a time-bound encroachment eviction plan, rehabilitation where applicable, legal action against wilful violators, and post-eviction ecological restoration.

It also imposed additional penalties against 118 government servants found to be encroachers, and ordered the dismantling of all structures, utilities, logistical facilities, etc. within encroached forest areas.

Finally, the Bench prohibited the diversion of forest land or the start of new non-forest activities within the ABR until all encroachments had been removed.

Likewise, it granted immunity from prosecution to all forest, police, revenue, and other officials involved in surveying, demarcating, and removing encroachments as part of this exercise except in cases involving *mala fide* or arbitrary action. Significantly, the court directed the CEC to recommend the deployment of paramilitary forces if the Tamil Nadu government failed to comply with the court's directions.

The State is also to decide on the utilisation, retention, relocation or removal of all infrastructure and other establishments belonging to the Bombay Burmah Trading Corporation, Ltd. (BBTCL) in the Kalakkad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve, in consultation with the CEC.

Agasthyamalai is a 3,500 sq. km biosphere reserve within Tamil Nadu and Kerala. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Historical injustice

Parliament enacted the Forest Rights Act (FRA) in 2006 to undo the historical injustice suffered by forest dwellers. It recognised and vested forest rights on forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribes and other traditional forest dwellers who had occupied forest land before December 13, 2005.

The FRA provided for a transparent process for these individuals to claim their individual and community rights, to be verified and approved by gram sabhas. Six-member sub-division- and district-level committees – with representatives from the Revenue, Tribal, and Forest Departments and the elected members of panchayats – have to examine the claims and issue titles. Those forest land occupations that didn't fall within the FRA's scope could then become the actual encroachment.

But over the years, State governments, the CEC, the Forest Departments, and even the Supreme Court have ignored this basic legal fact. Despite the FRA having operated for two decades, no official has asked for data on forest land occupation falling outside the FRA's scope nor has such information been presented to the public – making the data presented on encroachment and encroachers in any forum suspect.

In fact, in the recent hearings, the Supreme Court should have hauled up the recalcitrant State governments for poor FRA implementation. The Tribal Department, which is the nodal department to implement the Act, has also been problematically silent over these infirmities.

The FRA also prohibits authorities from evicting people who have allegedly encroached on forest land "till the recognition and verification procedure is complete". Violating these forest rights has been described as an atrocity under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989, since 2016. Yet courts and officials have continued to breach this principle.

Nowhere does the FRA produce a requirement that other traditional forest dwellers have to have occupied the land they are claiming for three generations (75 years) before 2005. Nor does the Act prohibit commercial activities on all forest lands or cultivating commercial crops there. In fact, the FRA defines "bonafide livelihood needs" to include the "sale of surplus produce arising out of exercise of such rights". It also explicitly permits grazing on all forest lands. Yet the administration and the judiciary have hampered the FRA's implementation on these dubious grounds.

CEC's findings

The ABR spans 3,500 sq. km across Kerala (including parts of Pathanamthitta, Kollam, Idukki, and Thiruvananthapuram) and Tamil Nadu (Tirunelveli, Kanyakumari, Tenkasi, Theni, and Dindigul).

It also covers protected areas as Kalakad-Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve, the Srivilliputhur-Megamalai Tiger Reserve, the Nellai Wildlife Sanctuary, and the Kanyakumari Wildlife Sanctuary in Tamil Nadu. In Kerala, it includes the Periyar Tiger Reserve and the Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuary.

In March 2025, the Supreme Court directed the CEC to conduct an extensive survey of the entire Agasthyamalai landscape and report within three months on non-forestry activities in violation of the Forest Conservation Act 1980 and the Wild Life (Protection) Act 1972.

The Supreme Court directed a time-bound encroachment eviction plan, rehabilitation where applicable, legal action against wilful violators, and post-eviction ecological restoration at the Agasthyamalai Biosphere Reserve

Based on inputs from the Forest Departments, field visits besides, and the previous Madras High Court orders pertaining to Megamalai, the CEC submitted its interim report on July 10, 2025, and the final report on January 16, 2026. The Court's latest directions were based on the contents of these reports. Five of its findings follow:

(i) Srivilliputhur-Megamalai Tiger Reserve: Around 4,595 individuals encroached 5,071.2 ha across Varusanadu, Megamalai, Gandamanur, and Chinnamanur, per 2020 records. The Theni district magistrate reported 4,601 encroachers had occupied 5,072.6 ha. The CEC also recorded 118 serving or retired government employees had encroached 15 ha.

(ii) Kalakad- Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve: Of the 3,388.6 ha of land leased to BBTCL – of the Wadia Group – roughly 3,300 ha had been handed over to the Forest Department in May 2025. The remaining 89.6 ha housed factories, offices, schools, common places with shops, weigh bridges, etc. Their dismantling was to be completed shortly. Another 10.1 hectares had been occupied by 99 families of workers involved in building the Papanasam Upper and Lower Dams in 1942.

(iii) Kanniyakumari Forest Division: Some 427.4 ha had been encroached by 553 persons, of which 237 ha by 47 persons was involved in court cases.

(iv) Periyar Tiger Reserve: About 700 non-tribal inhabitants have lived on tea estates in core areas since the early 20th century.

(v) Shendurney Wildlife Sanctuary: 1.3 ha had been occupied by tribal people in Kattilappara and Rosemala settlements.

Petitions dismissed

The apex court's new orders relate to appeals against the Madras High Court order denying the petitioners' claims about implementing FRA in Manjolai tea estate and rehabilitating evicted estate workers. The court subsequently extended the case's scope to cover ABR, inside which the estate is located.

The lease of the 3,388.7 ha of land leased to BBTCL for 99 years was set to expire in 2028. The Tamil Nadu government declared this land to be part of the critical tiger habitat of the Kalakkad Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve in 2007, notified it as reserve forest in 2018, and issued the eviction notice in 2023. BBTCL then initiated a voluntary retirement scheme for its workers.

These workers filed several PILs and writ petitions challenging the scheme as well as the State's actions, but the Madras High Court and the Supreme Court both dismissed them in 2024 and 2025.

One petition had contended that as the estate had been set up in 1929, the workers should be considered for forest claims under the FRA as 'other traditional forest-dwellers' fulfilling residence in the region for three generations. But the High Court declared these workers to be estate employees, not forest dwellers, and circumscribed them from the FRA's ambit.

Thus, the historical injustice continues.

(C.R. Bijoy examines natural resource conflicts and governance issues. cr.bijoy@gmail.com)

Researcher Aaron Carlisle works to place a tag on a white shark alongside a boat off the coast of Delaware, U.S., on May 5, 2025. REUTERS

Scientists turn to sharks for hurricane predictions

Reuters

From the killer shark of *Jaws* to the tornado-tossed predators of the *Sharknado* movies, films long have portrayed sharks as objects of summer fear. But when a shark cuts through the waters off the U.S. East Coast, it now may be doing more than hunting. It may also be gathering data that helps scientists understand the potential intensity of a hurricane before it makes landfall.

University of Delaware researchers are testing whether sharks can serve as mobile near-real-time ocean-data observers, carrying sensors that measure ocean conditions to inform climate, oceanographic, and atmospheric models.

These CTD tags are small electronic devices that measure ocean electrical conductivity – a metric closely related to salinity – as well as temperature and depth, as marine creatures to which they are attached swim and dive.

CTD tags are small electronic devices that measure ocean electrical conductivity, temperature and depth, as marine creatures to which they are attached swim and dive

"Animal-borne sensors have been used successfully by oceanographers for years, particularly on elephant seals in polar regions where scientific observations are scarce," said Aaron Carlisle, principal investigator and a professor in the university's School of Marine Science and Policy. Sharks offer a new opportunity in such research because they are abundant, widely distributed and easier to access than many protected marine mammals, he said.

Until now, shark tagging typically has tracked only where these fish travel and the habitats they use. The University of Delaware researchers select sharks that can collect the measurements most useful for hurricane research, and favor species that surface often enough for their tags to transmit the information to satellites. Previous analyses identified shortfin mako sharks, blue sharks, smooth hammerheads and juvenile great white sharks as strong candidates for such research in the North Atlantic.

"We are really most interested in the heat content of the top layer of the ocean, which is known as the mixed layer," Dr. Carlisle said. "This is the part of the water column that really drives hurricane intensity – warmer mixed layer equals stronger hurricane – as it holds the heat that feeds hurricanes," he added.

The tagging process begins in early May, when highly migratory species move closer to the coast from their winter habitats further out in the Atlantic, according to Caroline Wiernicki, a University of Delaware doctoral candidate in marine science.

Researchers head 50 to 65 km offshore aboard a research vessel, deploy baited lines and wait, two to three hours, for a shark to take the bait, Ms. Wiernicki said.

"The tags are attached to the dorsal fin. Then every time the shark fins (swims) at the surface, the tag can communicate and transmit data to the orbiting network of satellite receivers," Dr. Carlisle said. The tagging process itself is operated "like a pit crew" in an auto race, he said, and usually takes less than five minutes.

The tagging is carried out under institutional animal care oversight to minimise impact on the sharks. The tags are attached using materials designed to corrode and fall off over time. Each shark also undergoes a health check before release, as a stressed or harmed shark may not behave naturally, potentially biasing the data, Dr. Carlisle said.

For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Please send in your answers to science@thehindu.co.in

Patents that changed their industries

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1

On May 1, 1888, the Serbian-American engineer X received a patent for a new kind of motor. It was, specifically, an induction motor that used a rotating magnetic, thus making unit drives for machines feasible and in turn the transmission of alternating current a crucial part of economic growth. Name X.

QUESTION 2

The _____ ___ was a machine that mechanically removed seeds from cotton fibres; its invention, by Eli Whitney, the patent for which was granted on May 14, 1794, dramatically boosted cotton production but was also responsible in part for entrenching slavery in the United States. Fill in the blanks.

QUESTION 3

Also in 1888, an American entrepreneur named George Y was awarded a patent for a handheld camera with a small roll-film, which Y had designed to make photography accessible to even the novice. It was a revolutionary product. Y also became famous for turning Kodak into the world's leading supplier of film stock. Name Y.

QUESTION 4

On October 6, 1942, a physicist named Chester Carlson was awarded the patent for a technology called P, originally called electrophotography. Two decades later, businessman Joseph Wilson recognised P's potential and worked with Carlson to commercialise it. They were so successful that the name of Wilson's company Q, became synonymous with P. Name P and Q.

QUESTION 5

In 1972, a chemist named Stephanie Kwolek discovered _____, a polymer fibre that was five-times stronger than the same weight of steel. In the patent, it was called optically anisotropic aromatic polyamide dopes. Today, it is used in bulletproof vests and aerospace parts. Fill in the blank.

Answers to August 6 quiz:

1. Dead stars with ultra-powerful magnetic fields – **Ans: Neutron stars**
2. Star type formed when neutron stars collapse without becoming black holes – **Ans: Quark star**
3. Co-predictor of red giant stars with neutron-star cores – **Ans: Kip Thorne**
4. Unusually younger, hotter stars in old star clusters – **Ans: Blue stragglers**
5. Colloquial name for stars being accelerated by their supernovae – **Ans: Zombie stars**

Visual: **Tabetha Boyajian**

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VISUAL: Name this famous Hollywood actress who, together with George Antheil, received a patent for a technology to make radio-guided torpedoes harder for enemies to detect in 1942. They subsequently donated the patent to the U.S. Navy. PUBLIC DOMAIN